

7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods

Neighborhood Action Plan

In collaboration with Solomon Village CDC



Master of Urban Planning

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URBAN STUDIES & PLANNING
COLLEGE OF LIBERAL ARTS AND SCIENCES
WAYNE STATE UNIVERSITY



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Executive Summary

The 7-Mile Conant Neighborhoods Action Plan is a community-driven roadmap that equips residents, Solomon's Village CDC, neighborhood partners, and local entrepreneurs with practical strategies to strengthen and revitalize the neighborhood. More than a traditional planning framework, this Action Plan is designed to be a living resource, one that empowers residents to advocate for investment, access funding opportunities, and work collectively toward a stronger, more connected community for people of all ages and abilities.

The Action Plan is rooted in data-driven analysis and shaped by the voices of the people who know the neighborhood best: the residents. Community engagement reinforced that the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhood is a place of strong pride and lasting commitment. Residents expressed a desire for investment that helps them remain in their homes, supports local business, improves safety and walkability, creates opportunities for multi-generational learning, and expands attractive public spaces where neighbors can gather and connect. These priorities serve as the foundation for every recommendation presented in this plan.

The Action Plan translates these community priorities into four complementary implementation resources:

- Housing
- Commercial Development
- Neighborhood Beautification
- [Grant Playbook for FY26-FY28](#)

Together, these strategies are intended to preserve the neighborhood's existing strengths while creating new growth and investment. Recommendations focus on providing flexible strategies that residents and community organizations can adapt to as the neighborhood needs and desires evolve.

To support implementation, each focus area is paired with a comprehensive toolbox that connects users to grants, technical assistance, city programs, additional funding opportunities, and community resources. These toolkits are intended to lower barriers to action by making information more accessible and providing clear pathways for residents, business owners, and community leaders to turn ideas into meaningful neighborhood improvements. The [Grants Playbook](#) builds on this foundation with a dedicated FY26–FY28 funding calendar, application guidance, and a peer CDC landscape, giving Solomon's Village CDC and its partners a clear, sequenced path for pursuing the grants that make these recommendations possible.

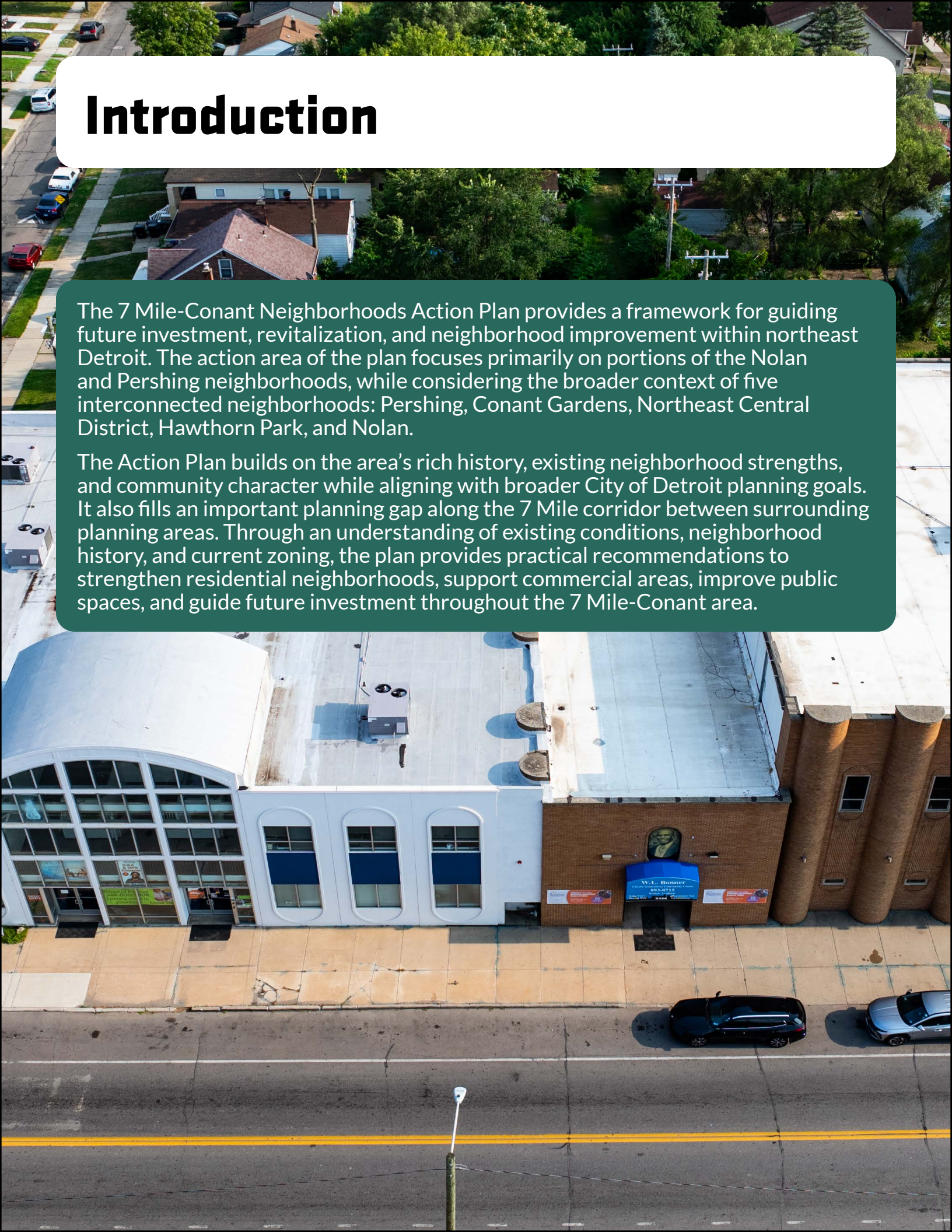
The accompanying digital resource further ensure that these materials remain accessible and adaptable as new opportunities emerge:

- [Toolbox Resource Page](#)

The 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods Action Plan is an investment in the community's future. By combining research, residents' perspectives, and practical implementation tools, it provides a foundation for continued collaboration and sustained neighborhood revitalization.

The recommendations presented here are intended to support ongoing efforts by residents, Solomon's Village CDC, local partners, and the City of Detroit to build on the neighborhood's strengths while fostering multi-generational investment, resilience, and community stewardship.

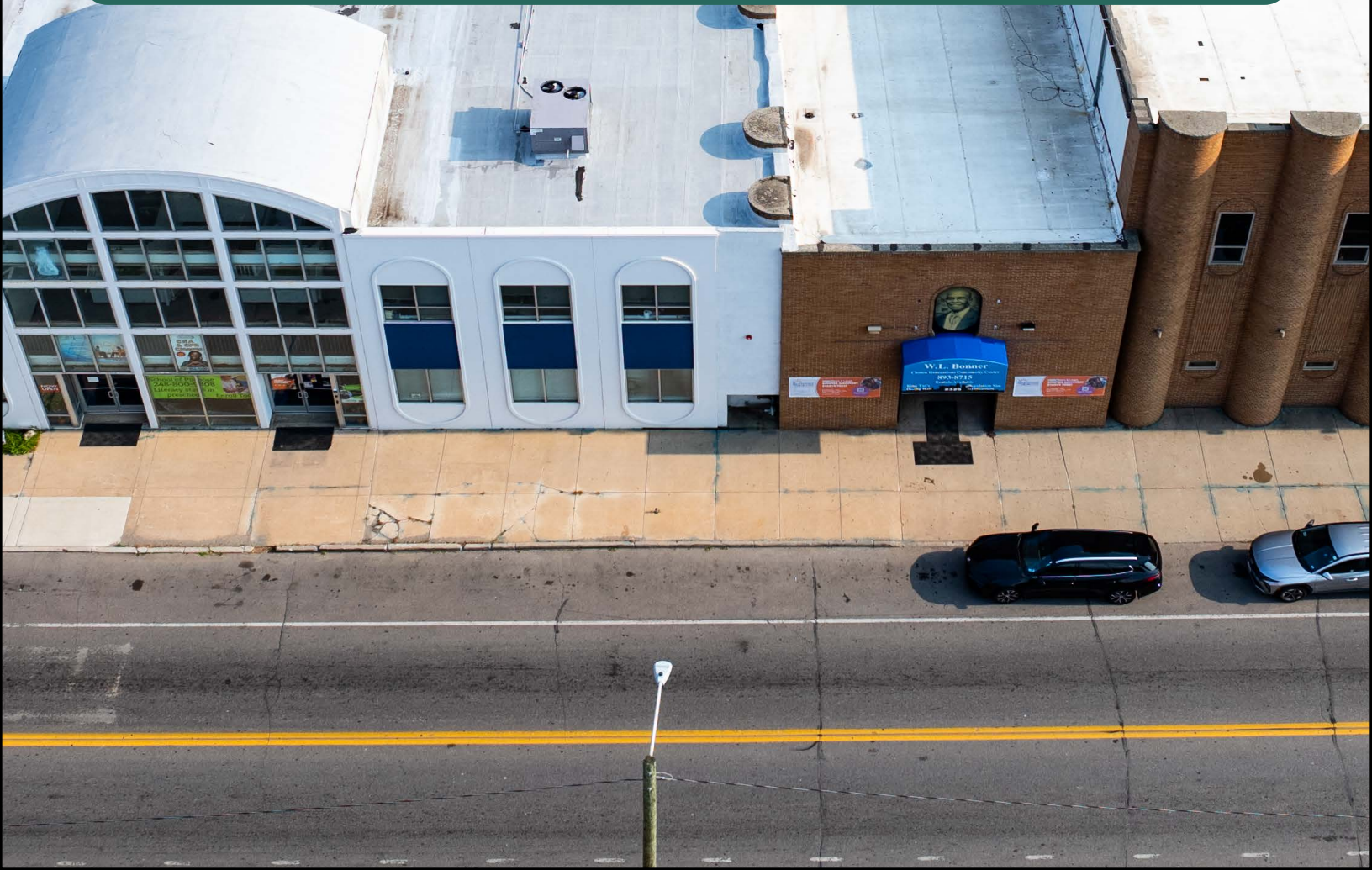




Introduction

The 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods Action Plan provides a framework for guiding future investment, revitalization, and neighborhood improvement within northeast Detroit. The action area of the plan focuses primarily on portions of the Nolan and Pershing neighborhoods, while considering the broader context of five interconnected neighborhoods: Pershing, Conant Gardens, Northeast Central District, Hawthorn Park, and Nolan.

The Action Plan builds on the area's rich history, existing neighborhood strengths, and community character while aligning with broader City of Detroit planning goals. It also fills an important planning gap along the 7 Mile corridor between surrounding planning areas. Through an understanding of existing conditions, neighborhood history, and current zoning, the plan provides practical recommendations to strengthen residential neighborhoods, support commercial areas, improve public spaces, and guide future investment throughout the 7 Mile-Conant area.



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Aerial image of the Chosen Generations Community Center

Action Area Overview

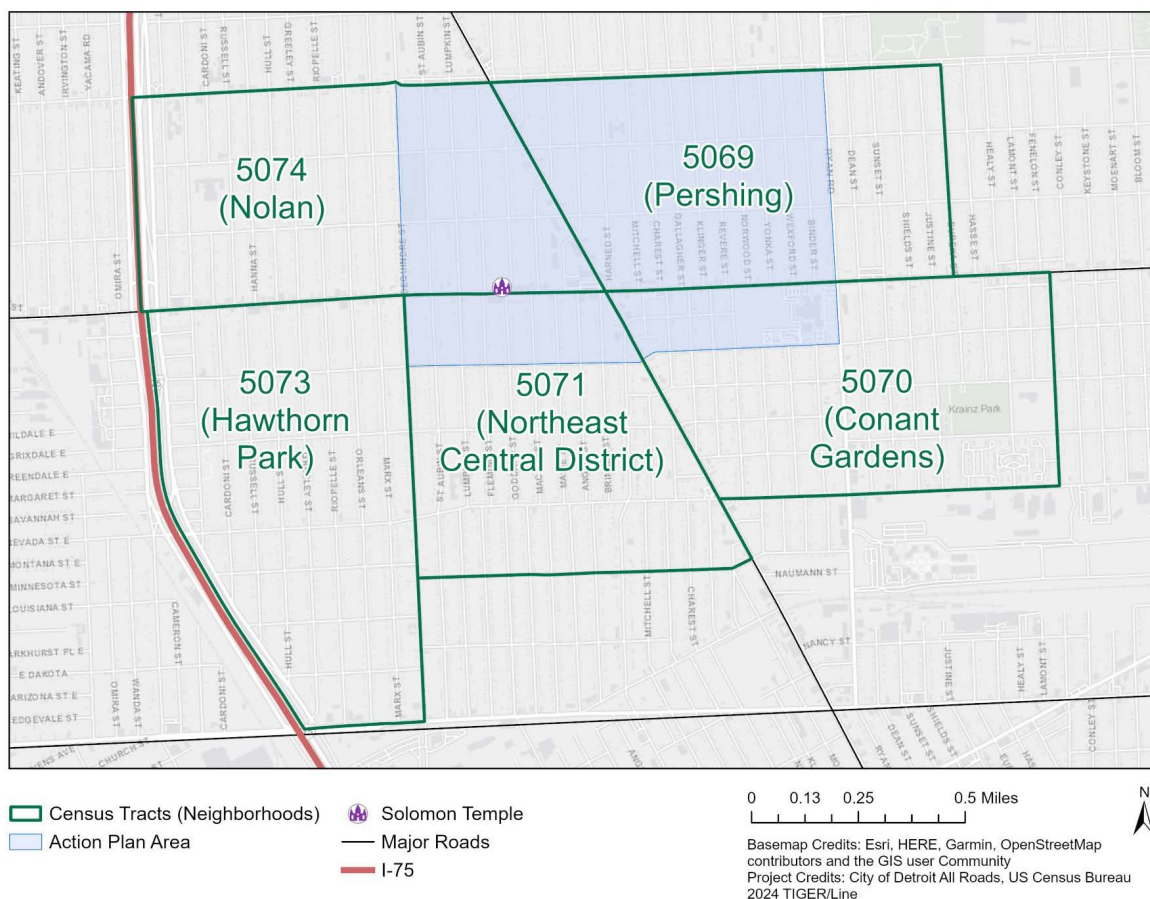
The action area addressed in this Action Plan is bounded by Outer Drive to the north, Ryan Road to the east, Robinwood Street to the south, and Dequindre Street to the west, as outlined in green in [Map 1](#). However, to provide important context for housing conditions in northeast Detroit, the action area at large includes five interconnected neighborhoods.

The Census tracts and their associated neighborhoods are:

- Census Tract 5069 (**Pershing**)
- Census Tract 5070 (**Conant Gardens**)
- Census Tract 5071 (**Northeast Central District**)
- Census Tract 5073 (**Hawthorn Park**)
- Census Tract 5074 (**Nolan**)

Each of the Census tracts listed above does not entirely encapsulate its associated neighborhood. However, for the purposes of this plan, references to each Census tract will be made using the name of its associated neighborhood to improve readability and provide a more intuitive geographic reference. Unless otherwise noted, all subsequent references to these neighborhoods correspond to their associated Census tracts rather than the full extent of the neighborhoods themselves.

MAP 1. 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods Action Area Overview



The following sections provide additional context for each of the five census tracts within the action area. See [Map 1](#) for their location and the [Historical Context](#) chapter for more details.

Pershing (Tract 5069)

Pershing is a residential neighborhood named after General John J. Pershing, who served in World War I. The neighborhood primarily developed during the mid-twentieth century, with most homes constructed between 1940 and 1969. Its housing stock includes Craftsman and cottage-style bungalows, American Foursquares, and postwar single-family homes, reflecting the architectural character of the neighborhood's residential development (Pershing Detroit).

Throughout much of the twentieth century, Pershing remained a predominantly white neighborhood before experiencing significant demographic change in the decades that followed. Like many surrounding communities, the neighborhood's population patterns shifted over time as African American residents expanded into areas beyond the historic boundaries of Conant Gardens.

Conant Gardens (Tract 5070)

Conant Gardens has a significant history as one of Detroit's most prominent African American communities, developing into an affluent middle-class neighborhood during the mid-twentieth century. By the 1930s, 1940s, and 1950s, the community had become recognized for its strong tradition of African American homeownership, civic engagement, and neighborhood stability (The Conant Gardens Community).

The neighborhood's residential character was largely established between the 1930s and 1950s, with Tudor Craftsman-style homes serving as a defining feature of its built environment (The Conant Gardens Neighborhood). As one of the earliest centers of African American homeownership within the neighborhoods, Conant Gardens played an important role in providing housing opportunities and fostering community development during a period when access to housing was heavily restricted for Black Detroiters.

Northeast Central District (Tract 5071)

The Northeast Central District was named based on its geographic location within the surrounding area. The neighborhood developed primarily during the 1940s and 1950s, with bungalows representing a significant portion of its residential housing stock (All About Northeast Central).

The Northeast Central District experienced substantial demographic change during the mid-twentieth century as African American residents increasingly established homes in communities surrounding Conant Gardens. Over time, the neighborhood became an important extension of the area's African American residential community and reflected the broader growth of Detroit's Black middle-class neighborhoods.



Hawthorn Park (Tract 5073)

Named after the native Hawthorn shrubs that once grew throughout the area, Hawthorn Park is a neighborhood with a unique connection to both Detroit and Highland Park. Although the neighborhood maintains a Detroit address, it shares a postal connection with Highland Park, linking it to the history and development of both communities (Neighborhood of Detroit).

The neighborhood's housing stock largely predates World War II and includes traditional cottages, bungalows, and Minimal Traditional-style homes, reflecting the residential development patterns of the early twentieth century (All About Hawthorn Park). Historically, Hawthorn Park developed as a predominantly white neighborhood before experiencing significant demographic change during the second half of the twentieth century. Over time, the neighborhood became part of the broader transformation of the surrounding area as African American residents established communities beyond the boundaries of Conant Gardens.

Nolan (Tract 5074)

Named after Benjamin A. Nolan, a longtime Detroit educator and former president of the Detroit Board of Education, the Nolan neighborhood is located on Detroit's outer east side. Shaped by the 1920s automotive boom and later post-industrial changes, this largely residential community is a testament to neighborhood resilience and Detroit's industrial heritage.

At its core is the historic Benjamin A. Nolan School, built in 1926 during the city's rapid public school expansion and designed by Smith, Hinchman & Grylls, with architectural attribution to Wirt C. Rowland, who also designed Detroit's famous Guardian building (Historic Detroit). Its brick-and-stone construction reflects the durable craftsmanship and civic architecture of the era, and, unlike many 1920s-era school buildings across the city, has remained in continuous operation for nearly a century.



Historic photograph of the Nolan neighborhood

Source: Archives of Michigan, Wayne County Road Commission photograph collection



Planning Context and Alignment

Neighborhood Action Plan Focus

This Neighborhood Action Plan focuses primarily on portions of the Nolan and Pershing neighborhoods, which are located within the Cluster 1 area, as defined in the City of Detroit Master Plan of Policies (2009).

The recommendations and strategies outlined in this plan align with numerous goals outlined by the City of Detroit for Cluster 1, including, but not limited to:

Alignment with Nolan Neighborhood Goals

- Goal 1:** Reinforce sound neighborhoods
- Goal 3:** Increase the vitality of commercial thoroughfares
- Goal 4:** Increase the vitality of neighborhood commercial areas
- Goal 5:** Improve the appearance of commercial areas
- Goal 7:** Increase open space and recreational opportunities

Alignment with Pershing Neighborhood Goals

- Goal 1:** Reinforce sound neighborhoods
- Goal 3:** Increase the vitality of neighborhood commercial areas
- Goal 4:** Improve the appearance of commercial areas
- Goal 5:** Increase access to open space and recreational areas



Source: City of Detroit

Relationship to Surrounding Planning Areas

The action area for this plan is also situated between the action areas for the Grixdale Farms, Campau/Banglatown, and Gratiot / 7-Mile Neighborhood Framework Plans.

This placement allows this plan to fill a crucial planning gap along the 7 Mile corridor between Grixdale Farms and Gratiot / 7-Mile.

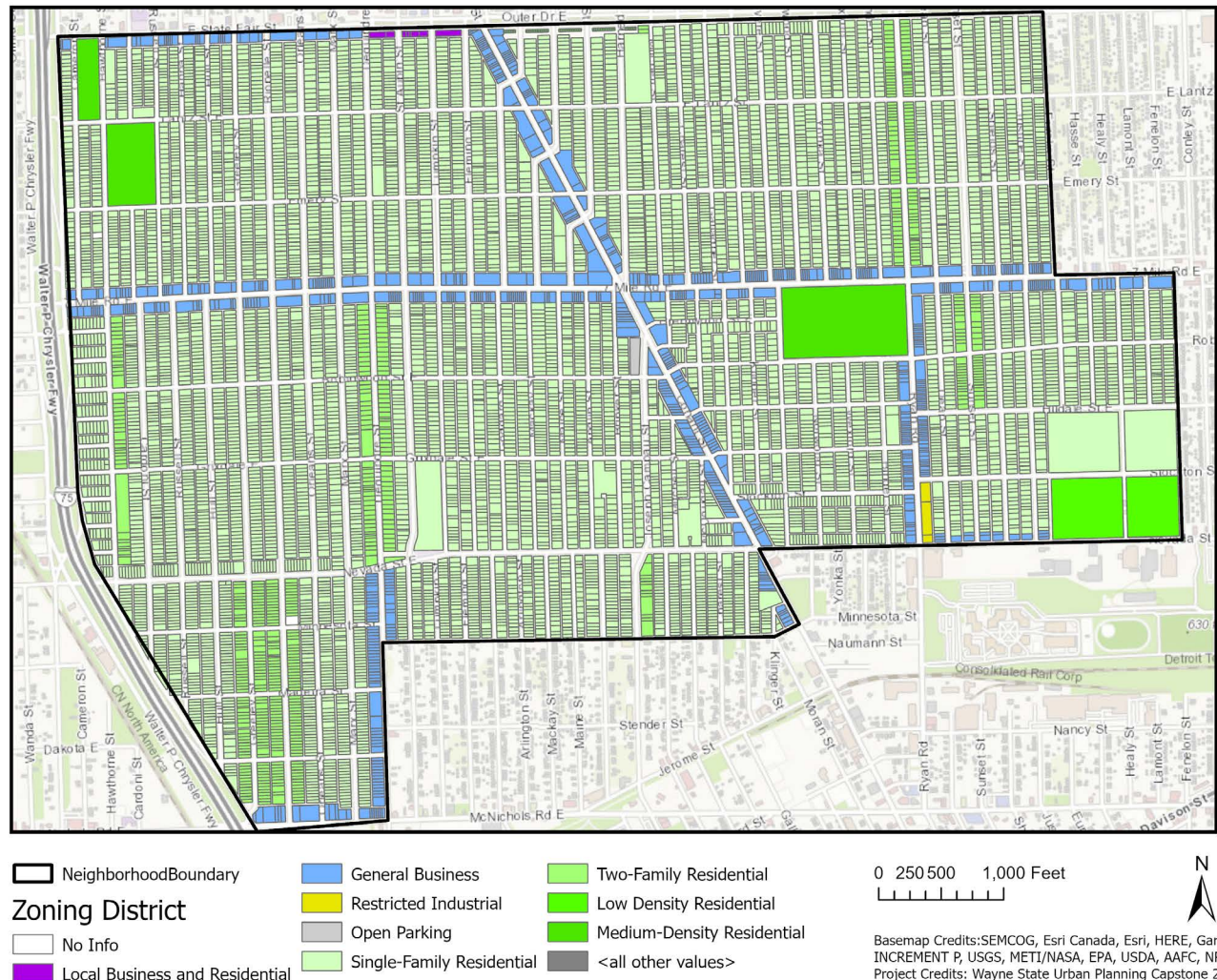
Relationship to Existing Neighborhood Plans

At the time of this plan's writing, there are currently no other adopted neighborhood action or framework plans in effect for the five neighborhoods referenced in this Action Plan.

Neighborhood Zoning Map

Below is the current zoning classifications of the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhood. This map will be referenced throughout the Action Plan in reference to recommended zoning changes.

MAP 2. 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods Zoning Map



Historical Context

This historical overview is included to ground the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhoods in its long-term social, economic, and spatial context. Understanding how the neighborhood developed, including its early formation, demographic change, settlement patterns, and periods of commercial growth and disinvestment, provides context for interpreting current conditions along the corridor and surrounding residential areas. These historical processes help explain the existing land use and built environment as well as the structural forces that have shaped investment patterns, housing stability, and commercial activity over time.

In this plan, the history serves as a foundation rather than a standalone narrative. It clarifies how past decisions, regional economic shifts, and segregation in housing markets contributed to present-day conditions. It also helps distinguish between trends that have continued over time and those that represent more recent change. By situating current challenges and opportunities within this broader trajectory, the plan supports recommendations that respond to long-standing patterns instead of isolated symptoms.



Historical Context

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Aerial imagery over 7 Mile and Ryan Rd

History of Conant Gardens and Surrounding Communities

Origins and Early Development

Conant Gardens is one of Detroit's most significant historic Black neighborhoods and a notable example of African American homeownership and community development during the twentieth century. The land that would become Conant Gardens was originally purchased in 1835 by Shubael Conant, an abolitionist who later served as the first president of the Detroit Anti-Slavery Society. Unlike many Detroit subdivisions developed during the twentieth century, properties in Conant Gardens were not subject to racially restrictive covenants, making it one of the few areas in Detroit where Black families could purchase homes during an era of widespread housing discrimination.

Conant Gardens and its surrounding census tracts were annexed in 1916, 1921, and 1924. As Detroit's population expanded due to the growth of the automobile industry, Conant Gardens began attracting residents and emerged as an important residential community during a period of rapid urban and economic development.



Historic aerial image of the 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods
Source: Wayne State University Library System Digital Collections

Early Demographic and Racial Patterns

Population and Housing Characteristics

An examination of 1940 U.S. Decennial Census data provides important context for understanding the development of the neighborhoods during the mid-twentieth century. At the time, the area had a combined population of approximately 19,500 residents and 4,330 housing units.

The population was notably young, with most residents under age 30, and housing consisted primarily of detached single-family homes built during the 1920s. The median home value was \$3,190 (approximately \$74,644 in 2026 dollars), while median gross rent was \$37 per month (approximately \$866 in 2026 dollars).

Demographic Transition

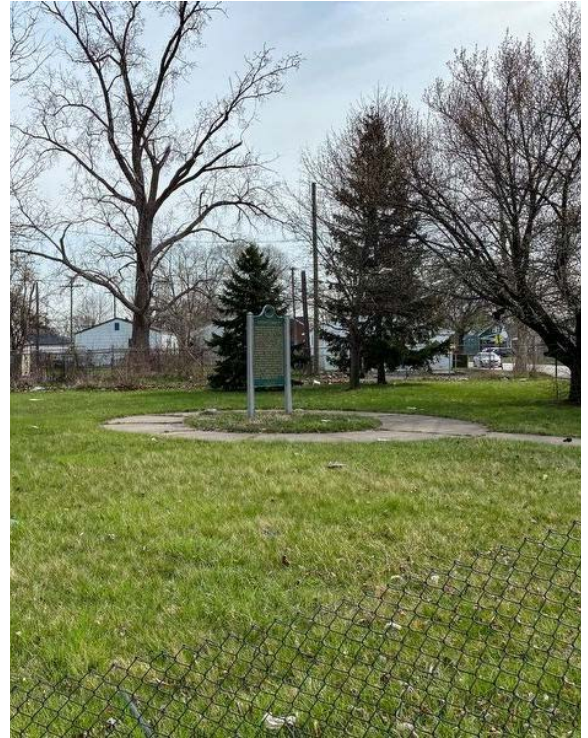
During the Second Great Migration (1940–1970), Detroit's Black population grew rapidly as African Americans migrated from the South in search of employment and greater opportunity. Conant Gardens emerged as a destination for African American professionals, business owners, and skilled workers, becoming one of Detroit's most prominent middle-class Black neighborhoods.

By 1950, the Black population in Conant Gardens had grown to more than one-third of residents, while the Northeast Central District became more than one-quarter Black. The surrounding neighborhoods, however, remained overwhelmingly white, indicating that demographic change was concentrated in specific portions of the area rather than occurring uniformly throughout the community.

Racial Composition and Distribution

The area was nearly 90% white, with over one-quarter of residents being foreign born, many of whom were Polish immigrants. Employment was closely tied to Detroit's industrial economy, with more than 40% of workers employed in manual labor or factory occupations.

Although the area was predominantly white, the Black population was concentrated in Conant Gardens, where it represented more than one-quarter of residents. In comparison, the Northeast Central District was roughly 6% Black, while Pershing, Hawthorn Park, and Nolan remained almost entirely white.



Historical sign in the Conant Gardens neighborhood
Source: *The Historical Marker Database*

Residential Conflict

The growth of Conant Gardens occurred amid significant racial tensions. Efforts by white residents in nearby communities to prevent Black families from moving into surrounding neighborhoods often included intimidation and organized resistance.

Sojourner Truth Housing Development

The Sojourner Truth Homes, located in the nearby Krainz Woods neighborhood, were constructed as a federally funded public housing project during World War II to provide housing for defense workers employed in Detroit's expanding wartime industries. Named after the renowned abolitionist and women's rights activist Sojourner Truth, the development reflected the federal government's effort to address the city's growing wartime housing shortage. However, plans to house Black defense workers there quickly made the project a focal point of Detroit's growing racial tensions.

While not located within the studied neighborhoods, this development and its history played a significant role in shaping the neighborhoods' demographic transition and broader housing patterns.

The 1942 Sojourner Truth Riot

White residents and neighborhood associations organized protests and sought to prevent Black occupancy, while African American residents and civil rights advocates fought for access to housing. Tensions culminated in violent confrontations when the first Black families moved into their houses on February 28, 1942, when hundreds of white and Black residents clashed near the project, prompting intervention by local police and the National Guard. The controversy drew national attention and highlighted the entrenched racial segregation that shaped housing opportunities throughout Detroit. Despite these challenges, Conant Gardens developed a strong tradition of civic engagement and homeownership and remains a symbol of African American resilience, achievement, and community building.



Police barricade at the Sojourner Truth riot scene
Source: Orlin Jones Collection

Neighborhood Demographic Transition

The conflicts at the Sojourner Truth housing project reflected broader pressures shaping residential patterns across the city as demographic change accelerated during the postwar period. By 1960, Conant Gardens and the Northeast Central District had become predominantly Black, with the proportion of African American residents increasing by more than 50% since 1950.

By contrast, Hawthorn Park and Nolan remained overwhelmingly white in 1960, but the following decade brought rapid demographic change. By 1970, African Americans comprised more than 90% of the population in Conant Gardens and the Northeast Central District and had become the majority population in Hawthorn Park (67%) and Nolan (61%). Even Pershing, which had remained entirely white through 1960, became 17% Black by 1970 (Social Explorer).

Lasting Legacy

These demographic shifts illustrate the rapid transformation of the neighborhoods and demonstrate how African American residents expanded beyond the boundaries of Conant Gardens into surrounding neighborhoods despite persistent barriers to housing access and neighborhood integration. The legacy of this transition is reflected not only in changing population patterns but also in the enduring strength of the community.

As Black families established roots beyond Conant Gardens, they contributed to the growth of stable neighborhoods, local institutions, and a strong tradition of homeownership and civic engagement. Together, the neighborhoods' history of industrial growth, racial segregation, community advocacy, and demographic change provides important context for understanding the area's development and the challenges and opportunities that continue to shape it today.



Civil unrest at the Sojourner Truth housing development, 1942

Source: *Finding Eliza*

Development of the 7 Mile Commercial Corridor

Growth of the Commercial District

The main commercial thoroughfare in the neighborhood, 7 Mile Road, originally served as a rural east-west highway that connected key roads throughout the region (Detroit Urbanism). Significant commercial development did not occur until the 1940s, when industrial expansion along the Mound Road corridor in neighboring Warren attracted thousands of workers to nearby neighborhoods such as Grixdale and Pershing. During World War II, the Mound Road corridor became a major center for key manufacturing and industrial plants, spurring residential growth in surrounding communities (Innovate Mound).

By that time, Conant Gardens had already established itself as a thriving enclave for Detroit's middle-class Black residents, while the surrounding neighborhoods remained less developed. As thousands of workers moved into newly built homes in Grixdale and Pershing, demand for retail services and commercial activity along 7 Mile Road increased substantially.

Since 7 Mile largely developed after the first auto boom in the 1920s, the 7 Mile corridor evolved into an auto-centric commercial district. Numerous tire shops, auto repair shops, and gas stations began to operate along this stretch. The corner of 7 Mile and Conant became home to Detroit's first strip mall during the 1940s, housing a shoe store, a men's clothing store, a drug store, and a Kresge 5 and 10 store (The Conant Gardeners).



Strip mall at the corner of 7 Mile and Conant
Source: Detroit Public Library

Decline and Disinvestment

Industrial Decline

The loss of manufacturing jobs during the 1960s and 1970s had a profound impact on the area. Automation, intensifying global competition, and the relocation of production to lower-cost regions in the South and overseas all contributed to the closure or departure of many industries along Mound Road. As these facilities shut down, thousands of well-paying industrial jobs disappeared, reducing household incomes and weakening the local tax base.

Population and Commercial Decline

The loss of stable employment led to steady population decline as workers and their families moved elsewhere in search of opportunity. With fewer residents to support them, local businesses experienced falling demand, which in turn accelerated closures and reduced commercial activity along key corridors.

Lasting Effects

Over time, this economic decline produced widespread disinvestment, rising vacancy rates, and falling property values—patterns that continue to shape portions of 7 Mile Road today.

The loss of industrial employment also weakened the economic foundation that had supported surrounding neighborhoods, making it more difficult for local businesses to remain viable and for property owners to maintain homes and commercial buildings. As vacancies increased and investment declined, portions of the area experienced deteriorating buildings, underutilized commercial properties, and reduced economic activity.

These conditions reinforced one another, as declining property values and limited private investment further reduced the resources available for neighborhood improvements and redevelopment. The effects of this long-term disinvestment remain visible in portions of the area today, particularly along commercial corridors where vacant or underutilized properties continue to present challenges to revitalization and reinvestment.



Local grocery store in the current commercial corridor

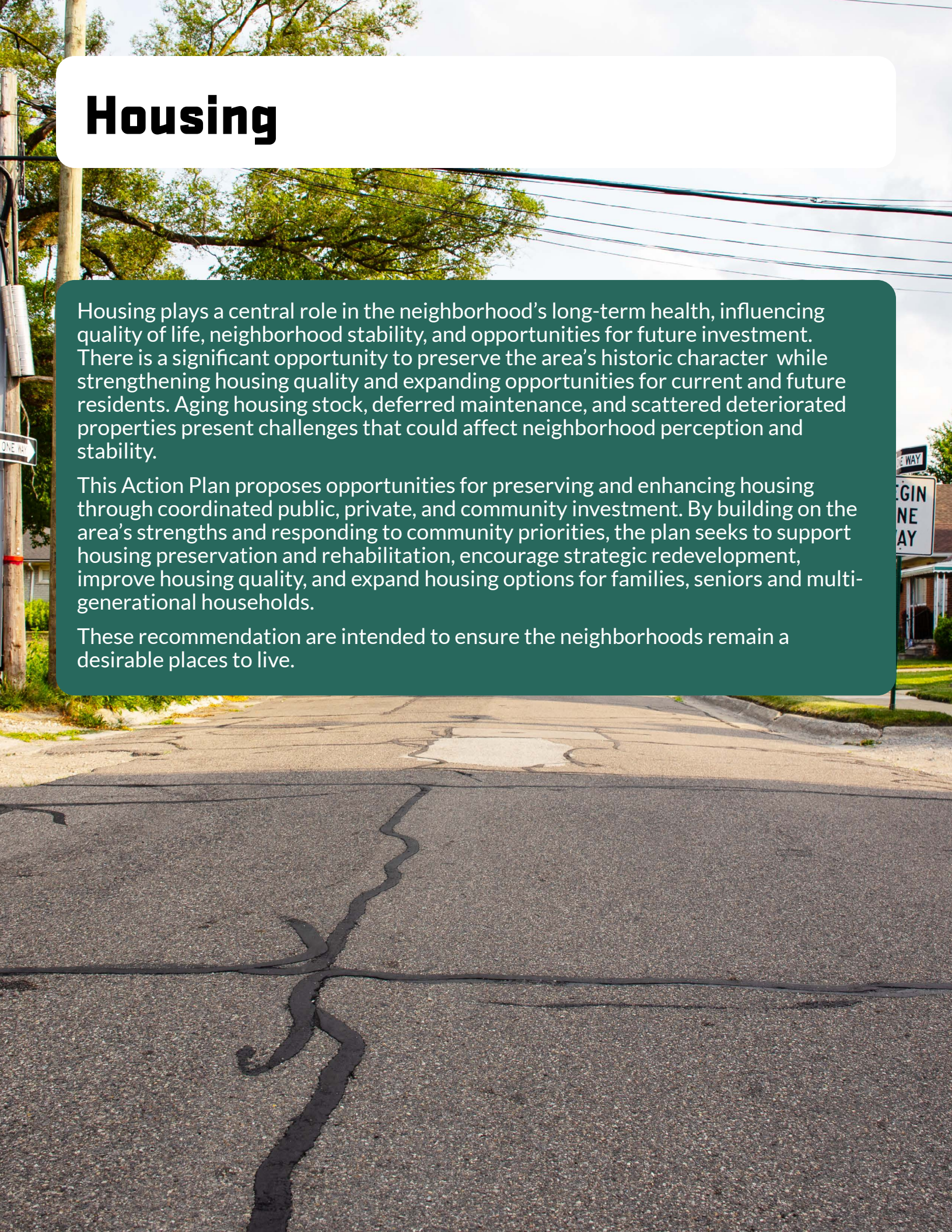
Source: Homes

Housing

Housing plays a central role in the neighborhood's long-term health, influencing quality of life, neighborhood stability, and opportunities for future investment. There is a significant opportunity to preserve the area's historic character while strengthening housing quality and expanding opportunities for current and future residents. Aging housing stock, deferred maintenance, and scattered deteriorated properties present challenges that could affect neighborhood perception and stability.

This Action Plan proposes opportunities for preserving and enhancing housing through coordinated public, private, and community investment. By building on the area's strengths and responding to community priorities, the plan seeks to support housing preservation and rehabilitation, encourage strategic redevelopment, improve housing quality, and expand housing options for families, seniors and multi-generational households.

These recommendations are intended to ensure the neighborhoods remain a desirable places to live.



Housing

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Residential street in the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhood

Neighborhood Desirability

Strong Community Identity and Residential Stability

The neighborhood possess assets that support long-term neighborhood stability and position it for continued investment. Throughout the community assessment and action plan development process, residents consistently described the neighborhood as a place defined by unity, strong social connections, and a shared commitment to rebuilding and preserving their community. Insights gathered through resident engagement and neighborhood analysis highlight a strong sense of place and collective investment in the neighborhood's future.

During the June 30th community engagement meeting, participants identified neighborhood cohesion as one of the area's defining strengths, reflecting the pride and long-term commitment of many residents. See [Appendix D](#) for more details on the community engagement session.

Residential Reinvestment and Development

Visible reinvestment is occurring throughout the area at both the neighborhood and institutional levels. Numerous residential properties showed evidence of recent improvements, including exterior renovations and active construction projects, indicating that homeowners continue to invest in maintaining and improving their properties.

In addition to reinvestment in the existing housing stock, limited construction of new single-family homes demonstrates continued residential demand and confidence in the neighborhood's future. These investments help strengthen housing quality while contributing to long-term neighborhood stability.



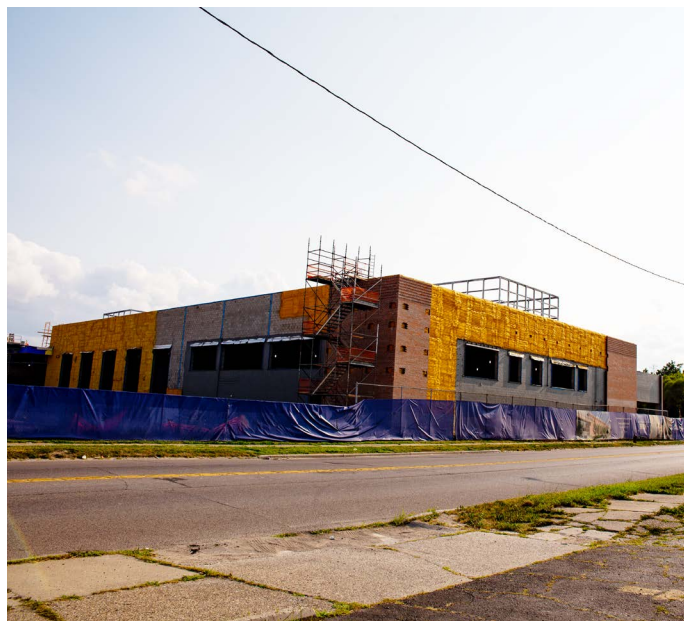
Construction in a residential area taking place in the 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhood

Investment and Neighborhood Amenities

The neighborhood is benefiting from significant public and private investment that reinforces neighborhood stability and supports future growth.

Pershing High School

The brand-new Pershing High School represents a significant investment in educational infrastructure and serves as an important community anchor. Replacing the original school that opened in 1930, the new \$77 million, 124,000-square-foot campus is part of Detroit Public Schools Community District's long-term Facilities Master Plan. The school is expected to open in 2027, reflecting continued investment in the neighborhood and supporting community vitality and educational opportunities for future generations.



Construction of the new Pershing High School in the Detroit Public Schools Community District

Senior Housing

Solomon's Village CDC's proposed senior housing and townhouse development represents another significant investment in the neighborhood. The project would redevelop the former Mason Elementary School site, transforming a property that has remained vacant for 14 years into new multi-unit housing for seniors and families.

Beyond expanding housing options, the development is expected to generate positive neighborhood spillover effects, including increased nearby property values, greater private investment, and improved neighborhood stability.

As a result, the project has the potential to serve as both a much-needed housing development and a catalyst for broader community revitalization.



The former Mason Elementary School that is proposed to be reused for a senior housing development

Neighborhood Current Conditions

Housing Style and Character

The housing character of the neighborhood reflects both its historic significance and its long-standing residential stability. Unlike many Detroit neighborhoods that experienced widespread demolition or dramatic shifts in land use, much of this area retains the physical character established during the early and mid-twentieth century.

The neighborhood remains largely residential, with blocks dominated by detached single-family homes situated on well-defined lots, connected by a traditional street grid.

Housing Types and Styles

One of the most distinctive characteristics of the area is the diversity of housing styles within a relatively compact neighborhood. The housing diversity reflects different periods of growth and illustrate the neighborhood's gradual development over several generations.

The most common housing types include:

- Modest ranch homes
- Bungalows
- Larger two-story residences

Building Materials

Brick remains the predominant exterior material throughout much of the action area, contributing to a sense of permanence and durability.

Vinyl siding, stucco finishes, and mixed-material facades are also present, often reflecting later renovations, repairs, or modernization efforts. These varied materials illustrate how residents have adapted and maintained their homes over time while preserving the neighborhood's residential character.



Common housing types throughout the 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods

Housing Age

The median year built for residential structures is 1943, indicating that much of the housing stock is now more than 80 years old. See [Table 8 in Existing Conditions](#) for more information regarding age of housing.

MAP 3. Year Housing was Built in 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhood



Housing Conditions

Housing conditions vary considerably from block to block. While many homes remain well maintained and contribute positively to neighborhood character, signs of deferred maintenance are visible throughout portions of the action area.

Common conditions observed during field observations include deteriorating facades, aging exterior materials, damaged or deteriorated porches and steps, roof deterioration, worn or peeling siding, missing or damaged gutters, broken or missing windows, and deteriorated fencing. In some cases, these conditions are present in occupied homes, suggesting that maintenance challenges may be linked to financial constraints rather than vacancy alone.

Housing Quality

While many homes are well maintained, some properties would benefit from rehabilitation or targeted investment. Housing improvements should focus on preserving existing homes, supporting routine maintenance, and ensuring that housing remains safe and livable for current residents.

See [Table 9](#) in [Existing Conditions](#) for additional information regarding complete plumbing facilities in the neighborhoods.

Neighborhood Conditions and Property Maintenance

Overall, the neighborhood contains a diverse mix of well-maintained homes, rehabilitated properties, properties under construction, and structures showing varying levels of physical deterioration. Field observations identified conditions ranging from illegal dumping and deferred maintenance to vacant, fire-damaged, and structurally deteriorated buildings.

Several properties displayed overgrown vegetation, excessive weeds, accumulated debris, and landscaping requiring routine maintenance. While these conditions are generally less costly to address than major structural rehabilitation, collectively they influence the overall appearance and perceived quality of the neighborhood.

Refer to the [Neighborhood Beautification](#) chapter for recommended strategies to address common upkeep challenges.



Houses in the neighborhood displaying extensive maintenance issues and damage

Vacancy

Although vacancy levels are lower than in many Detroit neighborhoods, the action area's vacant properties create visual inconsistencies and contribute to perceptions of disinvestment despite the overall strength of its housing stock. Vacancy is not a condition of any one section of the action area, as vacant parcels are present throughout the neighborhoods.

Vacant parcels within the action area generally fall into two categories:

- **Vacant structures** that are in severe disrepair and may require demolition or substantial rehabilitation before they can be reused.
- **Vacant land** consisting of open lots that are more immediately available for redevelopment, neighborhood improvements, or other community re-imagining efforts.

Map 4 identifies vacant structures throughout the action area. See Map 10 in the [Neighborhood Beautification](#) chapter for the companion map showing vacant parcels.

MAP 4. Vacant Structures Throughout the Neighborhood

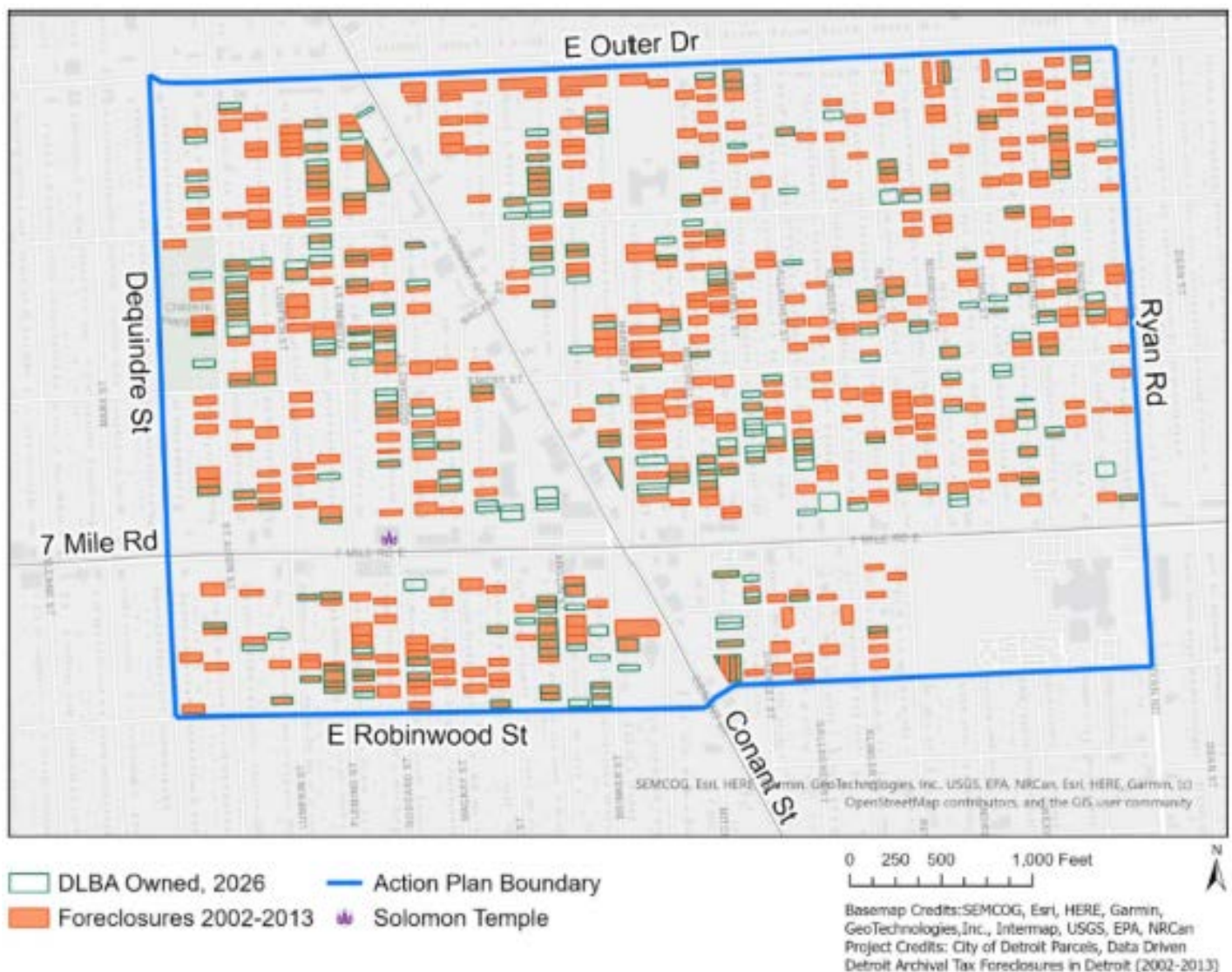


Foreclosures & Sales

Data Driven Detroit's historical tax foreclosure data shows that the 564 tax foreclosures between 2002 and 2013, roughly overlapping the national foreclosure crisis (2006-2012) were dispersed across the action area, as seen in the figure below. A quarter of the residences changed hands through a foreclosure process triggered at three years of tax delinquency. Of those 564 parcels, 146 are currently owned by the Detroit Land Bank Authority, are tax exempt and awaiting next use (See [Map 5](#)).

For more information regarding Housing and Household data, please refer to the [Housing](#) section of the Existing Conditions chapter.

MAP 5. Foreclosures in the Neighborhood: 2002-2013



Housing Maintenance and Neighborhood Enhancement

Short-Term Improvements

Many observed conditions can be addressed through incremental, low-cost improvements that collectively enhance neighborhood appearance without requiring major financial investment. Routine activities that residents, neighborhood organizations, block clubs, and volunteer groups can undertake include:

- Grass mowing and weed removal
- Seasonal landscaping and mulching
- Installation of landscape lighting
- Trimming overgrown trees and shrubs
- Porch painting and exterior touch-up painting
- Installation of decorative planters
- Updating house numbers

While modest in scale, these improvements can strengthen neighborhood pride, improve curb appeal, and reinforce ongoing property maintenance.

Long-Term Improvements

Some properties within the neighborhood require more substantial investment to restore structural integrity and preserve the long-term housing stock. Priority improvements include:

- Roof replacement
- Siding replacement
- Window replacement
- Porch reconstruction
- Rehabilitation of severely deteriorated structures

Where rehabilitation is no longer practical, strategic demolition followed by compatible infill housing or community-oriented redevelopment may be the most appropriate long-term solution.

Continued public and private investment in housing rehabilitation and neighborhood infrastructure will be essential to maintaining the area's residential character while supporting long-term neighborhood stability and reinvestment.

Policy and Program Recommendations

Neighborhood improvement efforts should be supported through policies and programs that reduce barriers to routine property maintenance and exterior rehabilitation for all Detroit residents, based on property needs.

Potential initiatives include:

- Exterior home improvement grants
- Neighborhood beautification grants
- Low-interest repair loans
- Volunteer lawn maintenance programs for low-income residents, seniors, and residents with disabilities
- Tool-lending programs that provide access to landscaping and maintenance equipment.

Educational workshops focused on preventative home maintenance, landscaping, and low-cost home improvements could further empower residents to preserve their properties before more significant maintenance occurs.



Future Opportunities

Development Opportunities

The 7 Mile and Conant neighborhood is well positioned to accommodate strategic residential growth that strengthens its established character while expanding housing opportunities for current and future residents.

As a predominantly single-family neighborhood with scattered vacant parcels and underutilized residential land, the neighborhood can leverage infill development to increase homeownership, attract new investment, and provide housing choices that meet the evolving needs of residents.

Future development should reinforce the neighborhood's historic residential identity while introducing a broader range of housing options that serve households of varying ages, incomes, and family structures.

Create a Continuum of Housing Choices

Future development should provide a continuum of housing options that enables residents to remain in the neighborhood throughout every stage of life. As household needs evolve, residents should have the opportunity to transition into housing that better matches their circumstances without leaving the community.

For example:

- **Young adults and first-time home buyers** may begin in a condominium, townhouse, accessory dwelling unit (ADU), or smaller single-family home before moving into a larger home as they establish careers or grow their families.
- **Families** may later choose homes with additional bedrooms, flexible living spaces, or multi-generational layouts that accommodate aging parents or adult children.
- **As residents grow older**, they should have access to smaller, low-maintenance homes, ranch-style residences with first-floor living, or accessible housing that allows them to age in place while remaining close to family, neighbors, and community resources.

Encourage Compatible Residential Investment

Future residential investment should prioritize housing that complements the neighborhood's existing architectural character and contributes to long-term neighborhood stability. A balanced housing strategy should combine:

- Traditional site-built homes
- Modular construction
- Thoughtfully designed "Missing Middle" housing
- Accessory Dwelling Units (ADUs)

Together, these housing types can expand housing choice while preserving the neighborhood's predominantly single-family character.

This approach will activate vacant land, support population growth, increase the local tax base, and create opportunities for families to build wealth through homeownership.



Single-Family Housing

Single-family homes should remain the predominant housing type throughout the interior residential blocks of the neighborhood. Preserving this development pattern will maintain the neighborhood's established residential identity while accommodating future growth through carefully planned infill development.

Encourage Compatible Housing Styles

Encouraging a variety of housing styles will provide housing options for a range of household sizes and incomes while maintaining architectural continuity throughout the neighborhood.

Recommended styles include:

- Ranch homes
- Bungalows
- Colonial homes
- Craftsman designs
- Contemporary interpretations of traditional Detroit architecture

Design Homes for Long-Term Flexibility

Future single-family homes should be designed with flexibility in mind to accommodate changing household needs over time.

As identified through community engagement and demographic analysis, many neighborhood households include:

- Grandparents serving as caregivers
- Adult children living with parents
- Multiple generations sharing one residence

New homes should respond to these trends by incorporating adaptable floor plans that support:

- Multi-generational living
- Aging in place
- Remote work



Source: Great Water Homes

Recommended Design Features

Future homes should incorporate:

- Three- to five-bedroom layouts
- Two or more bathrooms
- Covered front porches
- First-floor bedrooms with adjacent full bathrooms
- Flexible office or home school spaces
- Larger kitchens and family gathering areas
- Finished basements



Support Long-Term Neighborhood Stability

Designing homes that can evolve with changing family needs creates long-term value for both homeowners and the neighborhood.

Adaptable housing also strengthens neighborhood stability by:

- Encouraging long-term homeownership
- Preserving community relationships
- Creating opportunities for families to build equity
- Supporting the transfer of wealth across generations

By combining timeless architectural design with modern functionality, future single-family development can continue the neighborhood's tradition of stable homeownership while meeting the needs of future generations.



Source: Great Water Homes

Missing Middle Housing

While the neighborhood should remain predominantly composed of single-family homes, strategically introducing “Missing Middle” housing can expand housing choice without compromising the neighborhood’s established residential character.

“Missing Middle” housing refers to housing types that are between single-family homes and multi-family apartments, such as:

- Duplexes
- Triplexes
- Quadplexes

These housing types create opportunities for:

- First-time home buyers
- Young professionals
- Workforce households
- Seniors
- Multi-generational families

Maintain Neighborhood Character

All Missing Middle housing should be designed to reflect the architectural character of the surrounding neighborhood. New development should maintain:

- Residential-scale building massing
- Pitched rooflines
- Front porches
- Quality exterior materials
- Landscaped front yards
- Pedestrian-oriented entrances that reinforce the existing streetscape

Parking should be located behind buildings or screened from public view whenever feasible. Developments should incorporate attractive landscaping and shared outdoor spaces that promote neighborhood interaction.

By establishing consistent design standards, duplexes, triplexes, and quadplexes can integrate seamlessly into existing residential blocks while preserving the identity that residents value most.



Source: Zillow

Modular Housing

Modular housing offers an innovative and cost-effective approach to residential development that complements traditional site-built construction while expanding opportunities for attainable homeownership.

Modular homes are constructed in climate-controlled manufacturing facilities in multiple sections before being transported to the building site and permanently installed on traditional foundations. Built to the Michigan Residential Building Code, modular homes meet the same structural, safety, and energy-efficiency standards as conventional site-built homes and are virtually indistinguishable from traditionally constructed homes once completed.

Modular housing's ability to combine quality construction with faster production schedules makes it well suited for scattered-site infill development throughout the 7 Mile–Conant neighborhood.

Benefits of Modular Construction

Factory construction provides several advantages over conventional building methods, including:

- Reduced construction timelines
- Lower material waste
- Improved quality control
- Fewer weather-related delays

Site preparation and foundation work can occur simultaneously with factory construction, reducing overall project delivery time and lowering development costs.

These efficiencies make modular housing an attractive option for:

- First-time home buyers
- Workforce households
- Seniors
- Moderate-income families seeking quality homeownership opportunities.

Modular homes also incorporate modern energy-efficient materials, high-performance insulation, and sustainable building practices that reduce long-term operating costs and improve household affordability.



Source: InnovaLab Homes Detroit; MHInsider

Accessory Dwelling Units (ADUs)

Accessory Dwelling Units (ADUs) represent an effective strategy for expanding housing choice, improving affordability, and helping homeowners build long-term financial stability without altering the established character of the neighborhood.

ADUs are small, independent residential units located on the same lot as a primary single-family home and may take the form of:

- Detached backyard cottages
- Garage apartments
- Basement apartments
- Attached secondary suites
- Above-garage living units

Because they are integrated into existing residential properties, ADUs provide a modest increase in housing supply while preserving the neighborhood's predominantly single-family appearance. ADUs offer a flexible housing solution that benefits both homeowners and the broader community.

Support Compatible ADU Development

As the City of Detroit continues to modernize its zoning regulations to support housing affordability and neighborhood reinvestment, ADUs have the potential to become a valuable tool for established neighborhoods such as 7 Mile–Conant.

Future ADU development should comply with:

- Applicable zoning regulations
- Building codes
- Permitting requirements
- Design standards

New ADUs should complement the architectural style of the primary residence through:

- Similar building materials
- Rooflines
- Window proportions
- Landscaping

Careful attention to building placement, access, privacy, and open space will help ensure these units integrate seamlessly into existing neighborhoods while preserving the quality and character of residential streets.



Source: Woodbridge and Cass Corridor; Building an ADU

Upzoning for Density

With the new Pershing High School scheduled to open in 2027, the area immediately around it presents the best opportunity zone for residential growth within the plan area. A new school building will act as a major amenity for local real estate, especially for families with school-aged children. Living within walking distance of their child's school could attract young families and increase demand for housing.

Consider Upzoning Near Pershing High School

To take advantage of this potential increased demand, the community should consider upzoning the area directly adjacent to the new school, where all residential areas are currently zoned R1 (single-family residential). See [Map 2](#) for the current neighborhood zoning classifications.

R1 is the most restrictive type of zoning, only allowing for single-family detached housing by right. To allow families to stay close to amenities for their children, homes surrounding Pershing High School should be rezoned to R3 (low density residential), a type of zoning for low-density multi-family housing, such as:

- Single- and two-family homes
- Townhouses
- Garden apartments
- Community facilities

Residential Toolbox

For a full toolbox of resources to support residents and other community members, please see [Appendix A](#).

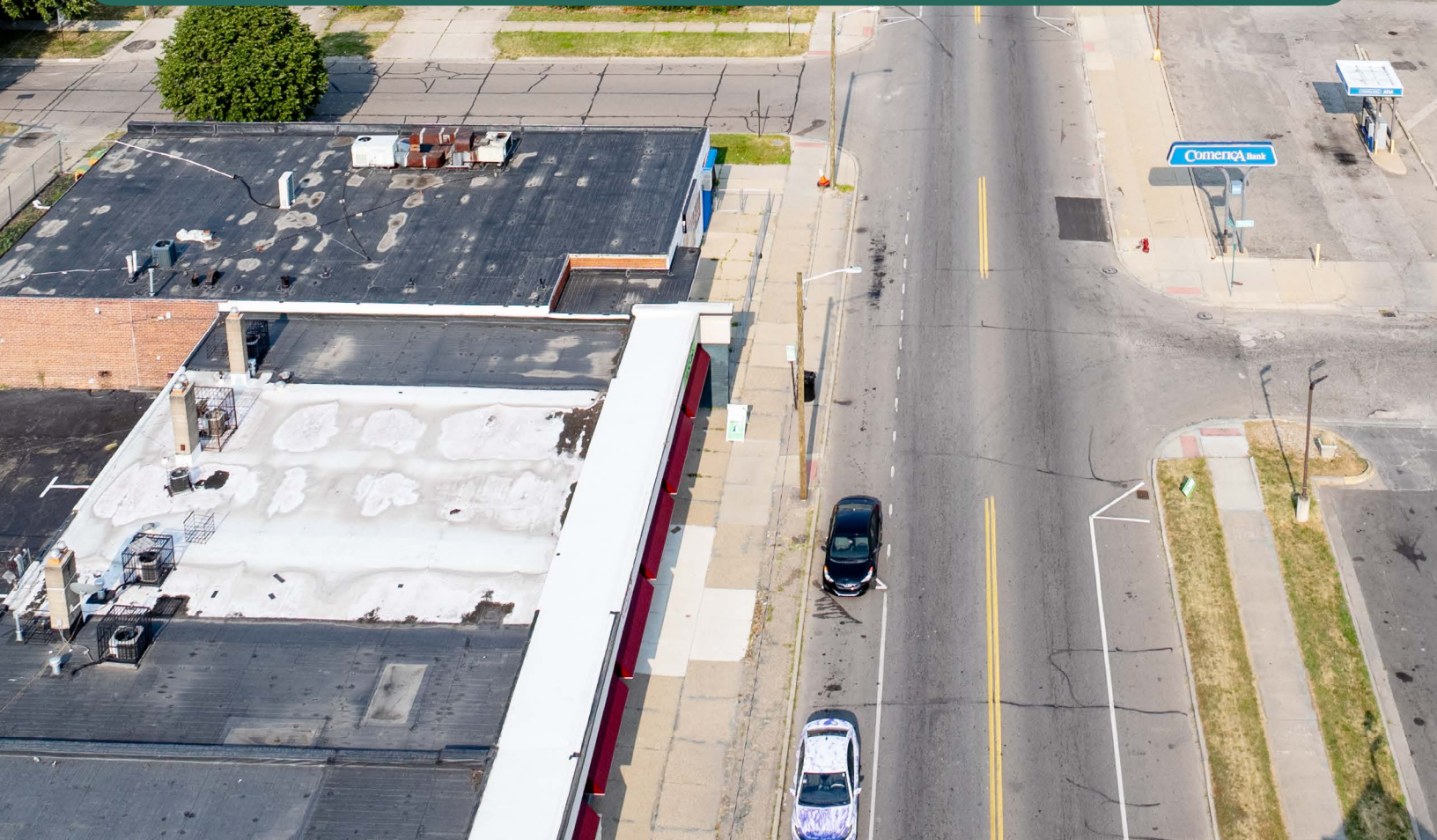


Residential street in the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhood

Commercial Development

The 7 Mile commercial corridor has the opportunity to become a stronger, more vibrant commercial destination that better serves residents, businesses, and visitors. While the area currently faces challenges related to commercial vacancy, limited business diversity, and a need for greater coordination, it has significant potential for revitalization through strategic investment, improved identity, and stronger partnerships.

Supporting new and existing businesses, enhancing the corridor's sense of place, and creating opportunities for collaboration can help foster a more connected and economically resilient commercial environment. Establishing a shared vision among businesses and community stakeholders will provide a foundation for continued growth, future improvements, and long-term corridor sustainability.



Commercial Development

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Aerial overview of the 7 Mile-Conant commercial corridor

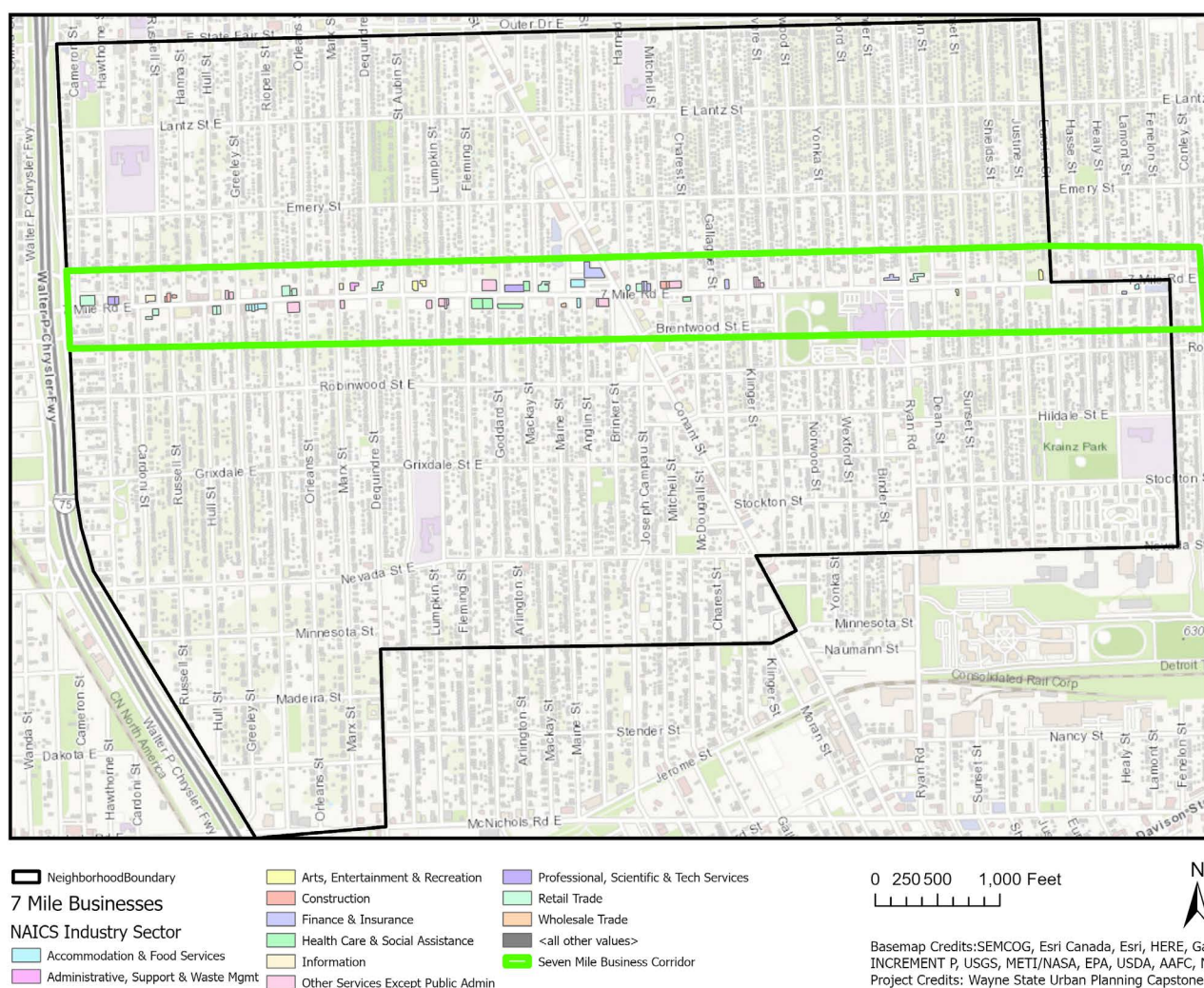
Current Uses and Needs

The existing commercial corridor, although in an optimal location, suffers from high vacancy and a lack of business diversity. For business owners in the area, property values are driven down, and low foot traffic limits their customer base. For residents, there exists a lack of vital institutions, including healthcare facilities and grocery options.

Vital institutions are essential community-serving resources that provide residents with access to basic needs, services, and opportunities that support quality of life and economic stability. The absence of these institutions further limits economic growth by driving residents to spend more dollars outside of their community. Residents are also negatively impacted by a lack of convenient and accessible institutions to meet their needs, particularly those with limited transportation options.

Map 6 below shows the boundaries of the 7 Mile commercial corridor and the types of business that currently exist within.

MAP 6. 7 Mile Commercial Corridor Boundaries



Expanding the Commercial Zone

Residents have expressed the need for vital services, particularly in the realm of healthcare and workforce development, as well as more food and entertainment options. To meet resident, business, and community desires, a two-pronged approach may be taken:

- Increase the number and diversity of businesses within the commercial corridor
- Develop larger-scale vital facilities within one mile of the corridor

Together, the commercial corridor and nearby facilities will function as an expanded commercial zone that serves residents, businesses, and institutions alike by meeting essential needs, increasing commercial activity, and presenting opportunities for partnerships.

The commercial zone will encourage a communal relationship between **residents (R)**, **business owners (BO)**, and **institutions (I)**, in which all parties participate with and benefit from the participation of the others.

TABLE 1. Benefits of Improving the Commercial Corridor

Benefit	Who Benefits
Accessibility	R, BO, I
Convenience	R, BO, I
Economic Growth	BO, I
Longevity / Stability	BO, I
Community Wellbeing	R, BO, I
Visibility	BO, I
Positive Health Outcomes	R
Partnerships	BO, I

Transportation

7 Mile Road serves as the primary transportation corridor for the neighborhood, providing connections to surrounding neighborhoods and commercial areas, while local streets support residential circulation throughout the community.

Traffic volumes are generally higher along 7 Mile Road, which also serves as an important transit route with Detroit Department of Transportation (DDOT) bus stops connecting residents to jobs, services, and other parts of Detroit. However, transit stops are relatively sparse, which limits convenient access for residents who rely on public transportation.

Pedestrian conditions are also inconsistent, with some areas offering sidewalks and crossings while others lack features such as curb ramps, lighting, and safe connections to transit stops. Improvements to sidewalks, crossings, and transit amenities would help create a safer and more accessible neighborhood.

See the sidebars on [page 45](#) for more information regarding the Complete Streets improvements that will take place along this corridor in the coming years.



Bus stop near the intersection of 7 Mile and Conant

Desired Institutions & Businesses

Expanding the range of institutions and businesses within the 7 Mile Corridor will help create a more complete and vibrant commercial environment. Adding essential services, community resources, and diverse business offerings will better meet resident needs, support local economic growth, and strengthen the corridor as a destination for the community.

Healthcare Facility



The Need

A healthcare facility is one of two high priority vital institutions to be added to the commercial zone. Residents have expressed a strong need for expanded healthcare services in the area, and providing healthcare to a multi-generational community is essential to the health and longevity of all residents, particularly seniors and children.

The Benefits

Capturing a stable patient base is essential for the longevity of a healthcare facility. Placing a facility within the corridor not only provides visibility for the institution, but also provides residents with an accessible location, aiding in retention. Residents are given a convenient option to meet more of their basic needs in a smaller area, and may choose to combine medical visits with other errands or visits to local businesses, which will also benefit from increased foot traffic.

Potential Location

While a healthcare facility (Xpress Pharmacy) does exist within the commercial corridor, as a larger-scale institution, the new development may be built within the expanded commercial zone. Although outside of the corridor, the commercial zone allows for nearby access to the most central location of other commercial goods and services.

This also presents an opportunity of partnership with the existing healthcare facility within the corridor, increasing ease of access for residents and a strengthened relationship between existing local businesses and new enterprises.

Residents have voiced a desire for development on vacant parcels 5017, 5025, and 5033 along 7 Mile Rd. These parcels are undeveloped, presenting an opportunity for a facility to be created at the scale required by the developer. These parcels are privately owned and would require rezoning from Residential to Commercial.



Potential location for a healthcare facility at 5017 7 Mile Rd. off Fenelon St.
Source: Google, Map data, Imagery 2022



Grocery



The Need

Another high-priority vital institution to be added to the commercial zone is a grocery. As of 2019, the USDA Food Access and Research Atlas (FARA) describes the Conant Gardens neighborhood as a Low Income, Low Access (LILA) Area, both with and without vehicle access.

The Benefit

Access to fresh and nutritious food options is integral to the health and wellbeing of a community's residents, and grocery stores, supermarkets, or super centers increase the economic activity within a community.

While increasing the positive health outcomes of a community does not solely hinge on the presence of a grocer, adding a larger-scale grocery store or supermarket within the commercial zone offers an opening for a health-based inter-community partnership with other institutions and businesses.

Business owners and institutions benefit from a shared customer/patient base and increased foot traffic in the area, while residents benefit from more positive health outcomes and a sense of community care.

WHAT IS A LOW INCOME, LOW ACCESS (LILA) AREA?

The United States Department of Agriculture defines a Low-Income, Low Access Area (LILA) as a neighborhood where many residents have limited access to supermarkets.

A community is considered low access when residents live:

- **More than 0.5-1 mile** from the nearest supermarket **without access to a vehicle**, or
- **More than 20 miles** from the nearest supermarket with vehicle access

Why its important: Limited access to healthy food is linked to increased risks of poor nutrition, chronic diseases, and adverse mental health outcomes.

Community Education Center



The Need

The remaining institution to be added within the commercial zone is a community education center. Residents expressed a need for a space where all members of the community can meet and build relationships, as well as a space for educational programming. A community center can address these needs by providing a large-scale, central location that is focused on community building and programmatic efforts.

Combined, the community center will serve as a center for both community building, as well as three informational sectors:

- **Workforce development:** Where residents can learn about entrepreneurship and employment resources and opportunities, including vocational and technical skills.
- **Inter-generational learning and youth programming:** Where seniors can teach younger members of the community life skills, such as sewing or cooking.
- **Homeownership education:** Where members of the community may learn financial literacy and the foundations of homeownership, including the buying process and property taxes, and homeownership resources.

The Benefit

A community center is a valuable tool for building and maintaining relationships by allowing residents a space to meet, learn, and share in community. For a multi-generational community, this bridges the gap between older and younger residents, ushering in understanding and trust. Beyond these community-building benefits, the center would provide meaningful opportunities for residents of all ages.

- **All Residents:** Access to workforce development opportunities assist in increasing skills and employment seeking, and homeownership education provides knowledge in navigating buying, owning, and maintaining a home.
- **Seniors:** Intergenerational educational opportunities help to combat social isolation and help to maintain and improve cognitive skills.
- **Youth:** Third spaces offer a location to socialize safely and are beneficial to healthy development.

Potential Location

Located just outside of the commercial corridor, 4120 E. 7 Mile Rd. is a two-story, 22,500 sq. ft. vacant commercial property across from Pershing High School. Already zoned commercial, this vacant building provides an opportunity for a community center close to the commercial center of the community. This lot and property are privately owned and would need to be purchased for use.



Potential community center at 4120 7 Mile Rd.

Dining



The Need

Successful commercial corridors offer a bundle of mixed-usages, including dining options. Residents have found a lack of these businesses within the community and within the corridor, as there are few dining options outside of fast casual and fast-food restaurants.

Sit-down restaurants and cafes/coffee shops offer a draw to the corridor for residents and visitors alike and will assist in bolstering business variety and filling vacant structures and parcels in the area.

The Benefit

Adding a variety of dining options to the corridor will provide several benefits to residents and business owners. These options add to the vibrancy of the commercial corridor, increasing visitation to the neighborhood, and driving foot traffic for other businesses.

Local businesses looking for a brick-and-mortar storefront can find a stable customer base from the residents. These businesses extend the operating hours of the corridor beyond standard working hours, with cafes and coffee shops operating in the early morning and dine-in restaurants operating into the evening.

Residents will be able to find a diversity of options within their own neighborhood, adding to their enjoyment of the community.

Financial Institution



The Need

To aid in the economic growth of the community, a financial institution should be added. As a historically under-resourced area, the neighborhood may further benefit from financial institutions who provide alternatives to the stricter requirements of traditional banks. These types of institutions include but are not limited to community development banks and credit unions, which provide affordable loans and credit for individuals and businesses, and provide financial counseling and literacy services to members.

Currently, there is one ATM located within the corridor, but residents must leave the area to seek a larger financial institution, such as a credit union or bank, elsewhere.

The Benefits

Adding a financial institution, particularly one that is locally owned and operated, will provide multiple benefits for the community. The addition of a financial institution within the corridor helps to create a holistic commercial hub with more opportunities for commercial activity outside of food, entertainment, and retail.

Local institutions tend to reinvest more funds directly into the neighborhood they are located in, and provide financial opportunities for local businesses, which both aids and sustains economic growth.

The addition of a financial institution also helps to increase safety in the community by lowering perceived danger, which in turn, drives more traffic to the corridor and the community.

7 Mile Corridor Marketing Plan

Summary

Positioned between Dequindre and Ryan, the 7 Mile Corridor serves as a critical northern connector. However, like many Detroit commercial corridors, it suffers from retail leakage which occurs when local residents spend their money on goods and services outside of the community. The 7 Mile Corridor seeking ways to mitigate commercial vacancy, and a high concentration of auto-centric or unvaried businesses.

Establishing a recognizable identity through branding, signage, wayfinding, and coordinated marketing will help combat these challenges while creating a stronger sense of place for both residents and business owners.

Complete Street Improvements & Business Coordination

The planned Complete Streets improvements, which are slated to begin in 2027 or 2028, will include curb bump-outs, high visibility cross walks, refuge medians, and improved signage. While these improvements are sorely needed to improve the road conditions of 7 Mile, they also introduce a double-edged sword and provide a dual opportunity for Solomon's Village CDC.

WHAT ARE COMPLETE STREETS?

Complete Streets is a transportation planning and design approach that considers the needs of all roadway users, including pedestrians, bicyclists, transit riders, and motorists.

Rather than focusing only on vehicle movement, Complete Streets emphasizes creating safer, more accessible, and better-connected transportation networks that support how people travel through and interact with their communities.

While it causes short-term operational disruption, these improvements offer a clean slate and a natural organizing catalyst to bring business owners together, establish a Small Business Association (SBA), and lay the groundwork for a formal Business Improvement Zone (BIZ) in the future. Details regarding Small Business Associations and Business Improvement Zones are included in later sections of this chapter.

COMPLETE STREETS AND 7 MILE ROAD

For the 7 Mile Road corridor, Complete Streets improvements focus on enhanced protection, which uses permanent physical infrastructure, such as curb bump-outs, separated bike lanes, and pedestrian refuge islands, to shield vulnerable road users from fast traffic. These designs prioritize safety, reduce speeds, and prevent severe crashes.

For more information regarding the scope and timeline of the project, please email ss4adetroitmi.gov



Source: Engage PGH

7 Mile Corridor Action Plan Outline (Dequindre to Ryan Rd)

Step 1: Construction Survival & Business Community Building

Timeline: During construction (approximately 1-2 years)

Before launching heavy branding campaigns, the immediate priority should be to protect existing businesses from construction disruption and using that shared challenge to build committee. Several City of Detroit departments could be involved in this campaign, including the Department of Neighborhoods, DEGC, as well as the Planning and Development Department.

“Open During Construction” Joint Marketing

Develop a joint marketing campaign that reminds residents and visitors that businesses remain open throughout construction.

Potential strategies include:

- Shared social media promotions
- Temporary yard signs
- Directional parking maps identifying rear-alley and side-street access
- Coordinated advertising among corridor businesses

Connect Businesses to Available Resources

Introduce business owners to programs such as Motor City Match, Invest Detroit, and other micro-loan opportunities that can help stabilize operations during construction. A list of these resources can be found in [Appendix B](#).



Construction taking place along 7 Mile Rd

Step 2: Corridor Branding & Neighborhood Marketing

Timeline: 1-3 years

As streetscape improvements take physical shape, the priority should shift from protecting existing businesses to actively promoting the corridor as a destination.

Establish a Distinct Corridor Identity

Develop a unified brand that reflects the identity of the neighborhood. Examples could include:

- The Historic Northside
- Seven-Mile Junction
- A brand inspired by Pershing High School or Conant Gardens

The branding effort should include a logo, color palette, typography, and messaging that can be used consistently throughout the corridor.

Façade Improvement & Cohesive Visuals

Coordinate future façade improvement projects with the established corridor brand. Building colors, awnings, signage, and exterior improvements should complement the streetscape materials installed by the City.

Vacancy Activation

Partner with local Detroit artists to install temporary murals or branded window graphics in vacant storefronts. Activating vacant spaces helps reduce the appearance of disinvestment while reinforcing the corridor's identity.

Business Recruitment Marketing

Develop an economic development “pitch-kit” that includes:

- Existing neighborhood spending power
- Demographic information
- Commercial opportunities
- Desired business types, such as sit-down restaurants, bakeries, cafés, specialty retail, and neighborhood services

This information can be used to recruit businesses that address gaps in the current commercial mix.

BRANDING GUIDE EXAMPLE: “THE JUNCTION”

The Junction will celebrate the stretch of 7 Mile as a historic connector of deep-rooted residential neighborhoods and a gateway to Detroit's northern border.

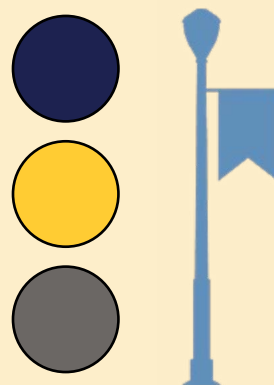
- **Brand voice:** Resilient, welcoming, and authentic
- **Target Audience:** Nearby residents who take pride in their community; local entrepreneurs

Color Scheme

Pershing Blue (Primary)
Junction Gold (Secondary)
Concrete Gray (Accent)

Light Pole Banners

- Merchant Banners with “The Junction” branded logo
- Legacy Banners “Home of the Doughboys”



Source: Beverly Hills, MI Master Plan

Step 3: Street Signage, Light Pole Banners, & Wayfinding

Timeline: 3-6 years

As branding efforts mature, implement permanent physical improvements that reinforce the identity of the corridor and improve navigation for residents and visitors.

Light Pole Banner Program

Coordinate with the city during the streetscape improvements to ensure new light poles are rated for banner brackets.

Coordinate with the City during streetscape construction to ensure new light poles are designed to accommodate banner brackets.

Banner designs should alternate between:

- Corridor branding and logos
- Neighborhood history
- Business categories such as “Shop Local” and “Dine 7 Mile”

Gateway Signage

Install gateway markers at the primary entrances to the commercial corridor:

- 7 Mile Road & Dequindre
- 7 Mile Road & Ryan

These markers communicate that visitors are entering a distinct, well-maintained commercial district.

Pedestrian Wayfinding

Install pedestrian-scaled wayfinding signage directing visitors to:

- Public parking areas
- Pershing High School
- Neighborhood parks
- Community destinations
- Major corridor businesses

Improved wayfinding encourages walking, increases visibility for businesses, and strengthens connections between neighborhood assets.



Gateway (left) and wayfinding (right) signage found throughout Detroit
Source: Detroit Free Press; Input for Wayne

Business Association

Introduction

Currently there is no formal or informal Business Association within the commercial corridor. As a result, activities appear to be disjointed, with each entity operating independently. Establishing a Business Association would unite commercial businesses within the community, specifically along the 7-Mile Corridor between Ryan and Dequindre, to strengthen the economic position and capitalize on growth opportunities.

Establishing a Business Association within a recommended timeline of 1-3 years would strengthen relationships among new and existing businesses while supporting continued economic growth.

What is a Business Association?

A Business Association is the organization of a group of businesses that join to form standards and norms that protect and promote their common interests and goals. The organization is also funded by the collective.

It is recommended that local businesses and community organizations collaborate in an effort to effectively execute the mission of the community at large. It is also encouraged that community services and the Business Association be housed in the same building as proposed in the Community Development portion of the report at 4120 7 Mile, as proposed on [page 42](#).

Benefits of a Business Association

There are several benefits to operating as a business association, including:

- Establishing uniform standards and policies
- Sharing educational opportunities, responsibilities, and resources
- Increasing visibility and credibility through association membership
- Providing discounts and collective purchasing benefits between members
- Creating networking opportunities and business referrals
- Supporting cooperative economics to meet shared economic, social, and cultural goals through jointly controlled initiatives
- Encouraging cohesive facade improvements and structural design that strengthens the identity of the commercial corridor



The Royal Palace strip mall that is owned by Solomon's Village CDC

How to Implement a Business Association

Step 1: Determine the Organizational Structure

The two most common types of Business Association are:

Limited Liability Company (LLC) or Partnership

- Best for for-profit operations
- Flexible oversight/rules that nonprofit requires
- \$50 to register with Michigan Department of Licensing and Regulatory Affairs (LARA)

Nonprofit Corporation (501(C)(4))

- Tax exempt and focus advocacy and networking
- Governed by a board of directors selected by the members

Step 2: Establish Founding Members

Recruit three to five business owners to determine the mission of the organization and establish the initial Board of Directors.

Responsibilities include:

- Preparing bylaws
- Developing the mission statement
- Defining the association's geographic boundaries

[How to Start a Nonprofit | Michigan Nonprofit Association](#)

Step 3: Register the Organization

Register the Business Association with business with Michigan Department of Licensing and Regulatory Affairs (LARA). The fee is \$20.

[Forms | MiBusiness Registry Portal](#)

[Licensing and Regulatory Affairs](#)

Step 4: Register for Taxes

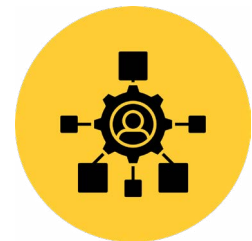
Complete registration with the Michigan Department of Treasury.

[Michigan Department of Treasury - Taxes](#)

Step 5: Obtain Local City Clearances

Obtain all required business licensing and approvals from the City of Detroit.

[Business Licensing | City of Detroit](#)



Business Improvement Zone (BIZ)

After business owners have worked together through an informal Business Association for approximately 5–10 years, the next step is to establish a Business Improvement Zone (BIZ). A BIZ is the natural evolution of a strong and trusted Business Association and allows businesses to pursue more ambitious corridor improvements than are possible through an informal organization alone.

What is a BIZ?

A BIZ is a tool that cities can use to promote economic development along a specific corridor or within a defined geographic area. Through a special assessment on commercial properties within the district, the BIZ receives a dedicated budget that can be used to implement projects and programs that support the long-term growth and maintenance of the commercial corridor.

Unlike an informal Business Association, which relies on voluntary participation and periodically pooled resources, a BIZ provides consistent annual funding, a formal governance structure, and greater capacity to undertake large-scale improvements.

Why create a BIZ?

A Business Association supports smaller collaborative efforts among businesses, while a Business Improvement Zone (BIZ) enables larger-scale investments and corridor improvements. The following illustrate the types of activities that may be pursued through each approach:

Business Association

Allows businesses to pursue smaller collaborative initiatives through shared participation and resources, including:

- Shared service agreements
- Shared parking agreements
- Joint landscaping equipment purchases
- Small-scale corridor signage and wayfinding
- Coordinated marketing efforts

Business Improvement Zone (BIZ)

Expands business collaboration by providing dedicated financial resources and a formal organizational structure for larger initiatives, including:

- Corridor security
- Façade improvement grant programs
- Community murals and public art
- Streetscape and infrastructure improvements
- Commercial property acquisition and redevelopment
- Ongoing corridor marketing and beautification

ADDITIONAL BIZ BENEFITS

Beyond physical improvements, a BIZ gives businesses a stronger collective voice when applying for grants, advocating for public investment, or working with the City of Detroit, the Michigan Economic Development Corporation, and philanthropic organizations.

Potential Programs of a BIZ

Corridor Maintenance

- Contract landscaping services
- Beautify green spaces
- Remove graffiti
- Commission public art and murals
- Maintain corridor appearance year-round



Event Planning

- Outdoor markets
- Retail promotions
- Community festivals
- Career fairs in partnership with Pershing High School
- Seasonal neighborhood events



Commercial Development

- Offer façade improvement grants
- Purchase and redeveloping vacant commercial properties
- Whitebox commercial spaces for future tenants
- Assist businesses with permitting and land use approvals



Business District Marketing

- A district logo
- A business district website
- Social media platforms
- Promotional materials
- Community event calendars



How to Implement a BIZ

As a long-term goal, creating the 7 Mile-Conant BIZ can be broken down into three phases:

Phase 1: Strengthen the Business Association

Establishing a BIZ is a long-term objective that depends on building trust and collaboration among business owners through a successful Business Association.

The first step is to create a strong foundation for ongoing collaboration by:

- Determining meeting schedules that encourage regular participation and establish a consistent meeting cadence.
- Building trust through collaborative problem-solving, shared investments, small joint projects, and consistent communication.
- Developing early leaders who organize meetings, develop agendas, and coordinate activities, positioning them as strong candidates for future BIZ leadership.

Phase 2: Explore BIZ formation

Once the Business Association is well established, begin discussions regarding the creation of a Business Improvement Zone.

This phase includes:

- Defining district boundaries
- Preparing a BIZ plan
- Developing a special assessment formula
- Obtaining petitions from at least 30% of property owners within the proposed district
- Working with the City of Detroit to establish the district under Michigan's Business Improvement Zone Act

Phase 3: Launch the BIZ

After approval, business and property owners nominate a Board of Directors to oversee the organization.

The Board then administers:

- Beautification projects
- Corridor security
- Marketing initiatives
- Grant programs
- Commercial redevelopment projects
- Annual budgeting and financial oversight



Funding and Special Assessment

The annual assessment paid by commercial properties to fund improvements will depend on the level and scope of services the business community agrees to provide. The assessment formula should ultimately reflect the priorities and financial capacity of the business and property owners within the district.

TABLE 2. Costs per Desired Services

Assessment	Estimated Annual Budget	Potential Services
\$0.25 per sq. ft.	~\$45,000	Basic maintenance and corridor security
\$0.50 per sq. ft.	~\$90,000	Maintenance, security, façade grants, and redevelopment assistance
\$0.75 per sq. ft.	~\$135,000	Full maintenance, redevelopment, grants, marketing, and expanded programming

Commercial Development Toolbox

For a full toolbox of resources available to support business owners and other community members, please see [Appendix B](#).

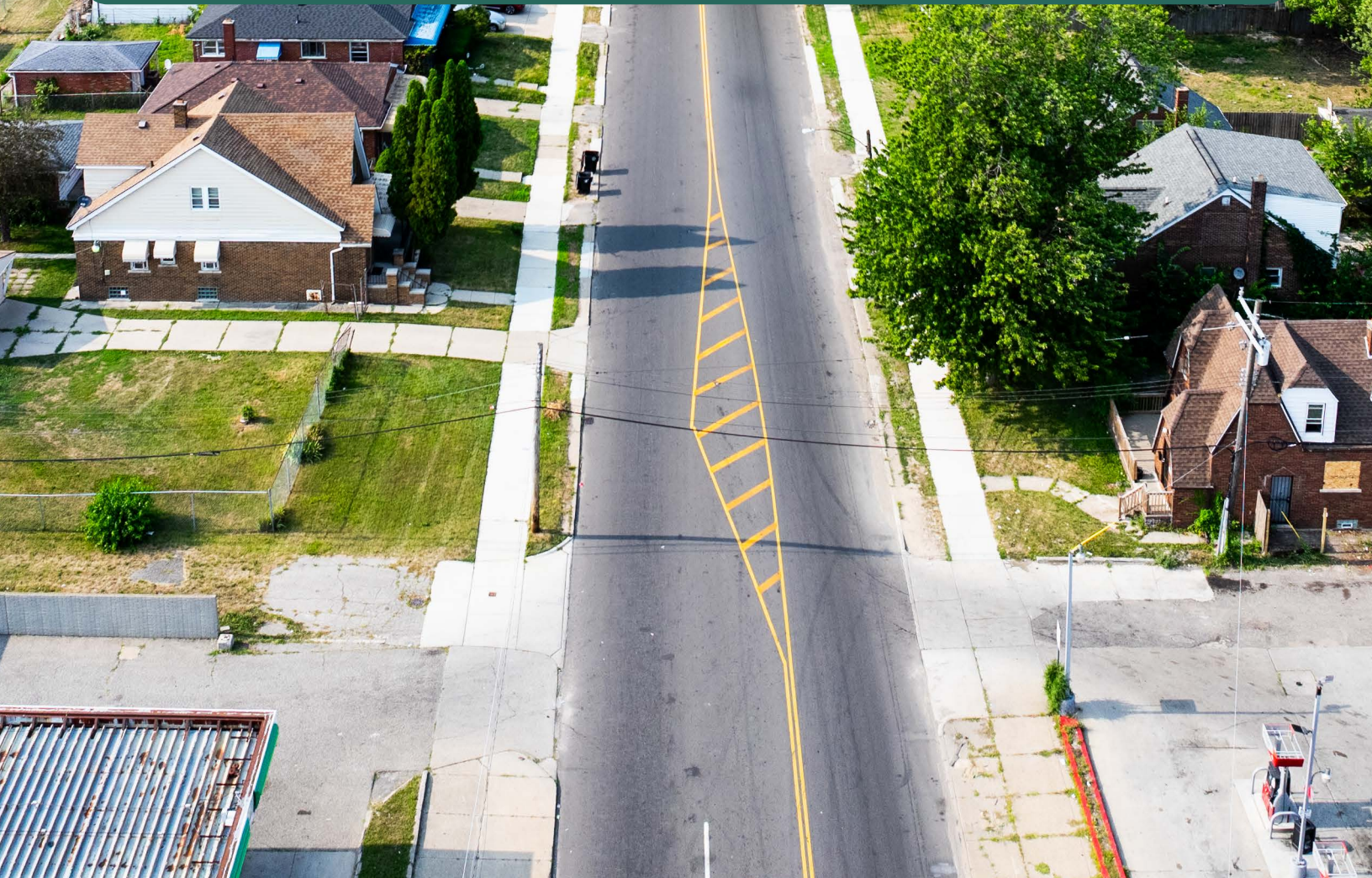


Businesses along the 7 Mile commercial corridor

Neighborhood Beautification

The success of the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhood is largely due to dedication of neighborhood organizations, the commitment of long-term residents, and the desirability of its housing stock and location. To preserve this stability while enhancing residents' quality of life, this section outlines three key strategies that neighborhood organizations and residents can pursue:

1. Expand and improve parks and public green space
2. Protect property values by making home maintenance more accessible
3. Invest in public infrastructure and neighborhood amenities, creating a safer and greener neighborhood



Neighborhood Beautification

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Promoting Public Parks and Public Green Space

Parks and public green spaces serve as essential community assets, providing places to walk, run, bike, play, experience nature, and gather with friends, family, and neighbors. Beyond the social and recreational factors, these spaces contribute to improved physical and mental health, community cohesion, and neighborhood identity.

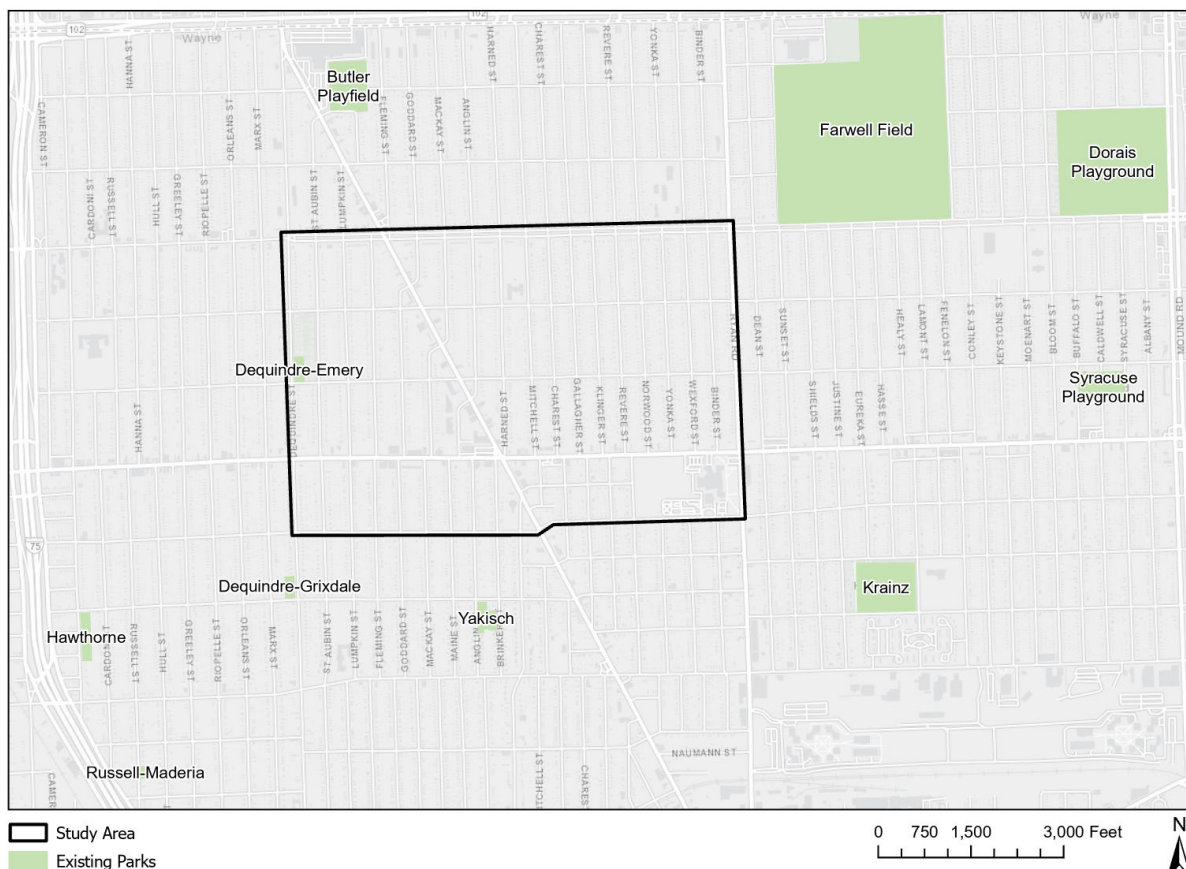
Research consistently shows that neighborhoods with well-maintained parks often experience greater residential stability and improved long-term health outcomes. Consequently, opportunities to preserve, enhance, or expand parks and green spaces represent valuable investments in the future of the 7 Mile and Conant neighborhoods.

Community engagement efforts revealed a strong desire among residents for more beautiful public spaces, increased opportunities for social interaction, and greater access to nature. Parks and green spaces address these three priorities by creating welcoming environments where natural landscapes can flourish while providing attractive and accessible spaces for residents to gather, exercise, and foster stronger community connections.

Existing Parks and Open Space

The 7 Mile-Conant neighborhood currently contains several parks and open spaces of varying size and amenities, both within the community and the surrounding area. Despite the nearby recreational resources, only one park exists within the action area itself, and there is limited tree canopy coverage overall. These existing assets are illustrated in [Map 7](#) and [Map 8](#).

MAP 7. Existing Parks in the Vicinity of the Neighborhood



Esri, HERE, SEMCOG, Esri, HERE, Garmin, GeoTechnologies, Inc., USGS, EPA, NRCAN
Project Credits: Data Driven Detroit, SEMCOG.



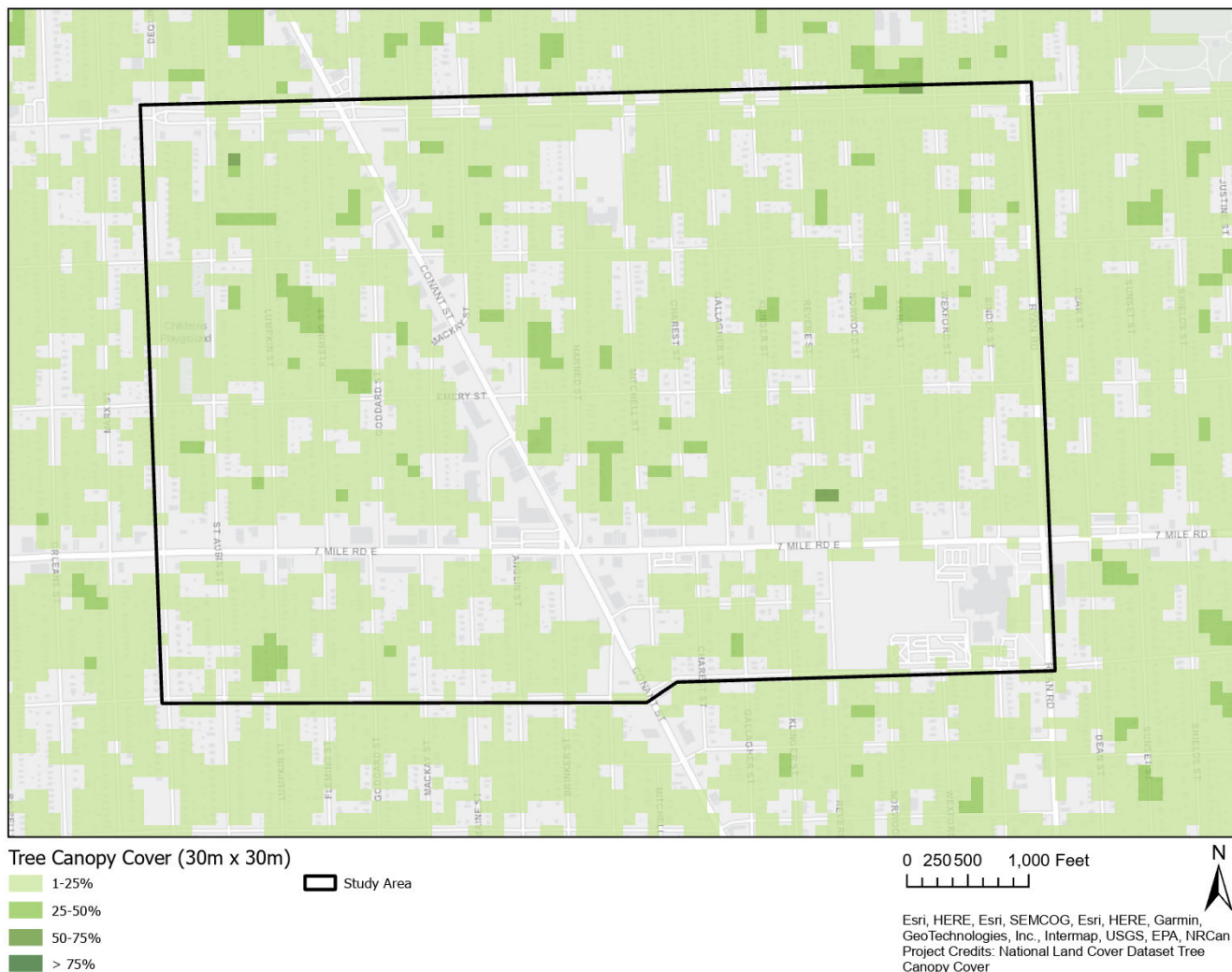
Tree Canopy Coverage

SEMCOG's Climate and Resilience goals include reaching a tree canopy of at least 40% in all urban census tracts. This number was determined by the U.S. Forest Service as the minimum tree canopy (where possible) for healthy neighborhoods.

According to the National Land Cover Dataset (NLCD), most 30-meter by 30-meter land cells within the action area have less than 25% tree canopy. Areas with 25–50% tree cover comprise only a small portion of the neighborhood, while areas exceeding 50% tree cover are even less common ([Map 8](#)).

While residents currently have access to some tree canopy and greenery, there are no nodes or corridors of greenery within the action area. Residents have daily access to a marginal amount of greenery but must make trips outside of the neighborhood for access to true public greenspace.

MAP 8. Tree Canopy Coverage in the Neighborhood



Note: Data collected between 2021-2024

Benefits of Tree Canopy

Trees not only add beauty and increased quality of life, but they are also important for environmental hazard mitigation such as flooding, heat island effect, and air pollution. They can provide pedestrians with protection from vehicle traffic as well.

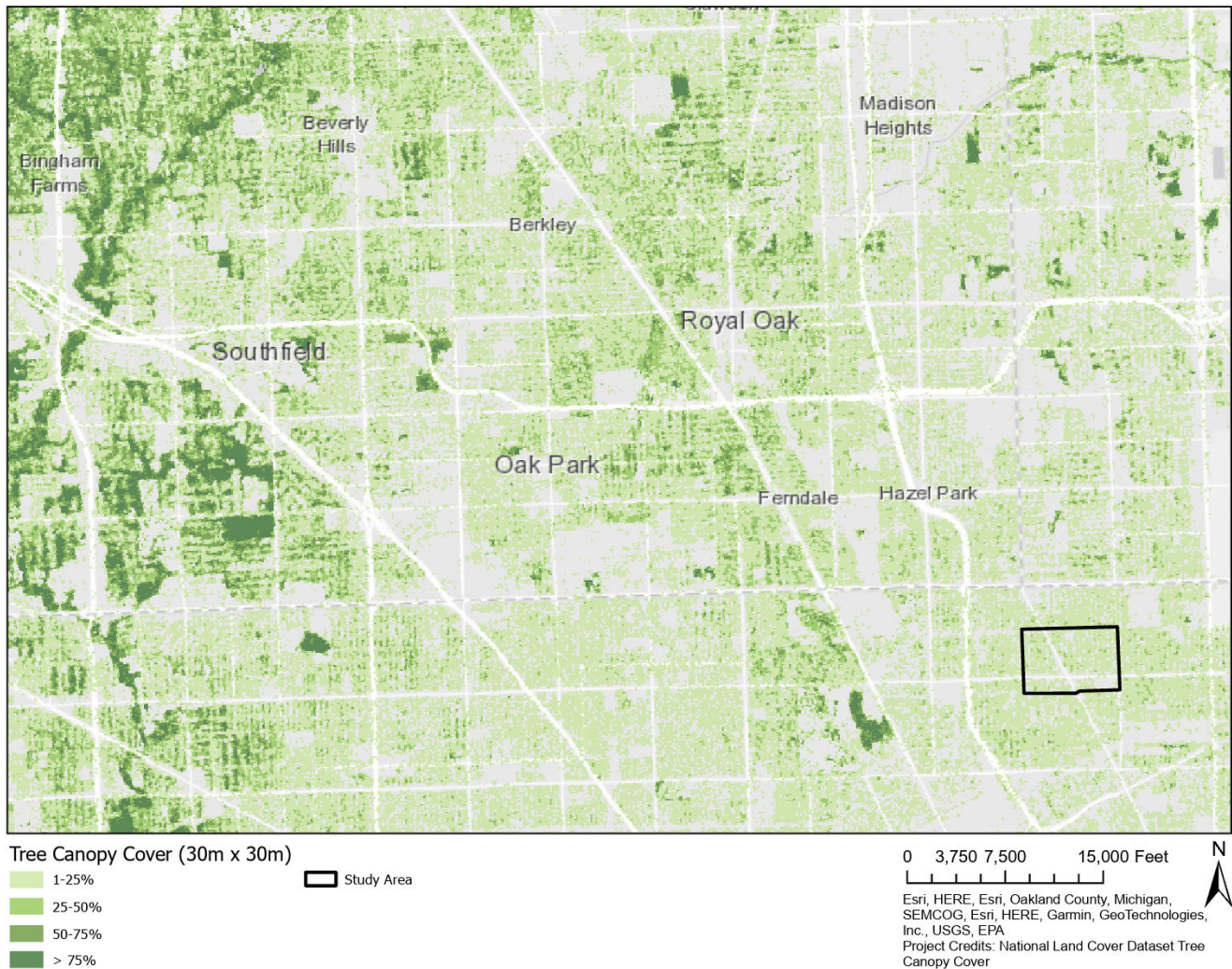
Although the level of canopy coverage in the 7 Mile and Conant neighborhoods is generally consistent with many Detroit neighborhoods, it is noticeably lower than that of nearby suburban communities such as Oak Park, Ferndale, and Royal Oak, where residential areas typically exhibit substantially greater tree coverage (see [Map 9](#)).

Citywide Tree Canopy Initiatives

The City of Detroit has considered this issue and set a broad goal across neighborhoods to increase tree canopy. Many of Detroit's Neighborhood Framework Plans include goals for expanding tree canopy coverage including [Rosa Parks and Clairmount](#), [Grand River - Northwest](#), [Russell Woods/Nardin Park](#), and [Greater Warren/Connor](#).

Additionally, the City has established resources to aid residents in expanding tree coverage in their neighborhood, including the [General Services Division's Request a Tree application](#), and the [Detroit Tree Partnership's Community Tree Planting Application](#).

MAP 9. Tree Canopy within the Action Area and Region



Note: Data was collected between 2021 and 2023

Lack of Access to Parks and Open Space Based on Walking Distance

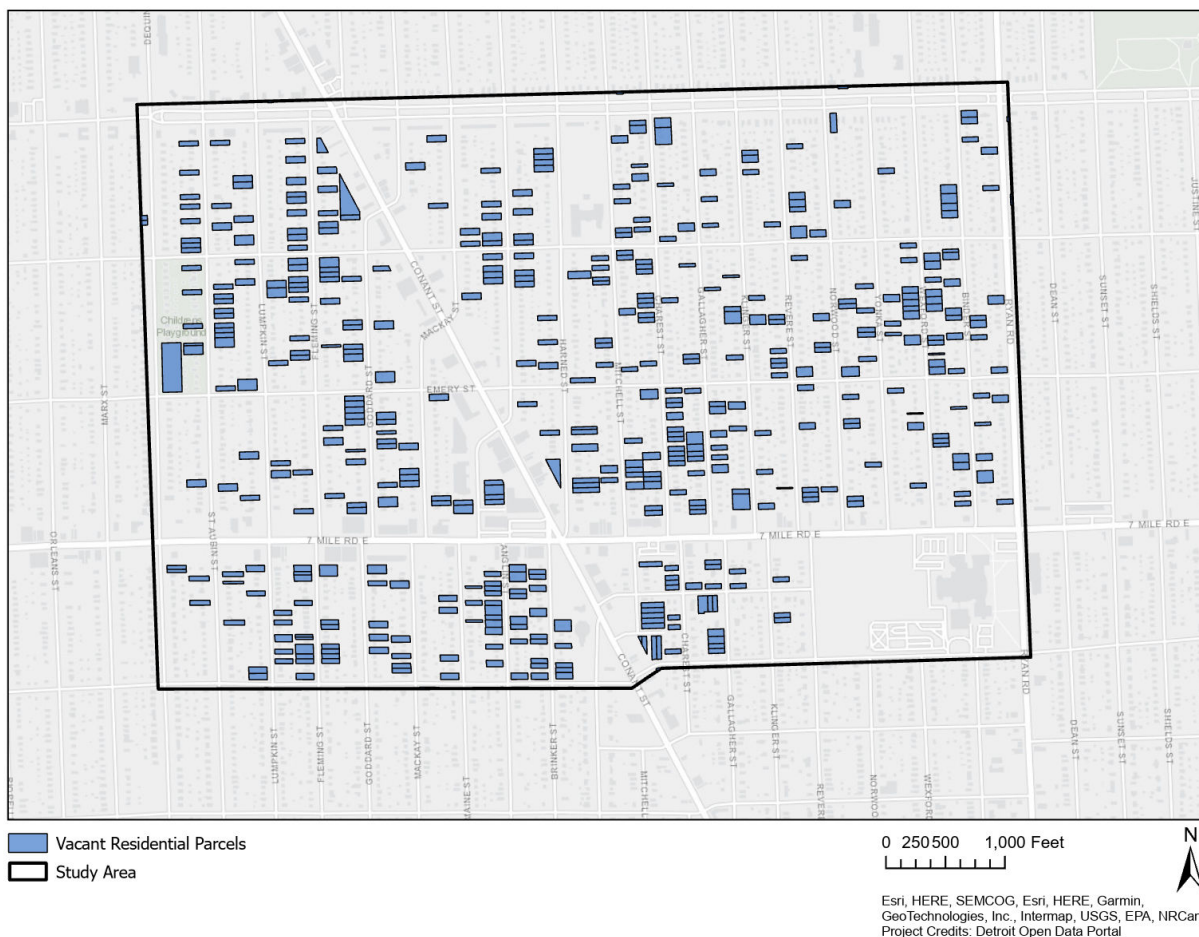
Due to the lack of parks within the action area, many residents must travel outside the neighborhood to access recreational and green spaces. Historical patterns of racial and social inequity oftentimes create differences in access to amenities such as parks and greenspace infrastructure. As such, in pursuing an equitable future from the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhood, in the face of all manner of past inequities, current and future access to these amenities should be prioritized. Further, addressing potential historic inequities helps to reduce access barriers such as mobility constraints, pedestrian safety concerns, and inadequate walkability.

Expanding the number of neighborhood parks, community gardens, and public gathering spaces would improve access to recreation and nature while supporting residents' physical, mental, and social well-being. Locating these amenities within walking distance of homes reduces travel time and makes them more accessible for children, older adults, and individuals with limited mobility, as well as encourages more frequent use of neighborhood green spaces.

Vacant Parcel Opportunities

According to the City of Detroit Open Data Portal, the action area contain 506 vacant residential parcels (Map 10). While some are individual parcels, others form clusters large enough to accommodate small parks, recreational space, or community gardens. These vacant parcels represent an opportunity to transform underutilized land into valuable neighborhood assets.

MAP 10. Vacant Residential Parcels in the Neighborhood



Proposed Pocket Parks

The National Recreation and Park Association (NRPA) defines pocket parks as small-scale urban open spaces that provide safe, inviting environments for nearby residents. Despite their small size, they can accommodate a range of uses.

Community engagement identified a strong desire for additional neighborhood green space, and spatial analysis confirmed a lack of walkable park access. In response, five locations were identified for new pocket parks based on the availability of contiguous vacant land and their distance from existing parks. Each proposed park is located at least one-half mile away from the nearest existing park, helping to improve access to recreation and green space throughout the neighborhood. [Map 11](#) illustrates existing and proposed park locations, along with walking distances to existing parks.

The following are different programs the neighborhood could utilize to develop pocket parks:

Create a Project

The Detroit Land Bank Authority also offers a [Create-a-Project](#) program, which allows legally recognized community groups to utilize vacant property to create small-scale neighborhood assets such as community gardens, or gathering spaces.

This is likely the most suitable program for Solomon's Village CDC.

Land Based Projects

Publicly owned land can be purchased through the City's [Land Based Projects](#) Program. The proposed park location, between Charest Street and Gallagher Street, occupies vacant City-owned parcels for sale according to the [Detroit Development Opportunities map](#).

This program is most beneficial for residents living next to vacant side lots.

Side Lot Program

Parcels owned by the Detroit Land Bank Authority (DLBA) may be purchased by adjacent residents for \$100 through the [Side Lot Sales](#) program.

This program is most beneficial for residents living next to vacant side lots.

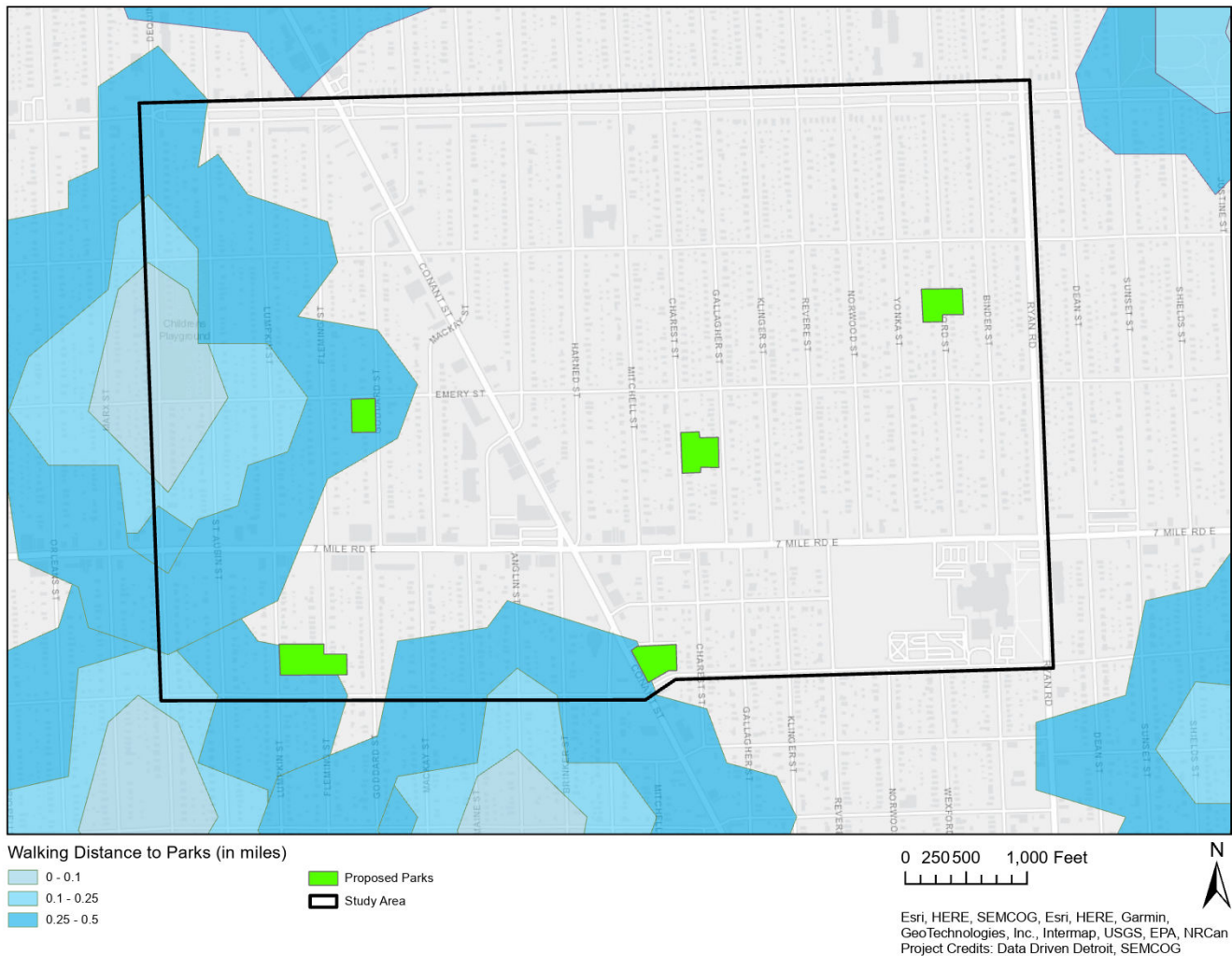
Adopt a Park

Community groups may also participate in the City's [Adopt-a-Park](#) program to improve existing parks in their neighborhood. The program provides supplies and encourages communities to schedule two or more events per year at the park. Programming and events are great ways to get residents engaged in stewardship and create a sense of pride in their community.



Sign and play structure at Yaksich Park at Grixdale and Anglin St



MAP 11. Existing and Proposed Parks in the Neighborhood

Resources for Land Stewardship Potential

The City of Detroit's [Nature Pockets Program](#) is currently working to convert vacant land into neighborhood green spaces featuring expanded tree canopy, native plantings, rain gardens, and other environmentally beneficial landscapes. Likewise, Solomon's Village CDC and residents of the 7 Mile and Conant neighborhoods can use the following available resources to establish or improve parks and greenspace. Transforming underutilized lots into shared spaces would allow residents to shape their neighborhood environment and create attractive places for recreation, social interaction, and neighborhood belonging.

Addressing Property Upkeep and Code Enforcement

Maintaining residential properties is essential to preserving neighborhood stability, safety, and property values. Property maintenance issues can range from overgrown lawns and accumulated debris to structures that pose safety risks to occupants and neighboring properties. If left unaddressed, these conditions can diminish neighborhood appearance, reduce property values, and negatively impact residents’ quality of life.

“Blight” Tickets

Buildings, Safety Engineering, and Environmental Department (BSEED), which enforces the City’s property maintenance ordinances. When an inspector identifies a violation (such as overgrown yards, unsafe structures, unregistered rental properties, or improperly maintained vacant buildings), the property owner receives a ticket describing the ordinance violation, which may include a fine if the issue is not corrected. Property owners who disagree with a citation may request a hearing through the Department of Appeals and Hearings (DAH).

Between 2021 and 2025, properties within the action area received 2,218 blight tickets, which is a rate of ~550 a year. While many tickets were one-time violations, several violation types occurred frequently, suggesting there are opportunities for education, outreach, or assistance programs to address underlying maintenance challenges. [Table 3](#) summarizes the ten most common blight tickets during this period.

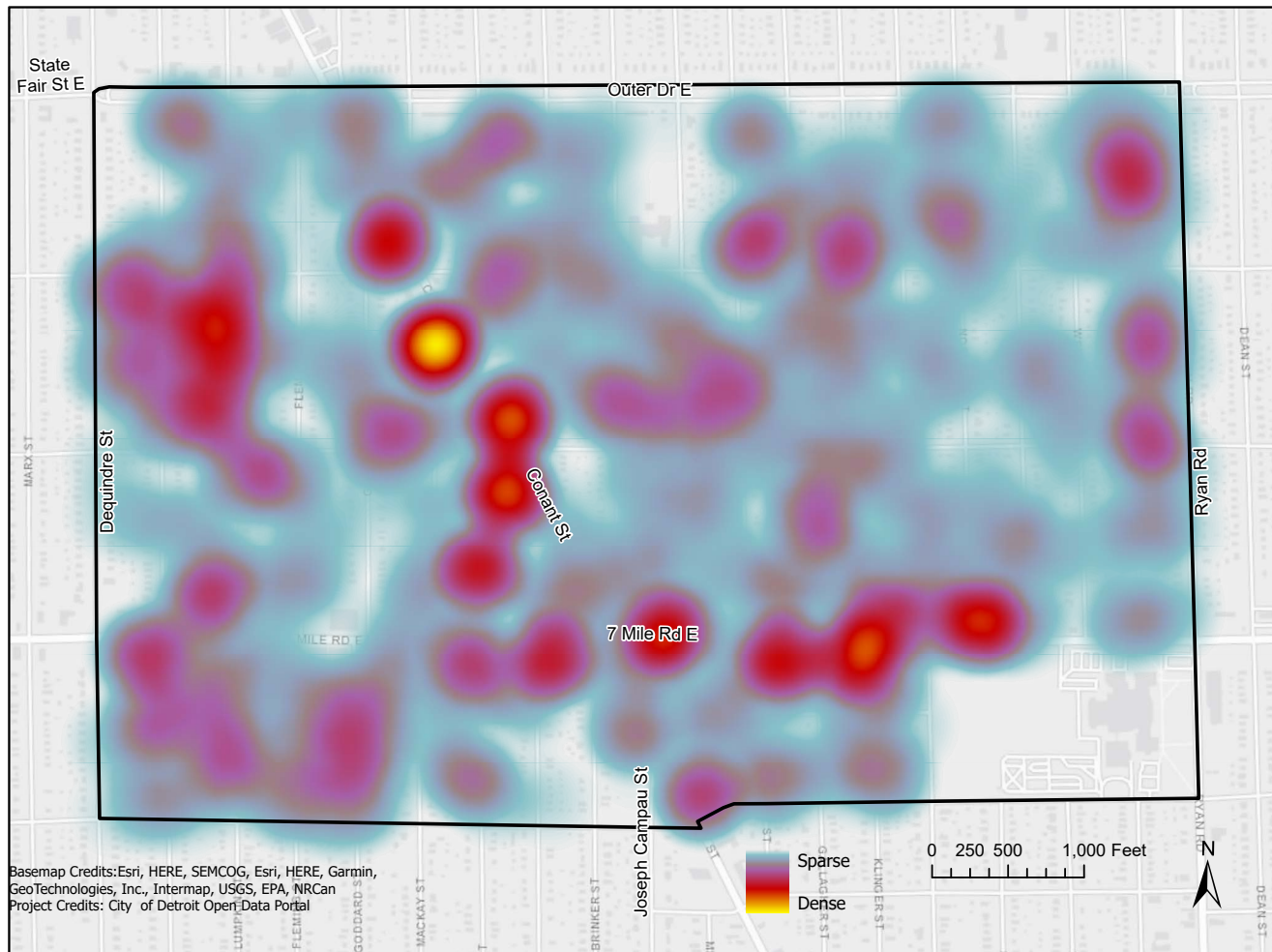
TABLE 3. Ten Most Frequent Blight Ticket Citations in the Neighborhood

Blight Ticket Citations	Ordinance Number	Count
Excessive residential weeds or plant growth	8-15-104	288
Failure to obtain certificate of compliance - non-rental	8-15-35(a)(1)	278
Unlawful rental without lead clearance	8-15-82	269
Failure to register rental property	8-15-81	214
Residential bulk waste accumulation	8-15-101	159
Failure to obtain certificate of compliance - rental	8-15-35(a)(2)	109
Failure to register a building vacant	8-14-45	107
Trash can left at curb outside of time limit	42-2-46	86
Commercial bulk waste accumulation	42-2-27	62
Failure to obtain commercial certificate of compliance	8-15-35(a)	53

Source: City of Detroit Open Data Portal, 2026

Map 12 shows the spatial distribution of blight tickets across the 7 Mile and Conant neighborhoods. The highest concentrations are found along the 7 Mile and Conant corridors and west of Dequindre Street. These patterns may be interpreted as indicators of neighborhood distress or may reflect areas where community members would benefit from awareness of City ordinances or additional assistance in addressing property maintenance issues.

MAP 12. Spatial Distribution of Blight Tickets Across the Neighborhood



Source: City of Detroit Open Data Portal

Blight Ticket Key Takeaways

Between 2021 and 2025, the most common blight violations in the action area fell into three broad categories:

- Property maintenance, including excessive weeds and vegetation growth
- Rental and non-rental property compliance, including certificates of compliance, rental registration, and lead clearance requirements
 - The **Certificate of Compliance (CoC)** confirms that a specific project addition, or improvements complies with applicable codes, regulations, or contractual obligations.
 - The **Certificate of Occupancy (CoO)** is a certification that confirms that a building or structure is following Detroit buildings codes making it suitable for its designated use. It is often issued for the entire property or the building mainly after major construction or occupancy reclassification.
- Waste management, including bulk waste accumulation and improper placement of refuse containers

These trends suggest opportunities to improve neighborhood conditions through education rather than enforcement alone. Many violations can be prevented by increasing awareness of City requirements and connecting residents and landlords with available maintenance resources.

As a part of this action plan, residents should be provided with accessible information about the most common blight violation in the City of Detroit. [Blight Violation: How to Address and Fix](#) serves as a quick reference guide that explains each violation, the associated fees, and the steps residents can take to correct the issue. Increasing awareness of common violations can help prevent citations, encourage resident compliance, and support neighborhood beautification efforts.

Supporting Compliance and Resolution

Resolving code violations often requires both knowledge of City requirements and access to financial or technical assistance. Property owners can improve the likelihood of successfully resolving citations by:

- Reviewing violation notice and required corrective actions carefully
- Completing repairs or maintenance as quickly as possible
- Maintaining documentation such as photographs, receipts, permits, and inspection records.
- Providing supporting evidence when participating in hearings or appeals

[Table 4](#) on the next page summarizes the most common code enforcement violations in the action area, applicable penalties, documentation requirements, and available financial assistance where applicable.



Vacant residential property with overgrown grass

TABLE 4. Common Code Enforcement Violations and Available Resources (2021-2025)

Ordinance	Common Violation	Typical Penalty*	Recommended Resolution	Documentation to Retain	Available Resources	Description
8-15-104	Excessive Weeds or Plant Growth	\$50–\$250	Cut vegetation and maintain the property	Timestamped photographs of completed work	Our Backyard Detroit	Vegetation exceeding 8 inches in height on private property or the adjacent berm
8-15-35 (a)(1)	No Certificate of Compliance (Non-Rental)	\$250–\$1,000	Obtain the required Certificate of Compliance	Inspection records, permits, receipts, and certificate	Home Repair Assistance Programs (where eligible)	Occupancy of a property without a required Certificate of Compliance
8-15-82	No Lead Clearance for Rental	\$500–\$2,000	Complete required lead inspection and submit clearance documentation	Lead Clearance Report or Risk Assessment	Lead Hazard Reduction Programs	Rental property lacks required lead clearance documentation
8-15-81	Rental Registration	\$250–\$500	Register the rental property with the City	Registration confirmation and payment receipt	-	Failure to register a rental property as required
8-15-101	Residential Bulk Waste	Determined at hearing	Remove improperly stored bulk waste or document compliance with collection schedules	Photographs, pickup schedule, police report (if illegal dumping occurred)	DPW Bulk Pickup Services	Improper placement or accumulation of residential bulk waste
8-15-35(2)	No Certificate of Compliance (Rental)	\$250–\$1,000	Apply for or obtain a Certificate of Compliance	Permit applications, inspection records, receipts, and certificates	-	Rental property occupied without a valid Certificate of Compliance
8-15-45	Vacant Building Registration	Determined at hearing	Register the vacant structure or document active rehabilitation	Building permits, contractor invoices, inspection records	Active Rehabilitation Exemption (if eligible)	Failure to register a vacant building with the city
42-2-46	Refuse Container Storage	\$100–\$500	Store refuse containers behind the front building line except during collection periods	Timestamped photographs	-	Trash containers left at the curb outside permitted collection times
42-2-27	Commercial Waste Accumulation	\$500–\$2,000	Maintain an active waste collection service and remove accumulated refuse	Waste hauler contract and collection receipt	Brownfield Grants and Loans (eligible properties)	Improper storage or disposal of commercial solid waste

*Penalty ranges reflect typical first through subsequent offenses. Certain violations are assessed by the Department of Appeals and Hearings based on the circumstances of each case.

Sources: City of Detroit Property Maintenance Code; Buildings, Safety Engineering, and Environmental Department (BSEED); Department of Appeals and Hearings (DAH).



Code Enforcement Solutions

Grants and Resources for Homeowners

Code enforcement is complemented by numerous programs that help homeowners, landlords, businesses, and neighborhood organizations maintain and improve their properties. These programs provide financial assistance and support to address maintenance issues before they become more serious.

For residents, [Our Backyard Detroit](#) provides free lawn care and landscape maintenance assistance for eligible residents who are unable to maintain their properties due to age, disability, or financial hardship.

For commercial community members, Brownfield grants and loans are available for smaller commercial properties in Detroit that are contaminated, blighted, or functionally obsolete.

Property owners can use these funds to cover critical cleanup and site preparation costs, including:

- Environmental assessments and Due Care planning
- Asbestos, mold, and lead abatement
- Demolition of blighted structures
- Underground storage tank and contaminated soil removal
- Site preparation and public infrastructure improvements

Appealing a Blight Citation

Property owners who receive a blight citation have the opportunity to request an administrative hearing before the City of Detroit Department of Appeals and Hearings (DAH). During the hearing, the city present the basis for the citation, while the property owner may submit photographs, permits, inspection reports, receipts, or other documentation demonstrating compliance or correcting the violation.

Because many maintenance issues can be resolved through available grant programs and technical assistance, pursuing compliance before or during the administrative process is generally more efficient than appealing to court.



Dumping on residential properties throughout the neighborhood

Upkeep Solutions

Community Improvement Programs

Beyond code enforcement, there are several programs that encourage neighborhood beautification and community investment.

Neighborhood organizations and residents can borrow landscaping and cleanup equipment through the [Detroit Tool Bank](#) or the [E. Warren Tool Library](#), while the [Our Backyard Detroit Everyday Champion Mini-Grant Program](#) provides funding for neighborhood cleanup events and community projects. City of Detroit programs such as [Blight to Beauty](#) supports the transformation of underutilized public spaces, while [City Walls](#) funds public art that enhances neighborhood identity.

For private property improvements, the City offers streamlined permitting for many home repairs, while land disposition programs allow eligible residents to acquire and maintain vacant lots adjacent to their properties.

Investing in Roads

Residents interact with the streets and roadways and streets throughout and around their neighborhood on a daily basis. These spaces are often serve as the first and last public environments residents experience when they leave or return home. As a result, the design, condition, and functionality of the transportation network play an important role in supporting community health, safety, mobility, and overall quality of life.

Improving roads to better serve residents requires significant planning, coordination, and investment. Because roadway reconstruction and redesign projects are both substantial in both time and cost, municipalities plan road projects in advance to promote fiscal responsibility.

PASER Ratings

One key measure used to identify roads in need of replacement, and potentially redesign is the Pavement Surface Evaluation Rating (PASER) system. PASER assigns pavement conditions a score of 1-10, with higher ratings representing better pavement conditions and lower ratings indicating greater deterioration and need for intervention.

As shown on [Map 13](#), all roads in and around the study have a PASER rating of 4 or below, indicating that pavement conditions are generally poor. These findings highlight the need for future roadway improvements.

10, 9, 8	7,6,5	4,3,2,1
New - Very Good Little or No Maintenance	Good - Fair Capital Preventative Maintenance	Poor - Failed Heavy Rehabilitation or Reconstruction
Estimated Costs \$0 - \$3,000 per mile	Estimated Costs \$5,000 - \$100,000 per mile	Estimated Costs \$130,000 - \$500,000 per mile

PASER rating classifications and estimated costs of maintenance
Source: Barry County Road Commission

MAP 13. Road PASER Ratings Throughout the Neighborhood



Road Improvement Priorities and Recommendations

The boundary roads of Dequindre, Outer Drive, and Ryan Road are all in poor condition and in need of repair. Conant Street, which runs north-south through the action area, also has a very low PASER rating. Considering these roads form the primary boundaries and central spine of the 7 Mile and Conant area, they should be prioritized for repair to address the significant concentration of poor road quality in the area.

When possible, road repair projects should integrate an increase in greenery, such as shrubs and trees, into the right-of-way or easement. During community engagement, residents specifically identified a desire for ornamental trees along the existing street network. Ornamental trees, which typically reach an average height of 20 feet and feature colorful leaves, foliage, or flowers, can improve neighborhood aesthetics and strengthen the overall character of public spaces.

Bike Lanes Near the 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhood

Residents also noted that biking and walking improvements would significantly increase the quality of life and desirability of the neighborhood. Residents were interested both in larger road improvements, such as bike lanes on collector and arterial roads, as well as local routes on residential streets. There are a number of existing bike lanes that lead towards the neighborhood, but gaps remain that limit connectivity.

Existing Bike Network and Improvements

There is an existing bike lane running westward along Outer Drive and an existing protected bike lane along Joseph Campau Street that runs north, both of which would connect the neighborhood to the city-wide bike lane network.

Bike lane improvements on larger streets, such as 7 Mile, Outer Drive, and Conant, should offer a full bike lane for cyclists and other non-motorized travelers. See the sidebars on [page 45](#) for more information regarding the Complete Streets improvements that will take place along the 7 Mile corridor in the coming years.

BICYCLE BOULEVARDS

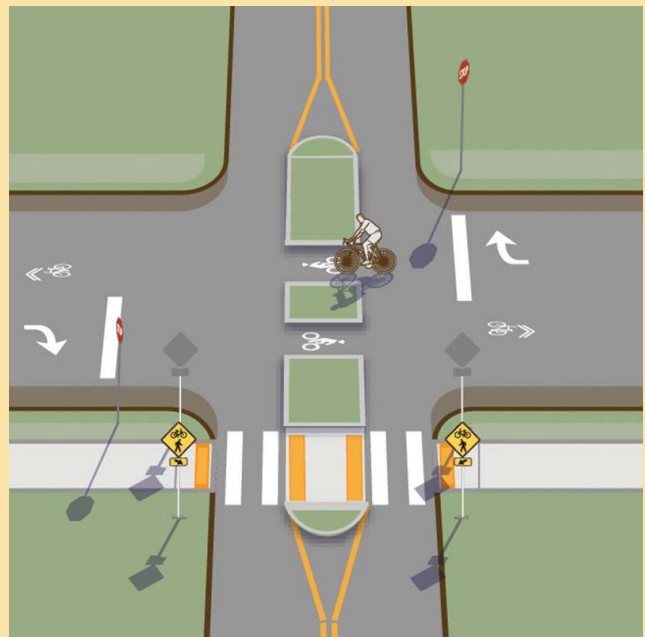
On lower-volume and slower-speed residential roads, bike boulevard treatments are oftentimes more effective, being lower in cost and providing the needed sense of safety for cyclists.

Bike boulevards use lower-cost treatments to indicate that residential streets are shared by all users, including:

- Sharrows
- Bicycle wayfinding signage
- Speed humps
- Other traffic calming measures

Although they provide less protection than traditional bike lanes, bike boulevards can improve the rideability of residential streets.

Bike boulevards are also a practical alternative where narrow roadways, on-street parking, and frequent driveways make traditional bike lanes impractical or impossible to implement.



Example of bicycle boulevard design
Source: *Small Town and Rural Design Guide*

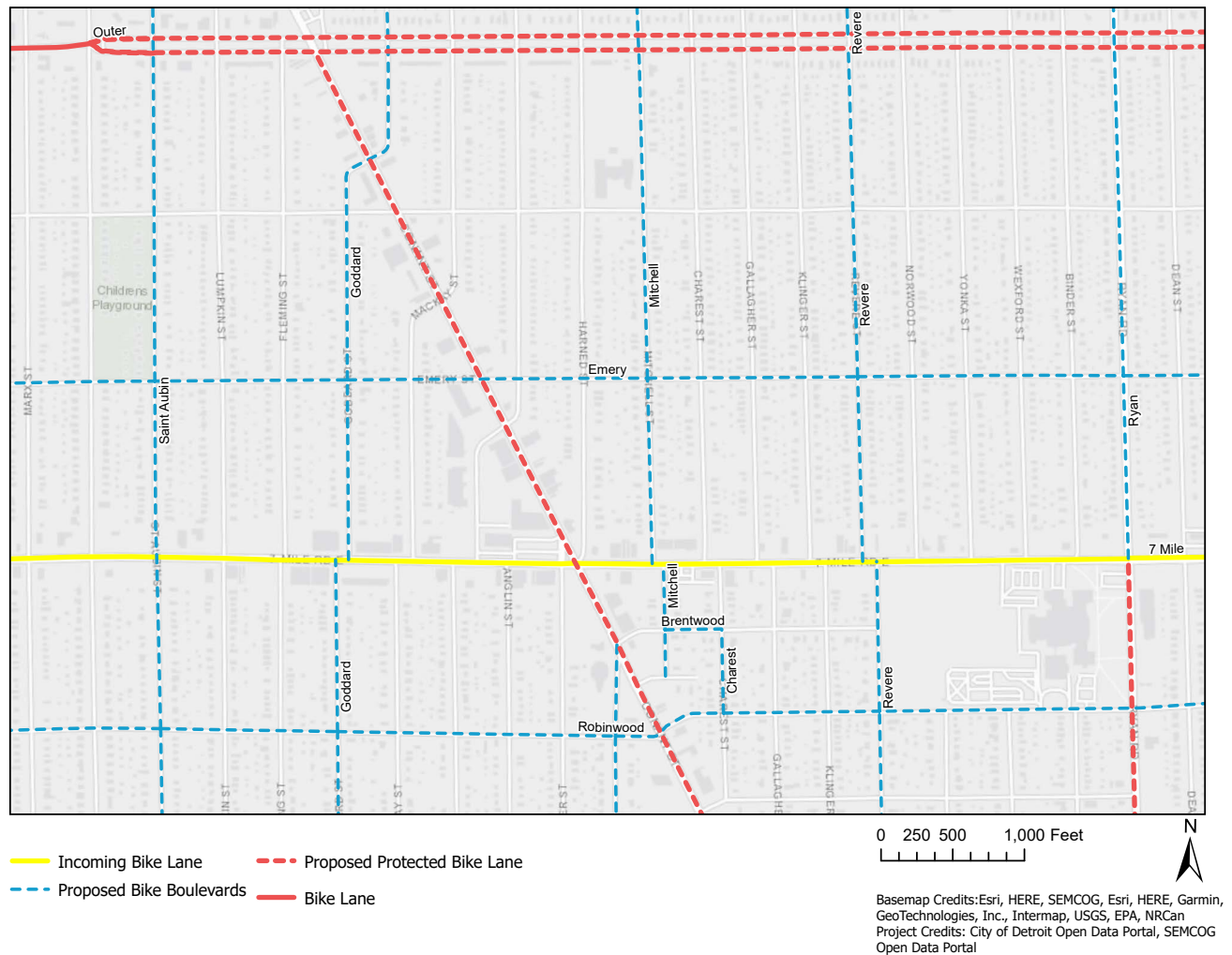
Proposed Bike Improvements

Map 14 shows a proposed system of bike lanes and bike boulevards within and around the 7 Mile and Conant area, providing a system of travel that connects the neighborhood to the expanding bike network outside of the neighborhood, as well as provides local routes for more recreational riders.

This system prioritizes connecting residents to existing bike paths, such as Outer Drive and Joseph Campau, existing park areas, such as the Dequindre-Emery Playlot, and local schools, being the Pershing High School campus.

These proposed connections also serve to provide flexibility in future design that can meet the specific conditions of these roads.

MAP 14. Existing and Proposed Bike Lanes in the Neighborhood



Investing in Walkability

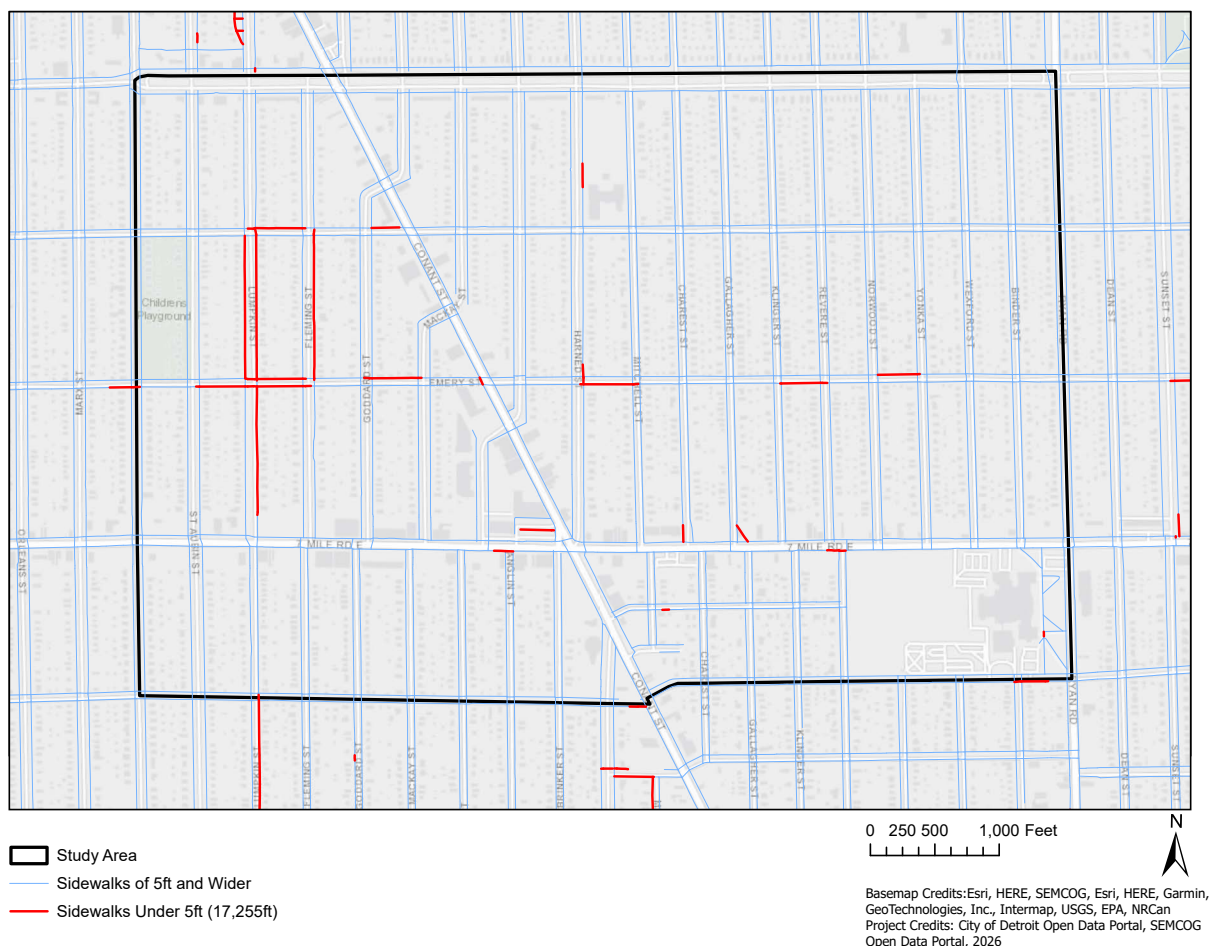
Walkability is an important contributor to both physical and mental health, supporting active transportation, social interaction, and overall quality of life. While factors such as greenery, investing in land uses that attract walkers, and giving residents parks to walk to all aid in local walkability, one factor of central importance is the condition of the local sidewalk network itself.

The sidewalk network in the 7 Mile and Conant Area is mostly complete, with few missing segments. However, portions of the network are narrower than the recommended minimum sidewalk width of 5 feet. This standard accommodates two-way pedestrian travel, allows individuals to walk side by side, and provides greater separation from adjacent vehicular traffic, improving accessibility and pedestrian comfort.

Map 15 below illustrates the sidewalk and crosswalk network throughout the action area. Sidewalk segments less than the recommended 5-foot minimum width are highlighted in red, identifying locations where future infrastructure improvements could enhance pedestrian accessibility, safety, and overall walkability.

In total, 17,255 feet of sidewalks in and around the action area are below the standard width and should be targeted for replacement. Sidewalks can be replaced as a condition of new development through private construction or by the City as a general public works project. Residents and neighborhood groups should advocate to the City to infill sidewalk gaps as sidewalks are replaced, which would substantially improve walkability in the area.

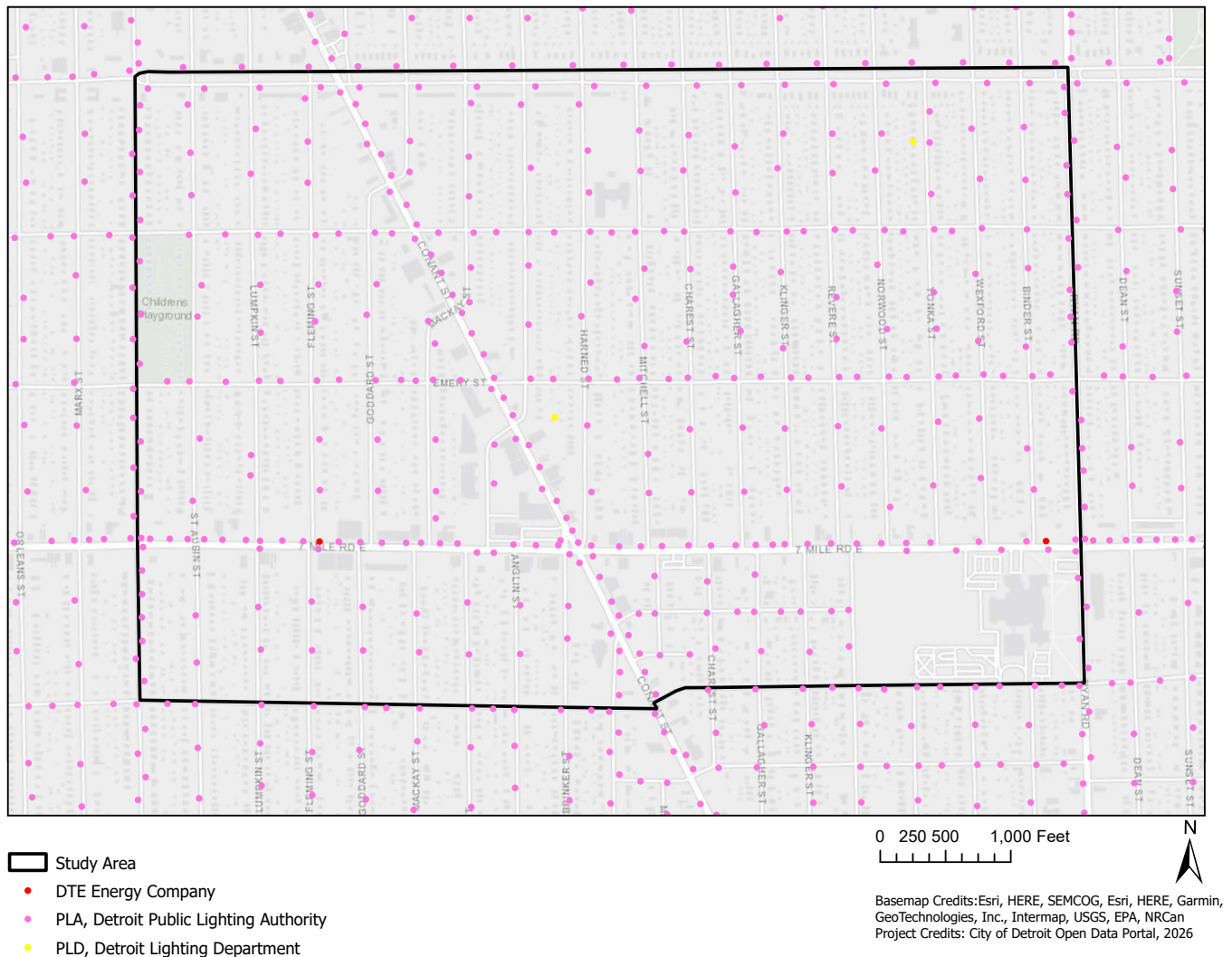
MAP 15. Existing Sidewalk and Crosswalk Network Throughout the Neighborhood



Investing in Lighting and Visibility

Residents also indicated during engagement that local visibility on streets and sidewalks has decreased since recent installation of LED light bulbs on local lighting poles. LED lights operate at a lower cost to both municipalities and residents, as well as offer more focused lighting than traditional bulbs, potentially creating less light pollution, depending on light color and design. While financial benefits are attractive, residents are still in need of adequate lighting. Proper lighting increases the perception of safety, which increases walkability, and promotes more neighborhood activity. The map below (Map 16) shows the lighting network within and around the action area.

MAP 16. Existing Lighting Network Within and Surrounding the Neighborhood



Existing Public Lighting Network

Inspection reveals that most of the lighting within the neighborhood falls under control of the Public Lighting Authority (PLA). During the 2010s, the PLA updated the city's antiquated, unreliable, and inefficient lighting system, and has largely filled in any lighting gaps. The PLA is now focused on further increasing reliability and coverage.

At the time of the drafting of this plan, Mayor Mary Sheffield has plans to work with the PLA to increase the number of mid-block streetlights to address this very issue. While the action area has a comparable density of lighting poles in relation to the surrounding neighborhoods, a concentrated effort to petition to the PLA and City of Detroit could result in additional and higher quality lighting through these new efforts, and through general petitions for improvement.

Private Lighting and Placemaking Opportunities

Additionally, residents can improve lighting privately through lighting on their properties, which has been a long-standing placemaking tool within the 7 Mile and Conant Area. Along Dequindre Road, and within the adjacent streets, ornamental DTE lighting poles exist, dating from when DTE was originally beginning to supply the area with energy. This residential lighting program is still on-going, where residents can order these poles from DTE through an online process on their website.

While these poles and associated lighting will add costs to the residents' lighting bill, the increased visibility and sense of place these lights provide may also provide additional value and pride to the neighborhood. Residents indicated that local block clubs also organize to decorate these lighting poles with flowers and banners seasonally and for special events.



Street lighting outside of Solomon's Temple church along the 7 Mile commercial corridor

Beautification Toolbox

The following toolbox identifies the primary implementation tools available to carry out the recommendations of the Neighborhood Beautification section. Many projects will require a combination of funding, partnerships, and community involvement. The toolbox is intended to help neighborhood organizations, residents, and the City identify the resources needed to move projects from concept to completion.

TABLE 5. Neighborhood Beautification Toolbox

Toolbox Category	Implementation Tools	Potential Partners and Funding Sources
Planning and Land Use	Neighborhood planning, land acquisition, Side Lot Program, vacant land redevelopment, capital improvement planning	City of Detroit, Detroit Land Bank Authority, Planning Department, MEDC
Parks and Neighborhood Beautification	Pocket parks, community gardens, tree planting, landscaping, public art, green infrastructure, neighborhood cleanups	Solomon's Village CDC, Greening of Detroit, Keep Growing Detroit, City Parks & Recreation, DNR Grants, philanthropic foundations
Housing and Property Improvement	Home repair programs, code compliance assistance, lead hazard remediation, rental registration education, property maintenance assistance, blight prevention	BSEED, Detroit Housing & Revitalization Department, HUD, Community Development Block Grant (CDBG), neighborhood organizations
Transportation and Public Infrastructure	Road reconstruction, sidewalk improvements, bicycle facilities, traffic calming, decorative lighting, ADA accessibility, streetscape improvements	DPW, Public Lighting Authority (PLA), MDOT, SEMCOG, Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A), Transportation Alternatives Program (TAP)
Community Partnerships and Funding	Grant writing, volunteer programs, block clubs, community engagement, sponsorships, fundraising, project monitoring	Solomon's Village CDC, residents, local businesses, faith-based organizations, philanthropic organizations, corporate sponsors

APPENDIX A: Residential Toolbox

Residential Toolbox

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Activate Vacant Land

Objective: Sell vacant lots owned by the Detroit Land Bank Authority (DLBA) to owners of adjacent occupied residential property to be used for residential, recreational or agricultural purposes.

Lot requirements:

- The lot must not exceed 7,500 square feet in size and it must not measure more than 300 linear feet on any side
- There must be no delinquent or currently due property taxes in connection with the lot
- Must be zoned residential

Step by Step

Step 1: Confirm Eligibility

You must:

- Own the home that is adjacent to the vacant lot, side lot can be next door, behind your property, or even across an alley, but not across the street.
- Hold title to the Applicants occupied property, which could include being a purchaser (but not a seller) in a land contract agreement
- Be current on property taxes or be in good standing with a payment plan entered into with Wayne County Treasurer's office.
- Be in good standing with any agreements the purchaser is a party to with the DLBA.

Step 2: Check if the lot is available

Go to [Side Lot Sales](#) and enter your home address to see available side lots in the area.

Step 3: Create an account

Create an account on the [Building Detroit Website](#). This is required before submitting an application.

Step 4: Submit Side Lot Application

Select the lot you want to purchase and complete the online application.

Be ready to provide:

- Proof of ownership of the adjacent property
- Verification that taxes are current or under a payment plan
- Contact information and ownership details if applying through an LCC, nonprofit, or other organization.

Step 5: Wait for DLBA Review

Once you have applied, you will receive updates via email from sidelotdetroitlandbank.org regarding the status of your application. This may take a week or two.

Step 6: Complete the Purchase

A standard side lot will cost \$100. After closing, the deed will be processed and transferred to you.

Step 7: File a Property Transfer Affidavit

Complete [Michigan Form 2766](#) and email to assessorssalesteam@detroitmi.gov or mail directly to the City of Detroit Office of the Assessor. The completed Property Transfer Affidavit must be filed by the new owner with the assessor for the city where the property is located within 45 days of the transfer.

Step 8 (optional): Combine parcels

The side lot parcel will remain a separate parcel with its own tax bill. If you want it combined with your home's parcel, you can apply for parcel combination through the City's Assessors Office at 2 Woodward Avenue, Suite 804 and call (313) 224-3024 before visiting to check what to bring.

What if...**What if more than one person applies to purchase a side lot?**

If there are multiple, eligible applications for a lot within 10 days of the first complete application, the DLBA will give preference to the applicant whose home is street adjacent to the Side Lot.

What if the vacant parcel next to me isn't listed online?

If the DLBA owns the lot and it isn't available for sale, contact inquire@detroitlandbank.org by email or call (313) 974-6869 to make a purchase inquiry.

Ways to Use Activated Side Lots

Once you own your side lot, you can turn this into an extension of your yard by:

- Expanding green space, adding landscaping
- Build a patio space with tables and chairs
- Install a fit pit area
- Add a fence around your additional lot
- Build a garden, possibility for herbs, vegetables or plants
- Greenhouse
- Gazebo
- Rain garden to prevent flooding
- Plant trees
- Build an ADU



Critical Home Repair Program

What is it?

The City of Detroit's Critical Home Repair Program provides free repairs for eligible homeowners, directly addressing the most critical home repair needs.

Who can apply?

To apply for this program, households must meet the following initial requirements:

- Own and occupy a home in the City of Detroit
- Be current on property taxes or in a payment plan
- Have at least one of the following living in their home:
 - A child under the age of 18
 - A senior age 62+
 - A resident with a documented disability
 - Make no more than 60% of the area median income

What repairs qualify?

The Critical Home repair program addresses needs such as:

- Severe plumbing issues
- Actively leaking roofs
- Lack of working furnace or boiler
- Electrical hazards
- Accessibility related repairs to bathrooms and home entrances and exits

How to apply

Residents can apply for the Critical Home Repair Program and HHFS's LeadSafe Housing repair program with one application, during open periods (twice a year). To be notified when the next open pre-application period opens, complete the [City of Detroit's Human Homeless and Family Services \(HHFS\) Single Family Home Repair Program contact form](#).

The March 2026 pre-application period is closed. To check the status of a submitted pre-application, go to the online [Neighborly System](#)



Home Weatherization Assistance Program

Through [Wayne Metropolitan Community Action Agency](#)

Benefits:

Weatherization provides energy efficiency services at no cost to the homeowner or renter that are tailored to each house for maximum cost savings. Families receiving weatherization services see their annual energy bills reduced by approximately \$250 to \$450.

- Wall insulation
- Attic insulation and ventilation
- Foundation insulation
- Air leakage reduction
- Dryer venting installation
- Free smoke detectors
- Free carbon monoxide detectors

Please Note: The Weatherization Assistance Program does not include funding for structural repairs (roofs, windows, doors), plumbing, or electrical repairs. **This is not an emergency or a home repair program.**

How to Apply

Apply for the Weatherization Assistance Program today using the online application or call the Connect Center:

gateway.waynemetro.org or call (313) 889-9799

Home Eligibility (Determined During the Home Assessment)

- Home is not eligible for Weatherization if it was weatherized in the past 15 years
- Home cannot be weatherized if it has one or more of the following deferral reasons:
 - Roof is damaged
 - Asbestos
 - Active knob & tube wiring
 - Visible mold or standing water in the basement
 - Major areas of infiltration (missing drywall, windows, etc.)
- Client must provide access to their basement and attic to receive Weatherization services
- **Please note:** Weatherization is a multi-step process that can take several months to complete.



Detroit 0% Interest Home Repair Loans

What is it?

The 0% Interest Home Repair Loan Program offers 10-year, interest-free loans of \$5,000 to \$25,000 to help Detroit homeowners invest in and repair their homes – promoting public health and safety, increasing property values, and helping residents secure and maintain homeowners' insurance.

Who can apply?

- Must own and live in the home for at least six months before applying. Vacant, unoccupied units are not eligible.
- Low to moderate-income homeowners can apply no matter where they live. View the income table to learn more.
- Regardless of income, homeowners in HUD-designated areas in each city council district can still apply. See the map.
- The minimum credit score is 560. The debt-to-income ratio cannot exceed 45%, and the housing ratio cannot exceed 35%. Loan-to-value cannot exceed 150%.
- Homeowner's insurance and property taxes must be current.
- The homeowner must be able to afford the loan payments.

What repairs qualify?

If a home has health and safety hazards (i.e. lead, mold, asbestos), those issues must be addressed first before other repairs can be made. The following are sample repairs:

- Removal of lead & other health/safety hazards (required)
- Electrical repairs
- Furnace & HVAC replacement
- Roof replacement
- Plumbing
- Door and window replacement
- Concrete repairs (sidewalks, driveways)
- Porches, foundations, and other structural repairs

How to Apply?

Intake Application Forms

Visit one of the [11 Intake Centers](#), as well as any [City of Detroit Rec Center](#), to pick up an application for a home repair loan. Complete the application and compiled all of the required documents, then contact an Intake Center to schedule an appointment to submit your application.

Carhartt Workshop Tool Bench: [A free resource for Detroit](#)



How it works

1. Register and verify a profile on www.CarharttWorkshop.myturn.com. Provide all required information, including email address, address, and phone number.
2. Once you've registered and verified your email address, take the New User Orientation. The orientation is required prior to picking up your first reservation.
3. Once you've completed the New User Orientation, Browse through the tool inventory to find a tool suitable for your needs.
4. Click on the tool and choose your preferred reservation date with the pop-up calendar. Determine your rental duration and click 'submit'.
5. Tools will be placed in your shopping cart. When you've found all the tools you need, click on your shopping cart (top right of the page), and click 'submit'.
6. Come to the Workshop on your specified pickup day to pick up your order.

Homeowners Property Tax Exemption (HOPE)

What is HOPE?

The City of Detroit's [HOPE](#) program gives qualifying Detroit homeowners a 100%, 75%, 50%, 25%, or 10% exemption from their property taxes based on their income or circumstances. The deadline to apply is November 6, 2026, at 4:30 PM.

Qualified Detroit homeowners can apply for a property tax exemption for this year or last year's property taxes. HOPE application review and determinations are made solely by the City of Detroit Board of Review. Community partners are here to help you submit your application. Learn more about the HOPE program and see if you qualify

Do you qualify?

Eligibility for the HOPE is based on whether you own and occupy your home as your primary residence and household income. Please review the income levels listed below. Most homeowners whose income is below the guidelines are generally approved.

Only the Board of Review may approve an application.

2026 HOPE Application

Residents seeking HOPE application assistance can make an appointment with a community partner. At your appointment, your counselor will help you complete your application and submit the required documents. Your HOPE counselor will explain the application process and timeline to you.

Book An Appointment



Make It Home – United Community Housing Coalition

What is MIH?

Make It Home is an innovative affordable homeownership project dedicated to helping Detroit residents secure the homes they live in. Through a unique partnership with the City of Detroit, UCHC exercises the city's right to first refusal to purchase tax-foreclosed properties before they are auctioned. This allows tenants, former homeowners, and multi-generational households to buy their homes at an affordable cost, preventing displacement and promoting housing stability.

Are you eligible?

To participate in MIH you must meet the following requirements:

- The property must be your primary residence, and you must continue living there.
- The home must be tax-foreclosed by the Wayne County Treasurer.
- The property must pass a home inspection to confirm livability.
- Cannot own other homes.
- Complete the MIH enrollment process, including attendance at required workshops and appointments.
- Save funds for the purchase of your home and deposit them into a UCHC Tenant Withholding Account.

Important Notes:

DO NOT pay the property taxes. Doing so will not grant you ownership and may disqualify you from MIH.

Keep your utilities active and limit major repairs until after purchase.

How to enroll?

- Register for an in-person Make It Home Appointment by calling (313) 725-4560.
- Meet with a UCHC Tax Foreclosure Prevention Counselor to complete enrollment.
- Schedule a home inspection with UCHC.

Trash Removal / Dumping

Legal Bulk Drop-Off Sites (free for residents):

- DPW Southfield Yard – 12255 Southfield Rd.
- DPW Davison Yard – 8221 W. Davison
- DPW J. Fons Yard – 6451 E. McNichols

Accepts construction and demolition of debris for a fee.



Improve Detroit – App & Website

Improve Detroit is an app that can be used to report non-emergency requests to the City of Detroit.

Examples of Requests:

- Abandoned Vehicle
- Bus Shelter Issues
- Curbside Solid Waste Removal
- Graffiti Abatement
- Illegal Dumping
- Investigate
- Fire Hydrant Related Issues
- Manhole Cover
- Service Leak
- Water Main Break
- Potholes
- Reboard House
- Request Recycling Cart
- Sidewalk Concern
- Snow Removal Issue
- Squatters Issue
- Streetlight Out
- Traffic Sign/Signal Issue
- Tree Issue

Include in Requests:

- Photo
- Address
- Description of Materials

You may comment on your submissions, and you will be notified when the status of the issue is updated.

Toolbox Webpage

To visit a webpage containing all resources as laid out in this toolbox and more, click [here](#).



Improve Detroit app homepage
Source: GovTech

APPENDIX B: Commercial Development Toolbox

Commercial Development Toolbox

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Detroit Economic Growth Corporation (DEGC)

Detroit's economic development catalyst, dedicated to finding innovative solutions that attract investment, create jobs, and revitalize Detroit's economy for all residents.

DEGC offers no-cost services and small business loan funding.

www.degc.org

Tech Town Detroit

Supports entrepreneurs by helping small businesses launch, stabilize, and grow by supporting entrepreneurs in building core business skills, increasing revenue, creating jobs, and accessing capital.

www.techtowndetroit.org

Detroit Means Business (DMB)

Detroit's front door to entrepreneurial success, providing access to capital, technical assistance, and advocacy for small businesses.

www.detroitmeansbusiness.org

Detroit Business Liaison

The District Business Liaison helps connect business owners with resources and navigate the City's business initiation process. They also provide education on various policies.

District 3 Liaison:

- MD-Abdul Muhit
- Email: mmuhit@degc.org
- Phone number: (313) 452-7704

The Small Business Call Center's phone number is (844) 333-8249

Business owners are also encouraged to subscribe to the District 3 newsletter for updates and opportunities.

[Sign up to Stay in Touch with Your D3 DBL!](#)

Small Business Technology Fund

Provides up to a \$1,000 technology grant to assist businesses with hardware, software, artificial intelligence, and other technology needs.

[Small Business Technology Fund | City of Detroit](#)



Community Tech Consultations

Provides no-cost one-on-one technology support, including assistance with websites, social media, artificial intelligence, templates, and business applications.

[Community Tech Consulting - Detroit Neighborhood Entrepreneurs Project Initiative](#)

Detroit Legacy Business Project Grant

Provides grant assistance to businesses that have operated in Detroit for 30 years or more.

[Apply for Grant | City of Detroit](#)

ProsperUs Detroit

Connects entrepreneurs with grants, technical assistance, and organizations dedicated to increasing economic equity and supporting business development in under-resourced communities.

[Detroit Resources - ProsperUs Detroit](#)

Community Tech Consultations

Provides no-cost one-on-one technology support, including assistance with websites, social media, artificial intelligence, templates, and business applications.

[Community Tech Consulting - Detroit Neighborhood Entrepreneurs Project Initiative](#)

Toolbox Webpage

To visit a webpage containing all resources as laid out in this toolbox and more, click [here](#).

APPENDIX C: Existing Conditions

Existing Conditions

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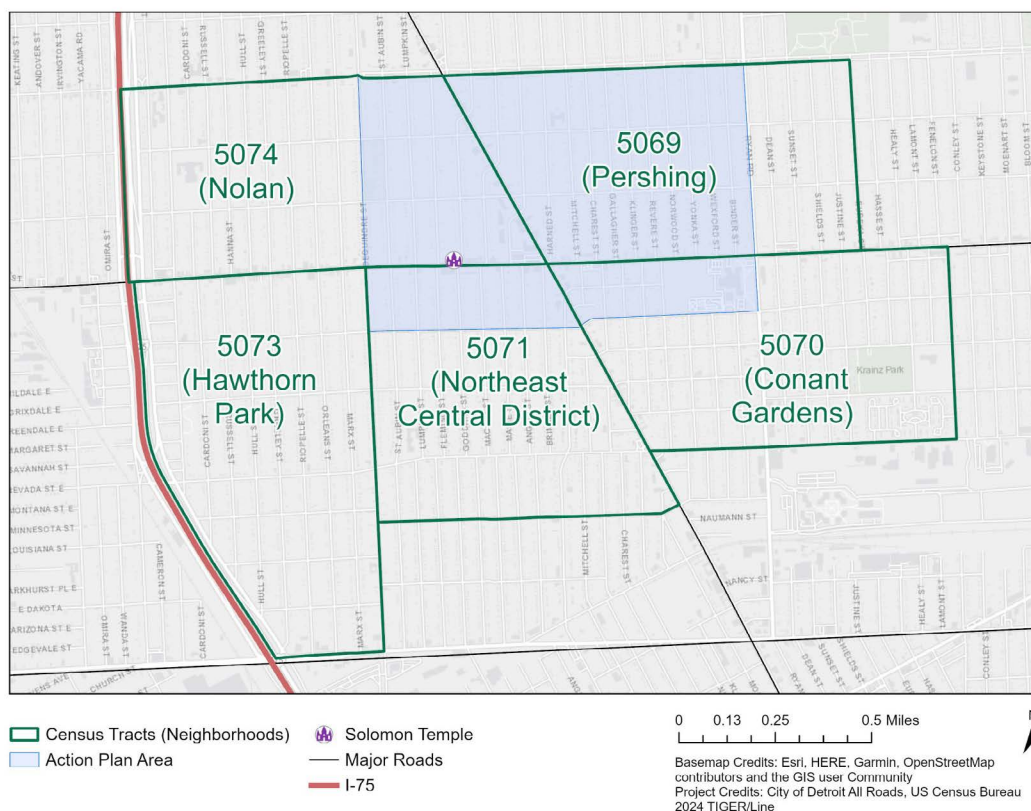
Existing Conditions

This section provides an overview of existing conditions in the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhoods to support the development of an action plan, focusing on key demographic, housing, and economic characteristics. The primary land use action area is encompassed within Census Tract 5069 and 5070; however, Census Tracts 5071, 5073, and 5074 are also included to provide additional geographic context and scale, while data for the City of Detroit is included to compare trends in the Tracts to those of the city at large. These data establish a critical baseline for measuring change over time, helping to identify patterns of growth, decline, and displacement risk, while also revealing gaps in access to housing, jobs, and services. In addition, they provide insight into how different parts of the neighborhood and surrounding Tracts may experience change unevenly, which is important for promoting equitable outcomes.

Data in this section are drawn from the 2010-2014, 2015-2019, and 2020-2024 American Community Survey (ACS) 5-Year Estimates. As the American Community Survey collects data from a sample of households each year, the estimates are subject to sampling error and may not fully reflect actual conditions within the neighborhoods. As a result, the data presented should be interpreted as an indicator of broader trends rather than an exact representation of current conditions. Additional limitations may exist when analyzing smaller geographic areas, where estimates can be more variable due to smaller sample sizes.

Data for Census Tracts 5069, 5070, 5071, 5073, and 5074 are presented individually where feasible; in cases where there are too many data points to summarize concisely, the Tracts are combined and treated as a single geography.

MAP 1. 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods Action Area Overview



Demographics

Demographic data provides insight into the composition and characteristics of a community’s population. Factors such as population size and change, age distribution, sex, race and ethnicity, and educational attainment help illustrate the diversity, needs, and overall well-being of residents. These characteristics can influence workforce availability, economic development, public service demands, and community planning efforts.

Understanding demographic trends is essential for creating policies, programs, and services that support residents of all backgrounds and life stages. A balanced and inclusive population contributes to a vibrant, resilient, and thriving community.

Population

Between 2014 and 2024, the neighborhoods experienced overall population decline, reflecting broader trends across the City of Detroit. While Conant Gardens and Nolan saw modest growth in their populations, the remaining Tracts lost population, with the most significant declines occurring in Pershing and the Northeast Central District at 19.1% and 36% (see [Table 1](#)). Overall, these trends suggest uneven neighborhood conditions across the neighborhoods, with some areas showing signs of stability while others continue to experience long-term population loss and disinvestment. Continued population declines can affect neighborhood vitality, housing demand, and the ability to sustain local services and amenities over time. These conditions reinforce the importance of targeted reinvestment, housing stabilization, and long-term planning efforts aimed at strengthening existing residential areas and supporting overall neighborhood resilience.

TABLE 1. Population Growth Rate: 2014 - 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Population, 2014	Population, 2024	Percent Change
5069	Pershing	4,215	3,412	-19.1%
5070	Conant Gardens	2,901	2,961	2.1%
5071	NE Central District	2,530	1,620	-36.0%
5073	Hawthorn Park	2,327	2,309	-0.8%
5074	Nolan	2,655	2,804	5.6%
Detroit		695,437	638,530	-8.2%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024

Age and Sex

The age distribution shows mixed demographic change between 2014 and 2024, with growth among younger residents and declines among several middle-aged and older groups. Children under 5 (17.3%), ages 5 to 9 (13.5%), ages 15 to 19 (24.1%), and ages 25 to 29 (23.4%) increased, while several middle-aged and older age groups experienced declines. Overall, these neighborhood-level shifts suggest changing household patterns and may increase demand for family services, housing, and youth-focused resources, while also highlighting potential changes in the needs of older residents. (See [Table 2](#)).

Sex composition remains generally balanced across Tracts with only minor shifts between 2014 and 2024. Patterns were stable compared to Detroit. (See [Table 3](#)).

TABLE 2. Population and Cohort Retention by Age: Combined Tracts, 2014 - 2024

Age	2014	2024	Cohort Retention Ratio (%)	Percent Change
Under 5	704	826	-	17.3%
5 to 9	944	1,071	-	13.5%
10 to 14	1,174	1,095	57.1%	-6.7%
15 to 19	1,070	1,328	82.4%	24.1%
20 to 24	1,020	670	82.9%	-34.3%
25 to 29	715	882	119%	23.4%
30 to 34	1,055	846	45.9%	-19.8%
35 to 39	845	851	95.3%	0.7%
40 to 44	1,224	484	72.2%	-60.5%
45 to 49	987	805	78.8%	-18.4%
50 to 54	835	884	87.8%	5.9%
55 to 59	1,070	778	63.7%	-27.3%
60 to 64	731	733	28.2%	0.3%
65 to 69	682	682	70.1%	0%
70 to 74	456	206	57.9%	-54.8%
75 to 79	407	478	54.8%	17.4%
80 to 84	342	264	0.0%	-22.8%
85+	358	223	0.0%	-37.7%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024

TABLE 3. Sex: 2014 - 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	2014		2024		Percent Change
		Male	Female	Male	Female	
5069	Pershing	49.3%	50.7%	51.8%	48.2%	+2.5% male
5070	Conant Gardens	45.4%	54.6%	42.4%	57.6%	+3.0% female
5071	NE Central District	51.4%	48.6%	40.8%	59.2%	+10.6% female
5073	Hawthorn Park	42.7%	57.3%	50.3%	49.7%	+7.6% male
5074	Nolan	52.4%	47.6%	53.9%	46.1%	+1.5% male
Detroit		47.4%	52.6%	47.4%	52.6%	No change

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024



Race

The racial composition shows that the neighborhoods remained predominantly Black or African American between 2014 and 2024, with only minor shifts across Tracts. Black residents continued to represent the majority population throughout the entire neighborhood, while White, Hispanic, and Asian populations remained relatively small. Compared with Detroit overall, the neighborhoods experienced more racial stability, while the city saw a larger decrease in the Black population share and increases among White, Hispanic, and Asian residents (see [Table 4](#)). These trends suggest continued racial continuity within the neighborhood, with limited diversification compared to broader citywide changes.

TABLE 4. Racial Composition: 2014 - 2024

Race	2014	2024	Percent Change
5069 - Pershing			
White	4.2%	1.0%	-3.2%
Black	94%	97.8%	3.8%
Hispanic	1.8%	1.2%	-0.6%
Asian	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
5070 - Conant Gardens			
White	0.4%	3.5%	3.1%
Black	99.6%	91.1%	-8.5%
Hispanic	0.0%	0.5%	0.5%
Asian	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
5071 - NE Central District			
White	0.4%	0.1%	-0.3%
Black	98.1%	96.3%	-1.8%
Hispanic	0.0%	0.1%	0.1%
Asian	0.6%	0.0%	0.0%
5073 - Hawthorn Park			
White	3.7%	0.6%	-3.1%
Black	94.5%	92.5%	-2.0%
Hispanic	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Asian	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
5074 - Nolan			
White	2.5%	3.3%	0.8%
Black	95.1%	96.6%	1.5%
Hispanic	0.9%	0.0%	-0.9%
Asian	0.3%	0.0%	-0.3%
Detroit			
White	8.7%	10.8%	2.1%
Black	80.7%	75.0%	-5.7%
Hispanic	7.3%	8.3%	1.0%
Asian	1.2%	1.7%	0.5%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024



Education

Educational attainment improved across most Tracts between 2014 and 2024, with declines in residents without a high school degree and increases in bachelor's degree attainment in several areas. While some variation exists by Tract, the overall trend reflects gradual educational improvement, including gains in post-secondary education, compared to Detroit (see [Table 5](#)). These changes may indicate increased access to educational opportunities and potential workforce growth, while highlighting the continued need for investments that support higher education and skill development.

TABLE 5. Educational Attainment: 2014 - 2024

Race	2014	2024	Percent Change
5069 - Pershing			
No High School Degree	23.1%	22.9%	-0.2%
High School Degree	31.4%	39.5%	8.1%
Some College / Associate's Degree	37.5%	20.7%	-6.8%
Bachelor's Degree or Higher	7.9%	16.9%	9.0%
5070 - Conant Gardens			
No High School Degree	24.2%	17.1%	-7.1%
High School Degree	30.1%	32.6%	1.5%
Some College / Associate's Degree	36.0%	36.4%	0.4%
Bachelor's Degree or Higher	9.7%	13.9%	4.2%
5071 - NE Central District			
No High School Degree	28.2%	17%	-11.2%
High School Degree	41.2%	40.5%	-0.8%
Some College / Associate's Degree	26.3%	41.7%	15.4%
Bachelor's Degree or Higher	4.3%	0.8%	-3.5%
5073 - Hawthorn Park			
No High School Degree	18.8%	19.4%	0.6%
High School Degree	50.9%	30.5%	-20.4%
Some College / Associate's Degree	27.4%	31.6%	4.2%
Bachelor's Degree or Higher	2.9%	18.5%	15.6%
5074 - Nolan			
No High School Degree	18.0%	17.9%	-0.1%
High School Degree	36.9%	47.1%	10.2%
Some College / Associate's Degree	33.2%	20.8%	-12.4%
Bachelor's Degree or Higher	12.0%	14.2%	2.2%
Detroit			
No High School Degree	22.2%	16.7%	-5.5%
High School Degree	32.4%	32.6%	0.2%
Some College / Associate's Degree	32.3%	32.6%	0.3%
Bachelor's Degree or Higher	13.1%	18.1%	5.0%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024



Housing

Data about housing can indicate the strength of the local economy and overall community appeal. The types of housing available in a community can entice or deter new prospective residents from coming to the community, depending on if what is offered meets their needs and desires. Homeownership is often an indicator of wealth, and house value builds upon that analysis.

Housing is an essential component of a community, and foundational in supporting families of all sizes and types. Having options for safe, affordable, and accessible housing is key to creating a healthy and thriving community.

Housing Occupancy

Housing occupancy and tenure patterns show higher homeownership rates across the neighborhoods compared to Detroit overall. All five Tracts have homeownership rates above the city average of 50.3%, while renter shares remain below Detroit’s rate of 49.7% (see [Table 6](#)). Tracts vary in housing occupancy, with some areas exceeding Detroit’s occupancy rate and others showing higher levels of vacancy. Pershing has the largest housing stock and highest number of occupied units, while the Northeast Central District has the highest number of vacant units. These patterns suggest stronger owner occupancy in the neighborhoods, while areas with higher vacancy may benefit from targeted housing stabilization and investment efforts.

TABLE 6. Housing Occupancy: 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Number of Housing Units	Number of Owners	Percent of Owners	Number of Renters	Percent of Renters
5069	Pershing	1,572	819	62.5%	492	37.5%
5070	Conant Gardens	1,214	623	63.2%	362	36.8%
5071	NE Central District	1,157	393	53.3%	345	46.7%
5073	Hawthorn Park	1,248	705	74.7%	239	25.3%
5074	Nolan	1,316	509	57.4%	377	42.6%
Detroit		329,393	129,895	50.3%	128,103	49.7%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024

Housing Value

Median housing values showed mixed changes across the Tracts between 2014 and 2024, with some areas experiencing declines while others saw significant increases. Three of the five Tracts experienced decreases in median home values ranging from approximately 15% to 20%, while two Tracts experienced gains of roughly 45%, exceeding Detroit's overall increase of 41% (see [Table 7](#)). These trends indicate uneven housing market conditions within the neighborhoods, with some neighborhoods experiencing appreciation while others may require targeted investment and stabilization efforts.

TABLE 7. Housing Value: 2014 - 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Housing Value, 2014	Housing Value, 2024	Percent Change
5069	Pershing	\$73,045	\$59,300	-18.8%
5070	Conant Gardens	\$64,079	\$54,600	-14.8%
5071	NE Central District	\$59,464	\$47,400	-20.3%
5073	Hawthorn Park	\$40,741	\$59,800	46.8%
5074	Nolan	\$45,224	\$65,700	45.3%
Detroit		\$59,464	\$83,900	41.1%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024

Age of Housing Stock

The housing stock across the five Census Tracts is overwhelmingly older, with most homes built before 1960 and very little new construction since 2000. In all areas, at least half of housing units were built before 1950, led by Conant Gardens (Tract 5070) where 44.1% of homes were built in 1939 or earlier. Construction from the 1950s and 1960s also represents a significant share of housing across the neighborhoods, while homes built after 1990 account for only a small fraction of units. Compared with Detroit overall, the study geographies generally contain an even older housing stock, reflecting longstanding residential development patterns and limited recent housing growth (see [Table 8](#)).

TABLE 8. Year Housing was Built: 2024

Census Tract	2020 or later	2010 to 2019	2000 to 2009	1990 to 1999	1980 to 1989	1970 to 1979	1960 to 1969	1950 to 1959	1940 to 1949	1939 or earlier
5069	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	2.0%	2.4%	7.4%	11.3%	20.2%	31.1%	25.7%
5070	0.0%	0.0%	2.8%	1.4%	3.0%	1.4%	8.8%	17.6%	20.8%	44.1%
5071	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	7.3%	19.1%	15.0%	29.2%	29.3%
5073	0.0%	1.1%	0.0%	0.5%	0.0%	7.3%	7.9%	16.8%	31.4%	35.0%
5074	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	3.0%	1.2%	3.6%	17.1%	22.6%	18.0%	34.5%
Detroit	0.2%	1.7%	2.6%	2.1%	3.1%	4.7%	7.8%	21.2%	20.3%	36.3%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024



Plumbing Facilities

Census data provides additional insight into less visible aspects of housing quality. The presence of complete plumbing facilities, including hot and cold running water, a flushing toilet, and a bathtub or shower, can help identify opportunities for focused investment. While most homes in the neighborhoods have complete plumbing facilities, a small number of units lack these basic amenities. These units are primarily concentrated among renter-occupied households, with the highest number occurring in Hawthorn Park, where 40% of housing units lack complete plumbing facilities (see [Table 9](#)). Understanding these less visible housing needs allows future investments to better support residents by promoting quality housing conditions, strengthening housing maintenance efforts, and ensuring that existing homes remain livable.

TABLE 9. Percent of Housing Units Lacking Complete Plumbing Facilities: 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Owner-Occupied	Renter-Occupied	Total
5069	Pershing	0%	0%	0%
5070	Conant Gardens	0%	0%	0%
5071	NE Central District	2%	14%	16%
5073	Hawthorn Park	8%	31%	40%
5074	Nolan	1%	3%	4%
Detroit		1%	1%	2%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024

Household Type

Patterns of household composition highlight the importance of supporting families with diverse housing needs. Female-headed households account for nearly 60% of households, while approximately 6.5% include grandparents living with their grandchildren, exceeding the citywide average (see [Table 11](#)). These patterns reflect diverse family structures within the neighborhoods and emphasize the need for housing that supports care giving responsibilities and multi-generational living.

TABLE 10. Percent of Households by Householder Type: 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Married-couple family	Male householder, no spouse present	Female householder, no spouse present
5069	Pershing	13%	22%	65%
5070	Conant Gardens	32%	20%	48%
5071	NE Central District	38%	17%	46%
5073	Hawthorn Park	24%	1%	74%
5074	Nolan	40%	0%	60%
Detroit		37%	13%	50%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024



TABLE 11. Percent of Grandparents as Primary Guardian: 2024

	5069	5070	5071	5073	5074	Detroit
	Pershing	Conant Gardens	NE Central District	Hawthorn Park	Nolan	
Living with own grandchildren under 18 years:	5%	10%	6%	2%	9%	4%
Grandparent responsible for own grandchildren under 18 years:	3%	4%	3%	0%	5%	2%
Responsible less than 6 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Responsible 6 to 11 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	2%	0%
Responsible 1 or 2 years	3%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Responsible 3 or 4 years	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Responsible 5 years or more	0%	4%	3%	0%	3%	1%
Grandparent not responsible for own grandchildren under 18 years	2%	6%	3%	2%	5%	3%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024

Housing Tenure

Census data provides insight into housing tenure patterns and residential stability across the neighborhoods. Nearly half (44%) of the owner-occupied households have lived in their homes since 1990 or earlier, while approximately two thirds (67%) of the renter households moved into their current residence between 2000 and 2019 (See [Table 12](#)). These occupancy trends provide context for directing housing resources towards neighborhood vitality.

TABLE 12. Housing Units by Owner and Renter Occupancy

	5069	5070	5071	5073	5074	Detroit
	Pershing	Conant Gardens	NE Central District	Hawthorn Park	Nolan	
Owner occupied						
Moved in 2020 or later	2%	15%	2%	17%	11%	11%
Moved in 2000 to 2019	43%	39%	59%	57%	39%	49%
Moved in 1990 or earlier	56%	47%	39%	26%	51%	40%
Renter occupied						
Moved in 2020 or later	28%	24%	21%	31%	19%	33%
Moved in 2000 to 2019	70%	63%	69%	60%	74%	62%
Moved in 1990 or earlier	3%	13%	10%	9%	8%	5%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Data 2024



Housing Affordability

Housing affordability remains an important priority identified by neighborhood residents and supported by Census data. While renters in the neighborhood generally experience housing cost burdens similar to or lower than Detroit averages, affordability challenges are more common among households with lower incomes. Overall, 50% of renter households and 37% of homeowner households spend 30% or more of their income on housing. The data shows that income plays a major role in housing affordability.

TABLE 6. Tenants Paying 30% or More for Housing

	5069	5070	5071	5073	5074	Detroit
	Pershing	Conant Gardens	NE Central District	Hawthorn Park	Nolan	
Owner-occupied units:						
Less than \$20,000	90%	100%	100%	91%	91%	85%
\$20,000 to \$34,999	64%	28%	58%	69%	35%	43%
\$35,000 to \$49,999	0%	56%	0%	0%	0%	20%
\$50,000 to \$74,999	0%	45%	0%	11%	0%	12%
\$75,000 or more	0%	0%	0%	10%	0%	3%
Average	31%	36%	54%	28%	38%	27%
Renter-occupied units:						
Less than \$20,000	100%	33%	100%	100%	100%	91%
\$20,000 to \$34,999	100%	88%	100%	23%	0%	86%
\$35,000 to \$49,999	100%	0%	16%	0%	50%	57%
\$50,000 to \$74,999	0%	0%	0%	0%	42%	27%
\$75,000 or more	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	4%
Average	81%	36%	64%	36%	34%	54%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Data 2024



Economy

This section examines the economic conditions of the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhoods to inform future land use and community development planning. It highlights patterns in employment, income, poverty, and commuting, showing how residents participate in the local economy and how economic opportunities are distributed. Understanding these trends is essential for identifying areas of growth, supporting local businesses, and addressing disparities. By establishing a baseline of current conditions, this information helps communities promote equitable economic development, anticipate future challenges, and align land use strategies with the neighborhood’s long-term economic vitality.

Industries of Employment

The occupational composition of the neighborhood has shifted over the past decade, reflecting greater diversity across employment sectors. While Sales and Office occupations remained a significant employment category, residents have increasingly participated in industries such as manufacturing, transportation, healthcare, and service-related fields. In 2024, employment was concentrated in industries including Arts and Hospitality, Retail Trade, Manufacturing, and Education and Health Services, with variation across Tracts (see [Table 13](#)). These patterns suggest a more diverse employment base, with opportunities to support workforce development and access to growing industry sectors.

TABLE 13. Industry of Employment: 2024

Industry	5069	5070	5071	5073	5074	Detroit
	Pershing	Conant Gardens	NE Central District	Hawthorn Park	Nolan	
Agriculture & Mining	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.3%
Construction	0.0%	0.0%	8.2%	1.4%	0.1%	4.4%
Manufacturing	8.9%	23.1%	7.4%	32.1%	12.3%	16.2%
Wholesale Trade	0.0%	2.3%	0.0%	0.0%	0.9%	1.5%
Retail Trade	27.6%	8.7%	11.1%	11.2%	18.5%	9.9%
Transportation & Utilities	9.7%	13.9%	18.1%	3.1%	13.7%	7.7%
Information	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	3.3%	0.0%	1.3%
Finance & Real Estate	7.5%	10.4%	2.6%	4.1%	1.6%	5.4%
Professional & Business Services	2.7%	1.0%	16.8%	2.7%	4.7%	11.3%
Education & Health Services	7.1%	16.8%	18.8%	13.6%	15.3%	23.4%
Arts & Hospitality	28.1%	6.1%	17.0%	7.2%	32.7%	10.3%
Other Services	4.0%	0.0%	0.0%	16.3%	0.0%	4.5%
Public Administration	4.4%	17.7%	0.0%	5.2%	0.0%	3.9%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024

Regional Retention

From 2014 to 2024, the share of residents working within Wayne County increased across most Tracts, indicating stronger regional employment retention. Three Tracts experienced gains of 10% or more, while one remained relatively stable and another saw a slight decline (see [Table 14](#)). These trends suggest that residents are increasingly accessing employment opportunities closer to home, potentially supported by growth in local industries and major employment hubs within Detroit and surrounding areas.

TABLE 14. Regional Retention: 2014 - 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Worked in Wayne County, 2014	Worked in Wayne County, 2024	Percent Change
5069	Pershing	63.5%	79.3%	15.8%
5070	Conant Gardens	77.2%	87.2%	10.0%
5071	NE Central District	56.7%	73.5%	16.8%
5073	Hawthorn Park	54.6%	62.6%	8.0%
5074	Nolan	76.0%	75.5%	-0.5%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024

Median Household Income

Median household incomes vary considerably across the neighborhoods, with only Tract 5073 exceeding Detroit's 2024 median household income of \$39,938. Tracts 5069 and 5071 have the lowest median incomes, while Tracts 5070 and 5074 fall closer to the citywide median. From 2014 to 2024, income trends were mixed, with Tracts 5070 and 5073 experiencing significant growth of 46% and 35%, respectively, while other Tracts saw declines (see [Table 15](#)). These patterns reflect uneven economic change across the neighborhood, highlighting areas of increasing opportunity alongside continued income challenges.

TABLE 15. Median Household Income: 2014 - 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	2014	2024	Percent change
5069	Pershing	\$32,563	\$28,295	-13.1%
5070	Conant Gardens	\$23,594	\$34,434	45.9%
5071	NE Central District	\$26,064	\$23,716	-9.0%
5073	Hawthorn Park	\$31,000	\$41,817	34.9%
5074	Nolan	\$41,522	\$37,652	-9.3%
Detroit		\$26,095	\$39,938	53.1%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024

NOTE: All values adjusted to 2026 levels of inflation



Poverty

Poverty rates remain higher across the neighborhoods compared to Detroit's 2024 rate of 32.7%, with most Tracts experiencing rates between approximately 46% and 57%. Nolan has the highest poverty rate at 57.3%, while Conant Gardens is the only area near the citywide level. From 2014 to 2024, poverty increased in most Tracts, with the largest increases occurring in Hawthorn Park and Nolan, while Conant Gardens experienced an 11.5 percentage point decline. (see [Table 16](#)). These trends indicate uneven economic conditions across the neighborhood, with some areas showing improvement while others continue to face significant economic challenges.

TABLE 16. Poverty Rate: 2014 - 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	2014	2024	Percent change
5069	Pershing	35.4%	48.7%	13.3%
5070	Conant Gardens	45.2%	33.7%	-11.5%
5071	NE Central District	41.5%	55.3%	13.8%
5073	Hawthorn Park	15.5%	45.7%	30.2%
5074	Nolan	24.3%	57.3%	33.0%
Detroit		39.8%	32.7%	-7.1%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014; 2020-2024

Unemployment

Unemployment rates for the following data are described as residents that are ages 16 years of age and over who are not working or actively looking for work. With that being said, Detroit's unemployment rate is 7.6% and 4 of the tracts have rates ranging from 8.5%-15.5%.

Unemployment rates remain higher in most Census tracts compared to Detroit's 2024 rate of 7.6%, with four Tracts ranging from approximately 8.5% to 15.5%. From 2014 to 2024, unemployment declined across most Tracts, with the largest reductions occurring in Pershing and Conant Gardens, each decreasing by 11.6 percentage points. Hawthorn Park was the only area to experience an increase, while Detroit overall saw unemployment decline by 6.8 percentage points (see [Table 17](#)). These trends suggest overall improvement in labor market conditions, though some areas continue to experience higher levels of unemployment.

TABLE 17. Unemployment Rate: 2014 - 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	2014	2024	Percent change
5069	Pershing	21.2%	9.6%	-11.6%
5070	Conant Gardens	22.6%	11.0%	-11.6%
5071	NE Central District	15.4%	N/A	N/A
5073	Hawthorn Park	12.2%	14.5%	2.3%
5074	Nolan	9.6%	8.5%	-1.1%
Detroit		14.4%	7.6%	-6.8%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2010-2014;; 2020-2024

*NOTE: 2024 Unemployment data for Tract 5071 was unavailable.

**NOTE: Unemployment data from the United States Census does not reflect trends caused by events such as the Great Recession or the COVID-19 pandemic.



Transportation

Tracking the shifts in Pershing, Conant Gardens, and the Northeast Central District (covering parts of Detroit’s northeast side/Osborn area) between 2014, 2019, and 2024 reveals a distinct economic and behavioral evolution. Broadly, these blocks mirror a larger macro-shift seen across the city: a slow diversification of the workforce away from purely localized sales/office jobs, a massive shift in commuting habits accelerated by the pandemic, and a shifting relationship with public transit.

Method of Transportation

Transportation patterns shifted significantly by 2024, with remote work becoming a more visible component of commuting patterns across the neighborhoods. While driving alone remains the primary method of transportation in most Tracts, several areas show increased reliance on working from home, particularly Nolan at 25.4%, compared to Detroit’s 12% (See). Public transportation use varies by Tract but remains lower than automobile use overall. These trends reflect broader changes in workplace patterns and may indicate the need for continued investment in transportation access, mobility options, and digital connectivity.

TABLE 18. Method of Transportation to Work: 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Drove alone	Carpooled	Public transportation	Walked	Other means	Worked from home
5069	Pershing	81%	3.4%	10.7%	0.0%	2.0%	2.9%
5070	Conant Gardens	74.9%	0.0%	1.5%	0.0%	17.2%	6.3%
5071	NE Central District	63.3%	8.2%	19.3%	0.0%	9.1%	0.0%
5073	Hawthorn Park	57.6%	23.4%	1.0%	0.0%	11.2%	6.8%
5074	Nolan	64.8%	0.1%	7.7%	0.1%	1.8%	25.4%
Detroit		65.5%	10.6%	4.9%	2.8%	4.2%	12.0%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024

Number of Vehicles and Commute Times

Vehicle ownership and commute times vary across the five Tracts, with most households having access to at least one vehicle. Pershing has the highest share of one-vehicle households (56.1%) and one of the shortest average commute times, while the Northeast Central District has the highest share of two-vehicle households (41.7%) and the longest commute time at 27.5 minutes (see [Table 19](#) and [Table 20](#)). Compared to Detroit, vehicle access is generally similar, though some Tracts have higher rates of households without vehicles. These patterns highlight differences in transportation needs and access across the neighborhoods.

TABLE 19. Number of Vehicles by Household: 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	No vehicles	1 vehicle	2 vehicles	3 or more vehicles
5069	Pershing	14.3%	56.1%	21.4%	8.1%
5070	Conant Gardens	24.4%	31.0%	36.1%	8.5%
5071	NE Central District	19.5%	35.2%	41.7%	3.5%
5073	Hawthorn Park	10.2%	40.8%	48.0%	1.1%
5074	Nolan	16.4%	53.3%	21.7%	8.7%
Detroit		20.1%	48.2%	22.8%	8.9%

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024

TABLE 20. Average Travel Time to Work: 2024

Census Tract	Neighborhood	Average Commute Time (minutes)
5069	Pershing	23.2
5070	Conant Gardens	21.1
5071	NE Central District	27.5
5073	Hawthorn Park	26.6
5074	Nolan	25.8
Detroit		24.8

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, ACS 5-Year Estimates, 2020-2024

APPENDIX D: Community Engagement

Community Context & Background

Existing Assets and Strengths

In the introduction meeting, Solomon Village CDC spoke warmly about the qualities that define this community, pointing to close neighborhood relationships, schools that are cared for, and the sense of pride and resilience that the residents of this area have. The multiple site visits confirmed these feelings and gave additional depth to their statements. On a Tuesday afternoon, the neighborhood had children playing in the front yards, neighbors grilling, people fixing cars together in the streets, and seniors relaxing in rocking chairs on their front porches. Combining the input of Solomon Village and our visits to the neighborhood, these topics became central to the community engagement session that fueled the action plan.

The community shows strength in its physical condition as well. Although many homes are several decades old, the housing stock is relatively stable, with low visual vacancy on the blocks themselves. Homeowners are invested in their property, and multiple buildings are undergoing some level of ongoing improvement, such as roofing, installing new doors, and new paint jobs. There are everyday amenities present in the neighborhood, though typically smaller in scale, including a grocery store, laundromat, urgent care, and car repair.

Looking ahead, Pershing High School represents a significant opportunity for the neighborhood. The new school building, scheduled to open in Fall 2027, has the potential to become a major community asset. This investment by the Detroit Public Schools Community District (DPSCD) reflects confidence in the neighborhood's future and reinforces the positive trajectory already evident throughout the community.



Pershing High School
Source: Historic Detroit

Key Opportunities and Challenges

The Solomon Village CDC identified poor housing conditions as one of the neighborhood's pressing concerns. As longtime residents and community advocates, the CDC has witnessed a disturbing decline in housing conditions throughout the neighborhood and seeks to address the cause and effect.

Site visits documented housing conditions across the neighborhoods and revealed varying levels of deterioration. Conditions ranged from severely blighted and boarded-up homes - which became an easy target for illegal dumping - to occupied homes with smaller maintenance needs, such as an unstable porch roof or unattached siding. These conditions of disrepair among well-kept homes diminish the neighborhood's appearance. Residents have identified the high cost of repairs that keep them from repairing roofs, gutters, and windows.



Homes that appear occupied and with noticeable signs of need

Site visits highlighted the real challenges the neighborhood faces as a result of these issues. Additional observations included visual commercial vacancy, inconsistent bus stop amenities, and a lack of placemaking and signage for the neighborhood. Residents also raised concerns about flooding, limited street lighting, and green spaces for children to play in. Property maintenance standards were another recurring concern, with residents expressing a desire for stronger accountability to ensure that property owners maintain their homes and lots. These observations and community concerns provided the starting point for the formal community engagement session.

Community Engagement

Purpose of Engagement

The purpose of the engagement was to ensure that the 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods Action Plan was informed by the perspectives, experiences, and priorities of the community's residents, business owners, community organizations, and neighborhood stakeholders.

Community engagement is an essential component of the planning process that provides the opportunity for participants to shape their vision, goals, and recommendations for neighborhood investment and revitalization.

Rather than relying only on demographic, housing, and economic data, the engagement process combined community input to create an inclusive understanding of neighborhood conditions and priorities.

Engagement Goals

The engagement activities were designed to:

- Identify the neighborhood's existing strengths, challenges, and opportunities.
- Capture residents' aspirations for the future.
- Understand the assets residents value most.
- Identify issues that affect residents' daily quality of life.
- Gather input on improvements that would strengthen the neighborhood.

Community Discussion Topics

Conversations focused on:

- Housing conditions and affordability.
- Neighborhood safety.
Walkability.
- Commercial development.
Public spaces.
- Community services.
- Programming for residents of all ages.

These discussions provided valuable community perspectives that complemented field observations and existing planning data.

Data Validation and Community Priorities

In addition to gathering resident perspectives, the engagement process sought to validate existing demographic and neighborhood data while identifying priorities that might not have been evident through data collection alone.

Equally important, the engagement process created multiple opportunities for residents and stakeholders to participate in meaningful dialogue about the neighborhood's future.

Role of Community Input

The information gathered throughout the engagement process served as the foundation for developing recommendations that respond to community needs, preserve neighborhood assets, and advance the vision of the 7 Mile-Conant Neighborhoods Action Plan.

Stakeholder Analysis

Once the action area was established, the next step was to identify the key stakeholders within the community. A review was conducted of the City of Detroit's Neighborhood Block Clubs and Associations list, which was last updated in December 2025. The list in [Table 21](#) below includes organizations located within or adjacent to the action area, including organizations that border the action area, recognizing that these groups also have an interest in this area's future.

After identifying the stakeholder groups, the most effective method for contacting each organization was researched. Email was determined to be the most practical outreach method, as contact information was available for many of the neighborhood block clubs and community associations.

TABLE 21. Neighborhood Block Clubs and Associations within the City of Detroit

Group	Organization Type
Solomon Church	Religious
Conant Gardens Neighborhood Dev Corp.	Block Club
Farwell Community Association	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Binder Street	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Riopelle Knights	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Belmont Shopping Center	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Eight-Mile Blvd. Association	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Hawthorne Street	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Hawthorne Park Association	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Anglin Street Angel's	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Conant Gardens Property Owners Asso	Neighborhood Associations / Block Clubs
Gardenia Community Block Club	Block Club
Goddard, Fleming, Mackey, Block Club	Block Club
Keep It Clean Block Club	Block Club
Keystone, Conley, Fenelon	Neighborhood Association
Lindale Gardens Block Club	Block Club
North Central Block Club Association	Neighborhood Association
Russell Block Club	Block Club
The Kings & Queens Of Albany	Block Club
Wexford Street Block Club	Block Club
Yonka-Norwood Block Club	Block Club

Outreach/Engagement Strategy

The community engagement approach for this plan employed a multi-faceted outreach strategy to encourage participation from residents, businesses, community organizations, and other community stakeholders throughout the planning process. Outreach efforts were designed to maximize awareness of the project and provide multiple opportunities for community members to share their perspectives.

Two site visits were conducted within the neighborhoods to observe existing conditions and connect with community members. During the second site visit, a brief business survey was administered to collect feedback on residents' perceptions of local businesses, commercial services, and access to neighborhood amenities.

Surveying

To gather broader community input, two surveys were developed. The first was an online survey that allowed residents to share their experiences, concerns, and priorities for the neighborhood. The survey included questions related to housing, safety, parks and open space, walkability, community services, and commercial development. The survey was distributed digitally through community partners and outreach efforts.

The second survey was sent directly to business owners with information requested around challenges of maintaining a business, creating a business association, and other needs. The business owner survey was physically distributed to businesses on the 7 Mile corridor and was available both physically and by QR code during the Community Input Meeting. Neither survey yielded substantial results.

Community Input Meeting

A Community Input Meeting was held on June 30, 2026, at the Chosen Generation Community Center. The event provided residents with an opportunity to learn about the Action Plan, share their perspectives, and discuss priorities for the future of the 7 Mile-Conant neighborhoods. Feedback collected during the meeting helped inform the recommendations included in the Neighborhood Action Plan, as discussed further in later sections.

Outreach and Communication

To promote participation in the Community Input Meeting, outreach strategies included:

- Designing and distributing flyers for the community event.
- Partnering with Solomon's Temple Church to share the event with congregation members.
- Including the event announcement in Solomon's Temple Church's weekly bulletin.
- Inviting neighborhood organizations, block clubs, and community stakeholders through email to participate.

These outreach efforts were intended to reach a broad cross-section of residents and encourage meaningful participation throughout the planning process.



Flyer distributed to community stakeholders

Community Sessions, Research & Assessment

The event was attended by approximately 20 members of the church, neighborhood, Solomon Village CDC, and graduate students. Four stations were hosted, including:

- Social/future desires station
- Housing priorities & preferences station
- Programming station
- Census/data station

Residents were welcomed by both Solomon Village CDC and Wayne State, and were then encouraged to rotate around the room to engage with each station. The information collected at each station is as follows:

Social/Future Desires

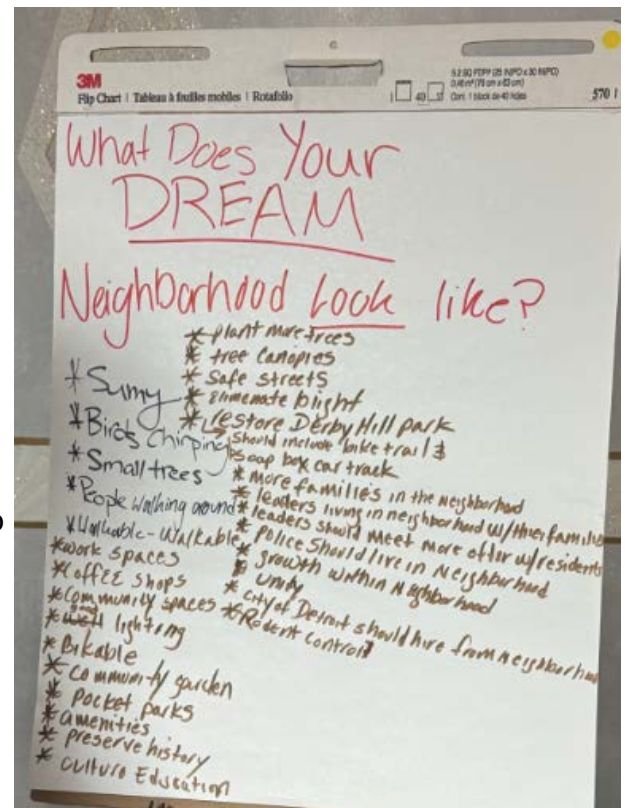
Participants were asked to imagine their ideal neighborhood and describe what it would feel like there were no constraints related to budget, politics, or other external factors. Rather than focusing solely on physical improvements, attendees shared a vision centered on the feeling and experience they want their neighborhood to foster.

Connection to nature

A strong theme throughout the discussion was a desire to feel connected to nature. Participants envisioned waking up to the sounds of birds chirping, walking beneath a healthy tree canopy, and spending time with their community in gardens, parks, and other green spaces. Nature was described not only as an amenity, but as something that creates a sense of peace, comfort, and well-being.

Connection to community

Attendees also expressed a desire to feel connected to one another and to the neighborhood itself. Participants described wanting welcoming gathering spaces, where neighbors can build relationships, such as coffee shops, community spaces, and local businesses that reflect the neighborhood's identity and history. These spaces were envisioned not only as places to socialize, but also as places where residents can share knowledge, skills, and experiences across generations. Many participants discussed the importance of creating opportunities for youth, adults, and seniors to learn from one another, strengthening community bonds while preserving local knowledge and culture.



Poster from session on dream neighborhood

Civic leadership

Participants also emphasized the importance of civic leadership that is deeply rooted in and representative of the community. Residents expressed a desire for leaders who live in the neighborhood, understand the experience of residents, and are invested in the community's success. This theme reflected a broader desire to feel heard, represented, and included in decisions that shape the neighborhood's future.

Unity and belonging

Above all, participants described wanted to feel a sense of unity and belonging. They envisioned a neighborhood where people of all ages can walk safely and comfortably, where streets are well-lit and welcoming, and where residents feel connected to both their neighbors and community spaces. The dream neighborhood was ultimately described as one that fosters belonging, safety, connection, representation, and opportunity. The neighborhood as a place where everyone feels supported, valued, and included.

Key feelings expressed by participants:



CONNECTION TO
NATURE



BELONGING AND
COMMUNITY PRIDE



UNITY ACROSS
GENERATIONS



SAFETY AND
COMFORT



REPRESENTATION
AND FEELING
HEARD



OPPORTUNITIES
FOR LEARNING AND
GROWTH



WELCOMING
SPACES FOR
GATHERING



INCLUSION AND
SUPPORT



Resident identifying areas for improvement on a map



Resident selecting their housing priorities and preference

Housing

Home maintenance and repair affordability

Residents identified home maintenance and affordability as the most pressing housing concerns. Throughout the community engagement discussion, the cost of home repairs was the primary barrier to maintaining homes. Participants emphasized the need for financial assistance and reliable information for financial assistance home repair programs, along with the desire to keep their homes in good condition.

Housing preferences and neighborhood character

When discussing housing preferences, participants expressed the greatest desire for single-family homes. The ability to own “a place to call your own” was viewed as an important benefit. Small multi-unit buildings and apartments also got multiple votes from the community, identifying the benefit of density to provide housing options for neighbors.

Challenges facing fixed-income homeowners

Conversations around affordability centered on affordability of repairs especially for fixed-income individuals. One resident specifically referenced the lasting effect of Detroit’s bankruptcy, describing reduction in pension benefits and healthcare coverage, that has strained repair affordability.

Priorities for affordable housing investment

When asked what types of affordable housing should be prioritized, repair assistance for existing homeowners received the greatest support. Participants consistently emphasized that helping current residents maintain their homes was their most important wish. Calls for “actually affordable” housing reflected concerns that costs should better align with residents’ incomes. One participant suggested tiny homes or container homes, as smaller, more efficient housing types that may be easier and less costly to maintain than older homes requiring ongoing repairs. Throughout the discussion, residents expressed pride in their homes and a desire for the neighborhood to remain well maintained and thrive. At the same time, many described homeownership as a financial burden due to repair and maintenance costs.

HOUSING PRIORITIES & PREFERENCES

What prevents homeowners from making repairs?
(Examples: cost, access to skilled labor, knowledge of assistance programs)

What makes it difficult for seniors to stay in their homes and the neighborhood?

Getting around the home	Getting around the neighborhood	Cost of repairs and upkeep	Cost of mortgage, taxes, rent	Other challenges
● ●	●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ●

What types of homes does this neighborhood need more of?

Single-family homes	Duplex / Small Multi-Units	Apartments	Senior-Assisted Living Homes	Other
● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●

What affordable housing should be prioritized?

Affordable rentals	Affordable homeownership	Affordable senior housing	Repair assistance for current homeowners	Other housing needs
● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●	● ● ● ● ●

Programming

This activity was structured by age groups (0-18, 18-65, and 65+), with participants responding to a set of guiding questions tailored to each group's perspective:

- What do I want for myself?
- What do I want for our youth residents?
- What do I want for our middle-aged residents?
- What do I want for our senior residents?



Community Engagement programming board

18 - 65 Age Group

Within the 18–65 age group, participants primarily identified needs that influence their current stability and long-term affordability. Their priorities reflected a desire to strengthen housing security, support community well-being, and expand opportunities for future generations. Key areas of focus included:

- **For themselves:** Participants emphasized the need for expanded access to diverse housing options, reasonable property taxes, and increased availability of home repair resources to better support both existing homeowners and renters.
- **For senior residents:** Participants highlighted the importance of safety and livability through safer streets, accessible community gathering spaces, and improved transportation resources that promote mobility, independence, and quality of life.
- **For youth:** Participants prioritized opportunity-building through increased access to job training programs, well-paying employment opportunities, expanded trade school pathways, and overall improvements to local school quality.

65+ Age Group

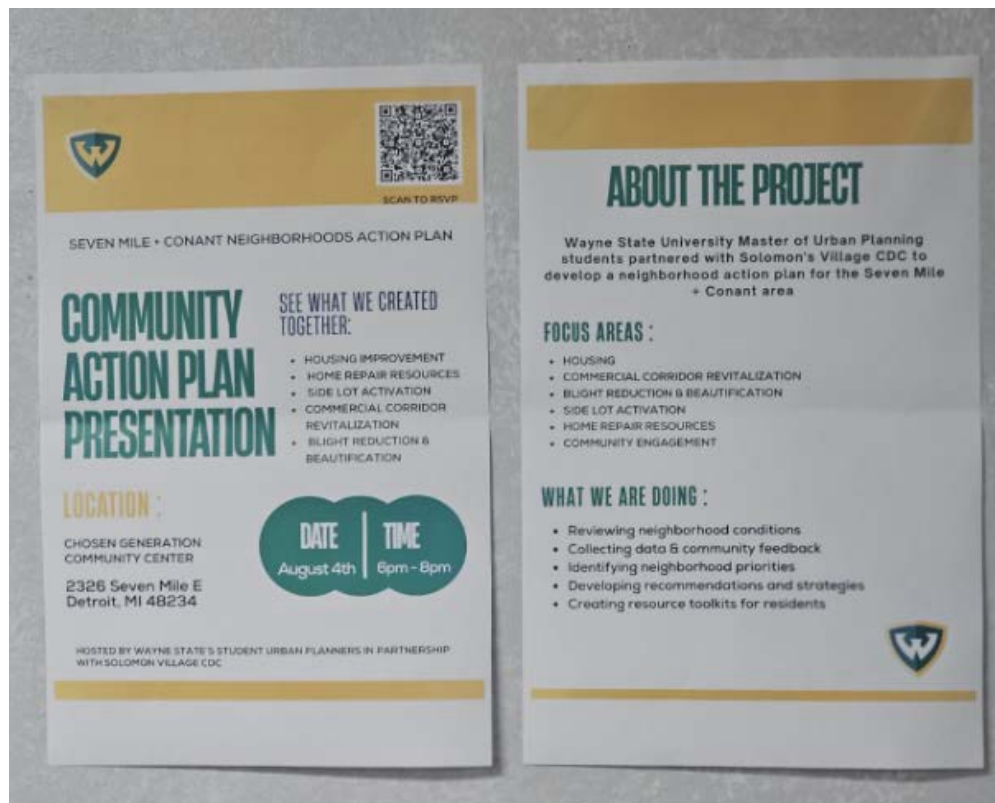
Within the 65+ age group, responses reflected both immediate quality-of-life concerns and broader community investment priorities. Participants identified needs that support personal well-being, strengthen household stability, and create greater opportunities for future generations. Key areas of focus included:

- **For themselves:** Participants emphasized the importance of walkability and neighborhood safety, highlighting the need for a community where residents can move comfortably, confidently, and securely throughout their daily routines.
- **For middle-aged residents:** Participants identified a broad range of resources to support household stability and neighborhood vibrancy, including more unique dining, nightlife, and entertainment options; improved financial literacy resources; increased access to daycare services; affordable housing options; and stronger access to essential services such as medical care, food resources, and banking institutions.
- **For youth residents:** Participants prioritized workforce preparation and structured development opportunities, including increased funding for job training programs, access to stronger employment opportunities, greater willingness among employers to hire and invest in young people, and expanded summer camps and after-school programs to support youth growth beyond the classroom.

There were no attendees under the age of 18 at the event.

Action Plan Presentation

Posters displaying the final action plan presentation on August 4th were displayed at the community event to encourage residents to attend.



Informative posters shared during the June 30th session for final plan presentation on August 4th

Key Findings and Themes

The community engagement process revealed several recurring themes that emerged through site visits, community conversations, surveys, and the June 30 Community Input Meeting. While each engagement activity focused on different aspects of the neighborhood, participants consistently expressed a shared desire to preserve the community's strengths while addressing long-standing challenges.

The following themes represent the most common ideas that emerged throughout the engagement process and informed the recommendations presented in this Action Plan.

Pride In the Neighborhood

One of the strongest themes that emerged throughout the engagement process was the pride residents have in their neighborhood. During site visits, many homes appeared occupied and well maintained despite their age, with visible investments such as new roofs, fresh paint, updated doors, and ongoing exterior improvements. Residents also spoke positively about their community, emphasizing their desire to remain in the neighborhood and continue investing in their homes.

This sense of pride demonstrates that residents value the character of the neighborhood and are committed to its long-term success. Rather than seeking to transform the community into something new, participants expressed a desire to build upon the neighborhood's existing strengths while preserving its identity.

Desire for Greater Investment

Although residents expressed pride in their neighborhood, many also shared a feeling that the area has been overlooked. Participants discussed the need for additional investment in housing, commercial corridors, neighborhood amenities, and public infrastructure. Conversations reflected a desire for equitable access to the same opportunities and improvements seen in other areas of Detroit.

Residents recognized the neighborhood's potential and expressed optimism that thoughtful investment could strengthen the community while improving quality of life for current and future residents.



Community engagement meeting attendees

Need for Assistance Navigating Resources

Throughout the engagement process, residents expressed a desire for greater support in navigating available programs and services. Discussions surrounding housing frequently focused on the challenges of finding affordable home repair assistance and understanding what resources already exist. Participants emphasized that maintaining their homes is important to them, but that identifying available funding opportunities and assistance programs can be difficult.

This finding suggests that improving access to information and connecting residents with existing resources may be just as valuable as creating new programs. Providing clear, accessible resource guides can help reduce barriers and empower residents to invest in their homes and neighborhoods.

Investing in Current Residents

Another consistent theme was the importance of investing in the people who already call the neighborhood home. Rather than focusing solely on attracting new development, residents emphasized preserving existing housing, assisting current homeowners with repairs, and ensuring that long-term residents can remain in the community.

This perspective highlights a desire for revitalization that strengthens neighborhood stability while supporting those who have remained invested in the area through years of change.

A Vision for a More Connected Community

While residents appreciated the neighborhood's existing strengths, they also identified opportunities to improve quality of life through additional amenities and public investment. Participants expressed a desire for expanded tree canopy, improved sidewalks, safer and more walkable streets, stronger community outreach, and continued investment in local businesses.

Along the 7 Mile commercial corridor, residents identified several desired amenities, including additional medical services, sit-down restaurants, coffee shops, family-friendly gathering spaces, entertainment options such as a movie theater, and improved pedestrian connections to nearby schools.

Collectively, these responses reflect a vision for a neighborhood that is not only safe and accessible but also provides the everyday services, recreational opportunities, and gathering spaces that support a vibrant community.



Community engagement meeting attendees

